וְשֹׁאֲבֵי מַיִם לָעֵדָה וּלְמִזְבַּח יהוה עַד־הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה אֶל־הַמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר
יִבְחָר: ‏ א וַיְהִי כִּשְׁמֹעַ אֲדֹנִי־צֶדֶק מֶלֶךְ יְרוּשָׁלִַם כִּי־לָכַד
יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶת־הָעַי וַיַּחֲרִימָהּ כַּאֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה לִיְרִיחוֹ וּלְמַלְכָּהּ כֵּן עָשָׂה לָעַי
ב וּלְמַלְכָּהּ וְכִי הִשְׁלִימוּ יֹשְׁבֵי גִבְעוֹן אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיִּהְיוּ בְּקִרְבָּם: וַיִּירְאוּ
מְאֹד כִּי עִיר גְּדוֹלָה גִּבְעוֹן כְּאַחַת עָרֵי הַמַּמְלָכָה וְכִי הִיא גְּדוֹלָה מִן־הָעַי
ג וְכָל־אֲנָשֶׁיהָ גִּבֹּרִים: וַיִּשְׁלַח אֲדֹנִי־צֶדֶק מֶלֶךְ יְרוּשָׁלִַם אֶל־הוֹהָם מֶלֶךְ־
חֶבְרוֹן וְאֶל־פִּרְאָם מֶלֶךְ־יַרְמוּת וְאֶל־יָפִיעַ מֶלֶךְ־לָכִישׁ וְאֶל־דְּבִיר מֶלֶךְ־
ד עֶגְלוֹן לֵאמֹר: עֲלוּ־אֵלַי וְעִזְרֻנִי וְנַכֶּה אֶת־גִּבְעוֹן כִּי־הִשְׁלִימָה אֶת־
ה יְהוֹשֻׁעַ וְאֶת־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל: וַיֵּאָסְפוּ וַיַּעֲלוּ חֲמֵשֶׁת | מַלְכֵי הָאֱמֹרִי מֶלֶךְ
יְרוּשָׁלִַם מֶלֶךְ חֶבְרוֹן מֶלֶךְ־יַרְמוּת מֶלֶךְ־לָכִישׁ מֶלֶךְ־עֶגְלוֹן הֵם וְכָל־
ו מַחֲנֵיהֶם וַיַּחֲנוּ עַל־גִּבְעוֹן וַיִּלָּחֲמוּ עָלֶיהָ: וַיִּשְׁלְחוּ אַנְשֵׁי גִבְעוֹן אֶל־
יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶל־הַמַּחֲנֶה הַגִּלְגָּלָה לֵאמֹר אַל־תֶּרֶף יָדֶיךָ מֵעֲבָדֶיךָ עֲלֵה אֵלֵינוּ
מְהֵרָה וְהוֹשִׁיעָה לָּנוּ וְעָזְרֻנוּ כִּי נִקְבְּצוּ אֲלֵינוּ כָּל־מַלְכֵי הָאֱמֹרִי יֹשְׁבֵי
ז הָהָר: וַיַּעַל יְהוֹשֻׁעַ מִן־הַגִּלְגָּל הוּא וְכָל־עַם הַמִּלְחָמָה עִמּוֹ וְכָל גִּבּוֹרֵי
ח הַחָיִל: וַיֹּאמֶר יהוה אֶל־יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אַל־תִּירָא מֵהֶם כִּי בְיָדְךָ
ט נְתַתִּים לֹא־יַעֲמֹד אִישׁ מֵהֶם בְּפָנֶיךָ: וַיָּבֹא אֲלֵיהֶם יְהוֹשֻׁעַ פִּתְאֹם כָּל־
י הַלַּיְלָה עָלָה מִן־הַגִּלְגָּל: וַיְהֻמֵּם יהוה לִפְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיַּכֵּם מַכָּה־גְדוֹלָה
בְּגִבְעוֹן וַיִּרְדְּפֵם דֶּרֶךְ מַעֲלֵה בֵית־חוֹרֹן וַיַּכֵּם עַד־עֲזֵקָה וְעַד־מַקֵּדָה:
יא וַיְהִי בְּנֻסָם | מִפְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הֵם בְּמוֹרַד בֵּית־חוֹרֹן וַיהוה הִשְׁלִיךְ עֲלֵיהֶם
אֲבָנִים גְּדֹלוֹת מִן־הַשָּׁמַיִם עַד־עֲזֵקָה וַיָּמֻתוּ רַבִּים אֲשֶׁר־מֵתוּ בְּאַבְנֵי
יב הַבָּרָד מֵאֲשֶׁר הָרְגוּ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בֶּחָרֶב: אָז יְדַבֵּר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ
לַיהוה בְּיוֹם תֵּת יהוה אֶת־הָאֱמֹרִי לִפְנֵי בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיֹּאמֶר | לְעֵינֵי
יג יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁמֶשׁ בְּגִבְעוֹן דּוֹם וְיָרֵחַ בְּעֵמֶק אַיָּלוֹן: וַיִּדֹּם הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ וְיָרֵחַ עָמָד
עַד־יִקֹּם גּוֹי אֹיְבָיו הֲלֹא־הִיא כְתוּבָה עַל־סֵפֶר הַיָּשָׁר וַיַּעֲמֹד הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ
יד בַּחֲצִי הַשָּׁמַיִם וְלֹא־אָץ לָבוֹא כְּיוֹם תָּמִים: וְלֹא הָיָה כַיּוֹם הַהוּא לְפָנָיו
טו וְאַחֲרָיו לִשְׁמֹעַ יהוה בְּקוֹל אִישׁ כִּי יהוה נִלְחָם לְיִשְׂרָאֵל: וַיָּשָׁב
טז יְהוֹשֻׁעַ וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל עִמּוֹ אֶל־הַמַּחֲנֶה הַגִּלְגָּלָה: וְיָנֻסוּ חֲמֵשֶׁת הַמְּלָכִים
יז הָאֵלֶּה וַיִּחְבְּאוּ בַמְּעָרָה בְּמַקֵּדָה: וַיֻּגַּד לִיהוֹשֻׁעַ לֵאמֹר נִמְצְאוּ חֲמֵשֶׁת
יח הַמְּלָכִים נֶחְבְּאִים בַּמְּעָרָה בְּמַקֵּדָה: וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ גֹּלוּ אֲבָנִים גְּדֹלוֹת
יט אֶל־פִּי הַמְּעָרָה וְהַפְקִידוּ עָלֶיהָ אֲנָשִׁים לְשָׁמְרָם: וְאַתֶּם אַל־תַּעֲמֹדוּ
רִדְפוּ אַחֲרֵי אֹיְבֵיכֶם וְזַנַּבְתֶּם אוֹתָם אַל־תִּתְּנוּם לָבוֹא אֶל־עָרֵיהֶם כִּי

10:1. This chapter relates details of Joshua's conquest of the southern part of Canaan. Divine Providence assisted the Israelites by causing the Canaanites of the South to unite and attack Gibeon. As a result, the Jews were able to defeat the confederacy of five kings in a single battle.

10:12. Alternatively: . . . and he said, "Before the eyes of Israel, O Sun, stand still . . . " (*Radak*).

10:13. The Book of the Upright is the Torah, in which God told Moses (*Exodus* 34:10) that He would act in an unprecedented manner for the benefit of Israel (*Radak*).

HASHEM, your God, has delivered them into your hand."

[20] *It happened when Joshua and the Children of Israel finished striking them an exceedingly great blow until their annihilation* that the remnant that remained of them entered the fortified cities.* [21] *Then the entire nation [of Israel] returned to the camp, to Joshua, to Makkedah, in peace. No one [even] whetted his tongue against any man of the Children of Israel.* [22] *Joshua said, "Open the mouth of the cave and bring out to me those five kings from the cave."* [23] *So they did; they brought out to him those five kings from the cave — the king of Jerusalem, the king of Hebron, the king of Jarmuth, the king of Lachish, the king of Eglon.* [24] *It happened when they brought out those kings to Joshua that Joshua summoned all the men of Israel and said to the officers of the men of war who had gone with him, "Approach, place your feet on the necks of these kings." They approached and placed their feet on their necks.** [25] *Joshua said to them, "Do not fear, and do not lose resolve; be strong and courageous, for thus shall HASHEM do to all your enemies with whom you battle."* [26] *Joshua struck them after that and killed them, and hanged them on five gallows, and they remained hanging on the gallows until evening.* [27] *It happened at the time the sun set that Joshua ordered. There were lowered from the gallows and they were thrown into the cave in which they had concealed themselves. They placed large stones at the mouth of the cave — [which are there] to this very day.*

Joshua kills the five kings

City by city conquest: Makkedah (See Appendix D, map 3)

[28] *Joshua captured Makkedah on that day, and smote it by the edge of the sword and its king he destroyed; [he killed] them and every soul that was in it; he did not leave a remnant. He did to the king of Makkedah as he had done to the king of Jericho.*

Libnah

[29] *Joshua and all Israel with him passed over from Makkedah to Libnah, and he waged war against Libnah.* [30] *HASHEM also delivered it and its king into the hand of Israel; they smote it by the edge of the sword and every soul that was in it; he did not leave a remnant in it. He did to its king as he had done to the king of Jericho.*

Lachish

[31] *Joshua and all Israel with him passed over from Libnah to Lachish; he encamped by it and waged war against it.* [32] *HASHEM delivered Lachish into the hand of Israel, and they conquered it on the second day. He smote it by the edge of the sword and every soul that was in it, like all that he had done to Libnah.*

Gezer

[33] *Then Horam, king of Gezer, went up to help Lachish. Joshua struck him and his people until he did not leave him a remnant.*

Eglon

[34] *Joshua and all Israel with him passed over from Lachish to Eglon; they encamped by it and waged war against it.* [35] *On that day they conquered it and they struck it by the edge of the sword and destroyed every soul that was in it that day, like all that he had done to Lachish.*

Hebron

[36] *Joshua and all Israel with him went up from Eglon to Hebron and waged war against it.* [37] *They conquered it and struck it by the edge of the sword — its king and all its villages and every soul that was in it; he did not leave a remnant, like all that he had done to Eglon. He destroyed it and every soul that was in it.*

Debir

[38] *Joshua and all Israel with him returned to Debir and waged war against*

10:20. Even though there were still some survivors, they were so few that, for all practical purposes, the entire army had been annihilated (*Metzudos*).

10:24. This was to symbolize that the Jews had nothing to fear from any of the Canaanite kings.

כ נְתָנָם יהוה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם בְּיָדְכֶם: וַיְהִי כְּכַלּוֹת יְהוֹשֻׁעַ וּבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לְהַכּוֹתָם
מַכָּה גְדוֹלָה־מְאֹד עַד־תֻּמָּם וְהַשְּׂרִידִים שָׂרְדוּ מֵהֶם וַיָּבֹאוּ אֶל־עָרֵי
כא הַמִּבְצָר: וַיָּשֻׁבוּ כָל־הָעָם אֶל־הַמַּחֲנֶה אֶל־יְהוֹשֻׁעַ מַקֵּדָה בְּשָׁלוֹם לֹא־
כב חָרַץ לִבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לְאִישׁ אֶת־לְשֹׁנוֹ: וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ פִּתְחוּ אֶת־פִּי
כג הַמְּעָרָה וְהוֹצִיאוּ אֵלַי אֶת־חֲמֵשֶׁת הַמְּלָכִים הָאֵלֶּה מִן־הַמְּעָרָה: וַיַּעֲשׂוּ
כֵּן וַיּוֹצִיאוּ אֵלָיו אֶת־חֲמֵשֶׁת הַמְּלָכִים הָאֵלֶּה מִן־הַמְּעָרָה אֶת | מֶלֶךְ
יְרוּשָׁלַם אֶת־מֶלֶךְ חֶבְרוֹן אֶת־מֶלֶךְ יַרְמוּת אֶת־מֶלֶךְ לָכִישׁ אֶת־מֶלֶךְ
כד עֶגְלוֹן: וַיְהִי כְּהוֹצִיאָם אֶת־הַמְּלָכִים הָאֵלֶּה אֶל־יְהוֹשֻׁעַ וַיִּקְרָא יְהוֹשֻׁעַ
אֶל־כָּל־אִישׁ יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיֹּאמֶר אֶל־קְצִינֵי אַנְשֵׁי הַמִּלְחָמָה הֲהָלְכוּא אִתּוֹ
קִרְבוּ שִׂימוּ אֶת־רַגְלֵיכֶם עַל־צַוְּארֵי הַמְּלָכִים הָאֵלֶּה וַיִּקְרְבוּ וַיָּשִׂימוּ אֶת־
כה רַגְלֵיהֶם עַל־צַוְּארֵיהֶם: וַיֹּאמֶר אֲלֵיהֶם יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אַל־תִּירְאוּ וְאַל־תֵּחָתּוּ
חִזְקוּ וְאִמְּצוּ כִּי כָּכָה יַעֲשֶׂה יהוה לְכָל־אֹיְבֵיכֶם אֲשֶׁר אַתֶּם נִלְחָמִים
כו אוֹתָם: וַיַּכֵּם יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אַחֲרֵי־כֵן וַיְמִיתֵם וַיִּתְלֵם עַל חֲמִשָּׁה עֵצִים וַיִּהְיוּ
כז תְלוּיִם עַל־הָעֵצִים עַד־הָעָרֶב: וַיְהִי לְעֵת | בּוֹא הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ צִוָּה יְהוֹשֻׁעַ
וַיֹּרִידוּם מֵעַל הָעֵצִים וַיַּשְׁלִכֻם אֶל־הַמְּעָרָה אֲשֶׁר נֶחְבְּאוּ־שָׁם וַיָּשִׂמוּ
כח אֲבָנִים גְּדֹלוֹת עַל־פִּי הַמְּעָרָה עַד־עֶצֶם הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה: וְאֶת־
מַקֵּדָה לָכַד יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא וַיַּכֶּהָ לְפִי־חָרֶב וְאֶת־מַלְכָּהּ הֶחֱרִם אוֹתָם
וְאֶת־כָּל־הַנֶּפֶשׁ אֲשֶׁר־בָּהּ לֹא הִשְׁאִיר שָׂרִיד וַיַּעַשׂ לְמֶלֶךְ מַקֵּדָה כַּאֲשֶׁר
כט עָשָׂה לְמֶלֶךְ יְרִיחוֹ: וַיַּעֲבֹר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל עִמּוֹ מִמַּקֵּדָה
ל לִבְנָה וַיִּלָּחֶם עִם־לִבְנָה: וַיִּתֵּן יהוה גַּם־אוֹתָהּ בְּיַד יִשְׂרָאֵל וְאֶת־מַלְכָּהּ
וַיַּכֶּהָ לְפִי־חָרֶב וְאֶת־כָּל־הַנֶּפֶשׁ אֲשֶׁר־בָּהּ לֹא־הִשְׁאִיר בָּהּ שָׂרִיד וַיַּעַשׂ
לא לְמַלְכָּהּ כַּאֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה לְמֶלֶךְ יְרִיחוֹ: וַיַּעֲבֹר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל
לב עִמּוֹ מִלִּבְנָה לָכִישָׁה וַיַּחַן עָלֶיהָ וַיִּלָּחֶם בָּהּ: וַיִּתֵּן יהוה אֶת־לָכִישׁ בְּיַד
יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיִּלְכְּדָהּ בַּיּוֹם הַשֵּׁנִי וַיַּכֶּהָ לְפִי־חָרֶב וְאֶת־כָּל־הַנֶּפֶשׁ אֲשֶׁר־בָּהּ
לג כְּכֹל אֲשֶׁר־עָשָׂה לְלִבְנָה: אָז עָלָה הֹרָם מֶלֶךְ גֶּזֶר לַעְזֹר אֶת־
לד לָכִישׁ וַיַּכֵּהוּ יְהוֹשֻׁעַ וְאֶת־עַמּוֹ עַד־בִּלְתִּי הִשְׁאִיר־לוֹ שָׂרִיד: וַיַּעֲבֹר
יְהוֹשֻׁעַ וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל עִמּוֹ מִלָּכִישׁ עֶגְלָנָה וַיַּחֲנוּ עָלֶיהָ וַיִּלָּחֲמוּ עָלֶיהָ:
לה וַיִּלְכְּדוּהָ בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא וַיַּכּוּהָ לְפִי־חָרֶב וְאֵת כָּל־הַנֶּפֶשׁ אֲשֶׁר־בָּהּ בַּיּוֹם
לו הַהוּא הֶחֱרִים כְּכֹל אֲשֶׁר־עָשָׂה לְלָכִישׁ: וַיַּעַל יְהוֹשֻׁעַ וְכָל־
לז יִשְׂרָאֵל עִמּוֹ מֵעֶגְלוֹנָה חֶבְרוֹנָה וַיִּלָּחֲמוּ עָלֶיהָ: וַיִּלְכְּדוּהָ וַיַּכּוּהָ־לְפִי־
חָרֶב וְאֶת־מַלְכָּהּ וְאֶת־כָּל־עָרֶיהָ וְאֶת־כָּל־הַנֶּפֶשׁ אֲשֶׁר־בָּהּ לֹא־
הִשְׁאִיר שָׂרִיד כְּכֹל אֲשֶׁר־עָשָׂה לְעֶגְלוֹן וַיַּחֲרֵם אוֹתָהּ וְאֶת־כָּל־הַנֶּפֶשׁ
לח אֲשֶׁר־בָּהּ: וַיָּשָׁב יְהוֹשֻׁעַ וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל עִמּוֹ דְּבִרָה וַיִּלָּחֶם

it. [39] *He conquered it and its king and all its villages, and he struck them with the edge of the sword and destroyed every soul that was in it; he did not leave a remnant. As he had done to Hebron, so he did to Debir and to its king, and as he had done to Libnah and to its king.* [40] *Joshua smote the entire land — the mountain, the South, the lowland, the [land of the] waterfalls and all their kings. He did not leave a remnant. He destroyed every soul as* HASHEM, *God of Israel, had commanded.* [41] *Joshua smote them from Kadesh-barnea to Gaza and the entire land of Goshen to Gibeon.* [42] *All those kings and their land Joshua conquered at the same time, because* HASHEM, *God of Israel, was waging war for Israel.* [43] *Joshua and all Israel with him returned to the camp, to Gilgal.*

The conclusion of the southern conquest

11

THE CONQUEST OF THE NORTH 11:1-15

(See Appendix D, map 3)

[1] *It happened when Jabin king of Hazor heard:* He sent to Jobab king of Madon, to the king of Shimron, and to the king of Achshaph,* [2] *and to the kings who were from the north, in the mountain, and in the plain south of Kinnereth, and in the lowland and in the districts of Dor to the west;* [3] *the Canaanite on the east and on the west; and the Amorite and the Hittite and the Perizzite and the Jebusite in the mountain; and the Hivvite at the foothills of Hermon in the land of Mizpah.* [4] *They went out — they and all their camps with them — many people, [as numerous] as the sand on the seashore, and very many horses and chariots.* [5] *All these kings gathered [together]; they came and encamped together at the waters of Merom to wage war with Israel.*

[6] *HASHEM said to Joshua, "Do not fear them, for tomorrow at this time I will deliver them all as corpses before Israel. You shall hamstring their horses and burn their chariots in fire."*

Joshua's pre-emptive strike

[7] *Joshua and all the people of war with him attacked them suddenly at the waters of Merom and fell upon them.* [8] *HASHEM delivered them into the hand of Israel, and they struck them and pursued them all the way to the Great Sidon and Misrephoth-maim and to the Valley of Mizpeh eastward. They struck them until they had not left them a remnant.* [9] *Joshua dealt with them as HASHEM had told him; he hamstrung their horses and burned their chariots in fire.*

[10] *Joshua turned back at that time and conquered Hazor and struck its king with the sword, because Hazor had formerly been the leader of all those kingdoms.* [11] *They smote every soul that was in it, destroying them by the edge of the sword; not a soul was left. He burned Hazor in fire.* [12] *Joshua conquered all the cities of these kings and all their kings; he struck them with the edge of the sword, destroying them, as Moses the servant of HASHEM had commanded.* [13] *However, all the cities [whose walls] remained steadfast, Israel did not burn. Only Hazor alone did Joshua burn.** [14] *All the spoils of these cities and the livestock, the Children of Israel took for themselves as booty; but they struck every man by the edge of the sword until they exterminated them. They did not leave any soul.* [15] *As HASHEM had commanded Moses His servant, so Moses commanded Joshua; and so Joshua did. He did not omit a thing of all that HASHEM had commanded Moses.*

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the king of Hazor formed a confederacy of the most powerful northern kingdoms to attack the Israelites, thus enabling Joshua to strike the unsuspecting confederacy while it was organizing its attack against the Israelites.

11:13. Joshua did not burn the cities whose walls remained intact. The only city he razed was Hazor (*Rashi*).

לט עָלֶיהָ: וַיִּלְכְּדָהּ וְאֶת־מַלְכָּהּ וְאֶת־כָּל־עָרֶיהָ וַיַּכּוּם לְפִי־חָרֶב וַיַּחֲרִימוּ
אֶת־כָּל־נֶפֶשׁ אֲשֶׁר־בָּהּ לֹא הִשְׁאִיר שָׂרִיד כַּאֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה לְחֶבְרוֹן כֵּן־
מ עָשָׂה לִדְבִרָה וּלְמַלְכָּהּ וְכַאֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה לִלִבְנָה וּלְמַלְכָּהּ: וַיַּכֶּה יְהוֹשֻׁעַ
אֶת־כָּל־הָאָרֶץ הָהָר וְהַנֶּגֶב וְהַשְּׁפֵלָה וְהָאֲשֵׁדוֹת וְאֵת כָּל־מַלְכֵיהֶם לֹא
הִשְׁאִיר שָׂרִיד וְאֵת כָּל־הַנִּשְׁמָה הֶחֱרִים כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּה יהוה אֱלֹהֵי
מא יִשְׂרָאֵל: וַיַּכֵּם יְהוֹשֻׁעַ מִקָּדֵשׁ בַּרְנֵעַ וְעַד־עַזָּה וְאֵת כָּל־אֶרֶץ גֹּשֶׁן וְעַד־
מב גִּבְעוֹן: וְאֵת כָּל־הַמְּלָכִים הָאֵלֶּה וְאֶת־אַרְצָם לָכַד יְהוֹשֻׁעַ פַּעַם אֶחָת
מג כִּי יהוה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל נִלְחָם לְיִשְׂרָאֵל: וַיָּשָׁב יְהוֹשֻׁעַ וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל עִמּוֹ

יא א אֶל־הַמַּחֲנֶה הַגִּלְגָּלָה: וַיְהִי כִּשְׁמֹעַ יָבִין מֶלֶךְ־
חָצוֹר וַיִּשְׁלַח אֶל־יוֹבָב מֶלֶךְ מָדוֹן וְאֶל־מֶלֶךְ שִׁמְרוֹן וְאֶל־מֶלֶךְ אַכְשָׁף:
ב וְאֶל־הַמְּלָכִים אֲשֶׁר מִצְּפוֹן בָּהָר וּבָעֲרָבָה נֶגֶב כִּנְרוֹת וּבַשְּׁפֵלָה
ג וּבְנָפוֹת דֹּאר מִיָּם: הַכְּנַעֲנִי מִמִּזְרֶח וּמִיָּם וְהָאֱמֹרִי וְהַחִתִּי וְהַפְּרִזִּי וְהַיְבוּסִי
ד בָּהָר וְהַחִוִּי תַּחַת חֶרְמוֹן בְּאֶרֶץ הַמִּצְפָּה: וַיֵּצְאוּ הֵם וְכָל־מַחֲנֵיהֶם עִמָּם
ה עָם־רָב כַּחוֹל אֲשֶׁר עַל־שְׂפַת־הַיָּם לָרֹב וְסוּס וָרֶכֶב רַב־מְאֹד: וַיִּוָּעֲדוּ
כֹּל הַמְּלָכִים הָאֵלֶּה וַיָּבֹאוּ וַיַּחֲנוּ יַחְדָּו אֶל־מֵי מֵרוֹם לְהִלָּחֵם עִם־
ו יִשְׂרָאֵל: וַיֹּאמֶר יהוה אֶל־יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אַל־תִּירָא
מִפְּנֵיהֶם כִּי־מָחָר כָּעֵת הַזֹּאת אָנֹכִי נֹתֵן אֶת־כֻּלָּם חֲלָלִים לִפְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל
ז אֶת־סוּסֵיהֶם תְּעַקֵּר וְאֶת־מַרְכְּבֹתֵיהֶם תִּשְׂרֹף בָּאֵשׁ: וַיָּבֹא יְהוֹשֻׁעַ
וְכָל־עַם הַמִּלְחָמָה עִמּוֹ עֲלֵיהֶם עַל־מֵי מֵרוֹם פִּתְאֹם וַיִּפְּלוּ בָּהֶם:
ח וַיִּתְּנֵם יהוה בְּיַד־יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיַּכּוּם וַיִּרְדְּפוּם עַד־צִידוֹן רַבָּה וְעַד מִשְׂרְפוֹת
מַיִם וְעַד־בִּקְעַת מִצְפֶּה מִזְרָחָה וַיַּכֻּם עַד־בִּלְתִּי הִשְׁאִיר־לָהֶם שָׂרִיד:
ט וַיַּעַשׂ לָהֶם יְהוֹשֻׁעַ כַּאֲשֶׁר אָמַר־לוֹ יהוה אֶת־סוּסֵיהֶם עִקֵּר וְאֶת־
י מַרְכְּבֹתֵיהֶם שָׂרַף בָּאֵשׁ: וַיָּשָׁב יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בָּעֵת הַהִיא
וַיִּלְכֹּד אֶת־חָצוֹר וְאֶת־מַלְכָּהּ הִכָּה בֶחָרֶב כִּי־חָצוֹר לְפָנִים הִיא
יא רֹאשׁ כָּל־הַמַּמְלָכוֹת הָאֵלֶּה: וַיַּכּוּ אֶת־כָּל־הַנֶּפֶשׁ אֲשֶׁר־בָּהּ לְפִי־חָרֶב
יב הַחֲרֵם לֹא נוֹתַר כָּל־נְשָׁמָה וְאֶת־חָצוֹר שָׂרַף בָּאֵשׁ: וְאֶת־כָּל־עָרֵי
הַמְּלָכִים הָאֵלֶּה וְאֶת־כָּל־מַלְכֵיהֶם לָכַד יְהוֹשֻׁעַ וַיַּכֵּם לְפִי־חָרֶב
יג הֶחֱרִים אוֹתָם כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּה מֹשֶׁה עֶבֶד יהוה: רַק כָּל־הֶעָרִים הָעֹמְדוֹת
עַל־תִּלָּם לֹא שְׂרָפָם יִשְׂרָאֵל זוּלָתִי אֶת־חָצוֹר לְבַדָּהּ שָׂרַף יְהוֹשֻׁעַ:
יד וְכָל שְׁלַל הֶעָרִים הָאֵלֶּה וְהַבְּהֵמָה בָּזְזוּ לָהֶם בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל רַק אֶת־
כָּל־הָאָדָם הִכּוּ לְפִי־חָרֶב עַד־הִשְׁמְדָם אוֹתָם לֹא הִשְׁאִירוּ כָּל־
טו נְשָׁמָה: כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּה יהוה אֶת־מֹשֶׁה עַבְדּוֹ כֵּן־צִוָּה מֹשֶׁה אֶת־יְהוֹשֻׁעַ
וְכֵן עָשָׂה יְהוֹשֻׁעַ לֹא־הֵסִיר דָּבָר מִכֹּל אֲשֶׁר־צִוָּה יהוה אֶת־מֹשֶׁה:

11:1. After the Israelites' success in their campaign against the Canaanites in the South, they turned to the final stage of their conquest — the northern Canaanite kingdoms. Again, Divine Providence assisted them, as

SUMMARY OF THE CONQUESTS 11:16-12:24

16 And Joshua took this entire land: the mountain and the entire South and the entire land of Goshen and the lowland and the Arabah and Mount Israel and its lowland. 17 From the split mountain that ascends to Seir, to the plain of Gad in the valley of the Lebanon at the foot of Mount Hermon; he conquered all their kings, struck them, and killed them.*

18 Joshua waged war with all these kings for a long time. 19 There was not a city that made peace with the Children of Israel except for the Hivvite inhabitants of Gibeon; they took everything in battle. 20 For it was from HASHEM, to harden their hearts toward battle against Israel, in order to destroy them — that they not find favor — so that they would be exterminated, as HASHEM had commanded Moses.

21 At that time Joshua came and cut down the Anakim from the mountain, from Hebron, from Debir, from Anab and from all the Mountains of Judah, and from all of Mount Israel; Joshua destroyed them with their cities. 22 No Anakim were left in the land of the Children of Israel; however, in Gaza, Gath, and Ashdod* they remained. 23 Thus, Joshua took the entire land, according to all that HASHEM had spoken to Moses. Joshua gave it to Israel as a heritage, according to their divisions, to their tribes. The land then rested from war.**

12

Moses' conquest: Sihon's territory (See Appendix D, map 1)

1 These are the kings of the land whom the Children of Israel smote and whose land they inherited on the other side of the Jordan, towards the rising sun, from the River Arnon to Mount Hermon and the entire plain to the east: 2 Sihon, king of the Amorite, who dwelled in Heshbon and who ruled from Aroer, that is on the edge of the River Arnon, and the middle of the river, and half of the Gilead, until the River Jabbok, the border of the Children of Ammon; 3 and the plain until the Kinnereth Sea to the east and until the sea of the plain, the Salt [Dead] Sea, to the east, the way to Beth-jeshimoth; and from the south under the falls of Pisgah. 4 And the boundary of Og, king of Bashan, who was a remnant of the giants, who lived in Ashtaroth and in Edrei, 5 and who reigned in Mount Hermon and Salcah, and in all of Bashan up to the border of the Geshurite and the Maacathite and half of the Gilead, [up to] the border of Sihon, king of Heshbon. 6 Moses, servant of HASHEM, and the Children of Israel defeated them; and Moses, servant of HASHEM, gave it as an inheritance to the Reubenite and to the Gadite and to half the tribe of Manasseh.*

Og's territory

Joshua's conquest (See Appendix D, map 3)

7 These are the kings of the land whom Joshua and the Children of Israel smote on the western side of the Jordan, from the plain of Gad in the Lebanon valley to the split mountain that ascends to Seir; Joshua gave it as an inheritance to the tribes of Israel according to their divisions, 8 in the mountain and in the lowland, in the plain and in [the land of] the waterfalls, and in the wilderness and in the South — the Hittite, the Amorite and the Canaanite, the Perizzite, the Hivvite and the Jebusite:

The thirty-one Canaanite kings

9 The king of Jericho, one;
the king of Ai, which was near Beth-el, one;
10 the king of Jerusalem, one;
the king of Hebron, one;

land was yet to be conquered. However, before his death, Joshua exhorted them to complete their occupation of the land or face disastrous consequences (Ch. 23).

12:1. The previous chapter ends with the conclusion of Joshua's battles, the close of the seven years of conquest and the beginning of the seven years of division. This chapter records all the territories that the Israelites had conquered until this time, under both Moses and Joshua.

טז וַיִּקַּח יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶת־כָּל־הָאָרֶץ הַזֹּאת הָהָר וְאֶת־כָּל־הַנֶּגֶב וְאֵת כָּל־אֶרֶץ
יז הַגֹּשֶׁן וְאֶת־הַשְּׁפֵלָה וְאֶת־הָעֲרָבָה וְאֶת־הַר יִשְׂרָאֵל וּשְׁפֵלָתוֹ: מִן־הָהָר
הֶחָלָק הָעוֹלֶה שֵׂעִיר וְעַד־בַּעַל־גָּד בְּבִקְעַת הַלְּבָנוֹן תַּחַת הַר־חֶרְמוֹן
יח וְאֶת כָּל־מַלְכֵיהֶם לָכַד וַיַּכֵּם וַיְמִיתֵם: יָמִים רַבִּים עָשָׂה יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶת־
יט כָּל־הַמְּלָכִים הָאֵלֶּה מִלְחָמָה: לֹא־הָיְתָה עִיר אֲשֶׁר הִשְׁלִימָה אֶל־בְּנֵי
כ יִשְׂרָאֵל בִּלְתִּי הַחִוִּי יֹשְׁבֵי גִבְעוֹן אֶת־הַכֹּל לָקָחוּ בַּמִּלְחָמָה: כִּי־מֵאֵת
יהוָה ׀ הָיְתָה לְחַזֵּק אֶת־לִבָּם לִקְרַאת הַמִּלְחָמָה אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל לְמַעַן
הַחֲרִימָם לְבִלְתִּי הֱיוֹת־לָהֶם תְּחִנָּה כִּי לְמַעַן הַשְׁמִידָם כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּה יהוה
כא אֶת־מֹשֶׁה: וַיָּבֹא יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בָּעֵת הַהִיא וַיַּכְרֵת אֶת־הָעֲנָקִים
מִן־הָהָר מִן־חֶבְרוֹן מִן־דְּבִר מִן־עֲנָב וּמִכֹּל הַר יְהוּדָה וּמִכֹּל הַר יִשְׂרָאֵל
כב עִם־עָרֵיהֶם הֶחֱרִימָם יְהוֹשֻׁעַ: לֹא־נוֹתַר עֲנָקִים בְּאֶרֶץ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל רַק
כג בְּעַזָּה בְּגַת וּבְאַשְׁדּוֹד נִשְׁאָרוּ: וַיִּקַּח יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶת־כָּל־הָאָרֶץ כְּכֹל אֲשֶׁר
דִּבֶּר יהוה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה וַיִּתְּנָהּ יְהוֹשֻׁעַ לְנַחֲלָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל כְּמַחְלְקֹתָם
יב ¶ לִשְׁבָטֵיהֶם וְהָאָרֶץ שָׁקְטָה מִמִּלְחָמָה: וְאֵלֶּה ׀ מַלְכֵי
הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר הִכּוּ בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיִּרְשׁוּ אֶת־אַרְצָם בְּעֵבֶר הַיַّרְדֵּן מִזְּרִחָה
ב הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ מִנַּחַל אַרְנוֹן עַד־הַר חֶרְמוֹן וְכָל־הָעֲרָבָה מִזְּרֶחָה: סִיחוֹן מֶלֶךְ
הָאֱמֹרִי הַיּוֹשֵׁב בְּחֶשְׁבּוֹן מֹשֵׁל מֵעֲרוֹעֵר אֲשֶׁר עַל־שְׂפַת־נַחַל אַרְנוֹן וְתוֹךְ
ג הַנַּחַל וַחֲצִי הַגִּלְעָד וְעַד יַבֹּק הַנַּחַל גְּבוּל בְּנֵי עַמּוֹן: וְהָעֲרָבָה עַד־יָם
כִּנְרוֹת מִזְרָחָה וְעַד יָם הָעֲרָבָה יָם־הַמֶּלַח מִזְרָחָה דֶּרֶךְ בֵּית הַיְשִׁמוֹת
ד וּמִתֵּימָן תַּחַת אַשְׁדֹּת הַפִּסְגָּה: וּגְבוּל עוֹג מֶלֶךְ הַבָּשָׁן מִיֶּתֶר הָרְפָאִים
ה הַיּוֹשֵׁב בְּעַשְׁתָּרוֹת וּבְאֶדְרֶעִי: וּמֹשֵׁל בְּהַר חֶרְמוֹן וּבְסַלְכָה וּבְכָל־הַבָּשָׁן
עַד־גְּבוּל הַגְּשׁוּרִי וְהַמַּעֲכָתִי וַחֲצִי הַגִּלְעָד גְּבוּל סִיחוֹן מֶלֶךְ־חֶשְׁבּוֹן:
ו מֹשֶׁה עֶבֶד־יהוה וּבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הִכּוּם וַיִּתְּנָהּ מֹשֶׁה עֶבֶד־יהוה יְרֻשָּׁה
ז לָרְאוּבֵנִי וְלַגָּדִי וְלַחֲצִי שֵׁבֶט הַמְנַשֶּׁה: וְאֵלֶּה מַלְכֵי
הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר הִכָּה יְהוֹשֻׁעַ וּבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּעֵבֶר הַיַّרְדֵּן יָמָּה מִבַּעַל גָּד
בְּבִקְעַת הַלְּבָנוֹן וְעַד־הָהָר הֶחָלָק הָעֹלֶה שֵׂעִירָה וַיִּתְּנָהּ יְהוֹשֻׁעַ לְשִׁבְטֵי
ח יִשְׂרָאֵל יְרֻשָּׁה כְּמַחְלְקֹתָם: בָּהָר וּבַשְּׁפֵלָה וּבָעֲרָבָה וּבָאֲשֵׁדוֹת וּבַמִּדְבָּר
וּבַנֶּגֶב הַחִתִּי הָאֱמֹרִי וְהַכְּנַעֲנִי הַפְּרִזִּי הַחִוִּי וְהַיְבוּסִי:
ט מֶלֶךְ יְרִיחוֹ אֶחָד
מֶלֶךְ הָעַי אֲשֶׁר־מִצַּד בֵּית־אֵל אֶחָד:
י מֶלֶךְ יְרוּשָׁלִַם אֶחָד
מֶלֶךְ חֶבְרוֹן אֶחָד:

11:16. The mountain was named for Jacob (Israel), who had lived there.

11:21. The Anakim were a family of giants that lived in the Hebron area and terrified all their opponents.

11:22. These were Philistine cities. Goliath, the giant slain by David, was from Gath (*I Samuel* 17:23).

11:23. When the Canaanites ceased their futile attempts at battle the Jews stopped the war, although much of the

11 the king of Jarmuth, one;
the king of Lachish, one;
12 the king of Eglon, one;
the king of Gezer, one;
13 the king of Debir, one;
the king of Geder, one;
14 the king of Hormah, one;
the king of Arad, one;
15 the king of Libnah, one;
the king of Adullam, one;
16 the king of Makkedah, one;
the king of Beth-el, one;
17 the king of Tappuah, one;
the king of Hepher, one;
18 the king of Aphek, one;
the king of the Sharon, one;
19 the king of Madon, one;
the king of Hazor, one;
20 the king of Shimron Meron, one;
the king of Achshaph, one;
21 the king of Taanach, one;
the king of Megiddo, one;
22 the king of Kedesh, one;
the king of Jokneam in the Carmel, one;
23 the king of Dor, of the district of Dor, one;
the king of Goiim in Gilgal, one;
24 the king of Tirzah, one;
all the kings, thirty-one.

13

DIVISION OF THE LAND
13:1-21:40
(See Appendix D, map 4)

1 Joshua was old, well on in years, and HASHEM said to him, "You have grown old, you are well on in years, and very much land still remains to be possessed. 2 This is the land that remains: all the districts of the Philistines and all the Geshurite [territory]; 3 from the Shihor that is before Egypt to the border of Ekron northward is considered to be the Canaanite's [territory]; the five governors of the Philistines, [who are] the Gazite and the Ashdodite and the Ashkelonite, the Gittite and the Ekronite; and the Avvites. 4 From the south: all the land of the Canaanite; Mearah that belongs to the Sidonians to Aphekah, until the border of the Amorite; 5 and the land of the Giblite, and all the Lebanon toward the rising sun — from the plain of Gad at the foot of Mount Hermon until the approach to Hamath; 6 all the inhabitants of the mountains,

יא מֶלֶךְ יַרְמוּת׳ אֶחָד
מֶלֶךְ לָכִישׁ אֶחָד:
יב מֶלֶךְ עֶגְלוֹן׳ אֶחָד
מֶלֶךְ גֶּזֶר אֶחָד:
יג מֶלֶךְ דְּבִר׳ אֶחָד
מֶלֶךְ גֶּדֶר אֶחָד:
יד מֶלֶךְ חָרְמָה׳ אֶחָד
מֶלֶךְ עֲרָד אֶחָד:
טו מֶלֶךְ לִבְנָה׳ אֶחָד
מֶלֶךְ עֲדֻלָּם אֶחָד:
טז מֶלֶךְ מַקֵּדָה׳ אֶחָד
מֶלֶךְ בֵּית־אֵל אֶחָד:
יז מֶלֶךְ תַּפּוּחַ׳ אֶחָד
מֶלֶךְ חֵפֶר אֶחָד:
יח מֶלֶךְ אֲפֵק אֶחָד
מֶלֶךְ לַשָּׁרוֹן אֶחָד:
יט מֶלֶךְ מָדוֹן׳ אֶחָד
מֶלֶךְ חָצוֹר אֶחָד:
כ מֶלֶךְ שִׁמְרוֹן מְרוֹן׳ אֶחָד
מֶלֶךְ אַכְשָׁף אֶחָד:
כא מֶלֶךְ תַּעֲנַךְ׳ אֶחָד
מֶלֶךְ מְגִדּוֹ אֶחָד:
כב מֶלֶךְ קֶדֶשׁ אֶחָד
מֶלֶךְ־יָקְנְעָם לַכַּרְמֶל אֶחָד:
כג מֶלֶךְ דֹּר לְנָפַת דּוֹר אֶחָד
מֶלֶךְ־גּוֹיִם לְגִלְגָּל אֶחָד:
כד מֶלֶךְ תִּרְצָה אֶחָד
כָּל־מְלָכִים שְׁלֹשִׁים וְאֶחָד:

יג א וִיהוֹשֻׁעַ זָקֵן בָּא בַּיָּמִים וַיֹּאמֶר יהוה אֵלָיו אַתָּה זָקַנְתָּה בָּאתָ בַּיָּמִים וְהָאָרֶץ
ב נִשְׁאָרָה הַרְבֵּה־מְאֹד לְרִשְׁתָּהּ׃ זֹאת הָאָרֶץ הַנִּשְׁאָרֶת כָּל־גְּלִילוֹת
ג הַפְּלִשְׁתִּים וְכָל־הַגְּשׁוּרִי׃ מִן־הַשִּׁיחוֹר אֲשֶׁר ׀ עַל־פְּנֵי מִצְרַיִם וְעַד גְּבוּל
עֶקְרוֹן צָפוֹנָה לַכְּנַעֲנִי תֵּחָשֵׁב חֲמֵשֶׁת ׀ סַרְנֵי פְּלִשְׁתִּים הָעַזָּתִי וְהָאַשְׁדּוֹדִי
ד הָאֶשְׁקְלוֹנִי הַגִּתִּי וְהָעֶקְרוֹנִי וְהָעַוִּים׃ מִתֵּימָן כָּל־אֶרֶץ הַכְּנַעֲנִי וּמְעָרָה
ה אֲשֶׁר לַצִּידֹנִים עַד־אֲפֵקָה עַד גְּבוּל הָאֱמֹרִי׃ וְהָאָרֶץ הַגִּבְלִי וְכָל־הַלְּבָנוֹן
ו מִזְרַח הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ מִבַּעַל גָּד תַּחַת הַר־חֶרְמוֹן עַד לְבוֹא חֲמָת׃ כָּל־יֹשְׁבֵי הָהָר

from the Lebanon to Misrephoth-maim — all the Sidonians — I will drive them out on behalf of the Children of Israel. You have only to allot it to Israel as a heritage, as I have commanded you. [7] *So now, divide this land as a heritage for the nine tribes and half the tribe of Manasseh."*

The boundaries of trans-Jordan (See Appendix D, map 1)

With it, the Reubenite and the Gadite took their heritage that Moses had given them on the eastern side of the Jordan, according to that which Moses, servant of HASHEM, had given them.* [9] *From Aroer that is on the edge of the River Arnon and the city that is in the middle of the river — the entire plain from Medeba to Dibon;* [10] *and all the cities of Sihon, the king of the Amorite, who ruled in Heshbon to the border of the Children of Ammon;* [11] *and Gilead, and the border of the Geshurite and the Maacathite, all of Mount Hermon, and all of Bashan to Salcah;* [12] *the entire kingdom of Og in Bashan who ruled in Ashtaroth and in Edrei; it is he who remained from the remnant of the giants — Moses defeated them and drove them out.* [13] *But the Children of Israel did not drive out the Geshurite and the Maacathite, rather the Geshurite and Maacathite dwell in the midst of Israel until this day.* [14] *To the tribe of Levi, however, he did not give a heritage; the fire-offerings of HASHEM, the God of Israel, are his heritage, as He had spoken to him.**

Reuben's territory

[15] *Moses gave to the tribe of the children of Reuben according to their families.* [16] *Their border was from Aroer that is on the edge of the River Arnon and the city that is in the middle of the river and all the plain to Medeba;* [17] *Heshbon and all its cities that are in the plain — Dibon and Bamoth-baal and Beth-baal-meon;* [18] *and Jahaz and Kedemoth and Mephaath;* [19] *and Kiriathaim and Sibmah and Zeres-hashahar on the mount of the valley;* [20] *and Beth-peor and the falls of Pisgah and Beth-jeshimoth;* [21] *and all the cities of the plain; and all the kingdom of Sihon, king of the Amorite, who ruled in Heshbon, whom Moses had smitten: him and the princes of Midian — Evi and Rekem and Zur and Hur and Reba — dukes of Sihon, the inhabitants of the land.* [22] *The Children of Israel slayed Balaam son of Beor, the sorcerer, with the sword, along with their [other] slain.* [23] *The border of the children of Reuben was the Jordan and its border.* This was the inheritance of the children of Reuben, according to their families — the cities and their villages.*

Gad's territory

[24] *Moses also gave to the tribe of Gad, to the children of Gad, according to their families.* [25] *Their border was Jazer, and all the cities of Gilead, and half the land of the Children of Ammon, to Aroer, which is before Rabbah;* [26] *and from Heshbon to Ramath-hamizpeh and Betonim; and from Mahanaim to the border toward Debir.* [27] *And in the valley: Beth-haram and Beth-nimrah and Succoth and Zaphon — the rest of the kingdom of Sihon, king of Heshbon — the Jordan and its border, to the shore of the Kinnereth Sea on the eastern side of the Jordan.* [28] *This is the heritage of the children of Gad according to their families — the cities and their villages.*

Manasseh's territory

[29] *Moses also gave to half the tribe of Manasseh; and it was for half of the tribe of the children of Manasseh according to their families.* [30] *Their boundary was from Mahanaim, all the Bashan, all the kingdom of Og, king of Bashan, and all of Havvoth-jair in Bashan — sixty cities;* [31] *and half of the Gilead, and Ashtaroth and Edrei — the royal cities of Og in Bashan — were given to the children of Machir son of Manasseh, to half the children of Machir, according to their families.* [32] *These are the ones to whom Moses distributed inheritances in the plains*

מִן־הַלְּבָנוֹן עַד־מִשְׂרְפֹת מַיִם כָּל־צִידֹנִים אָנֹכִי אוֹרִישֵׁם מִפְּנֵי בְּנֵי
ז יִשְׂרָאֵל רַק הַפִּלֶּהָ לְיִשְׂרָאֵל בְּנַחֲלָה כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוִּיתִיךָ: וְעַתָּה חַלֵּק אֶת־
ח הָאָרֶץ הַזֹּאת בְּנַחֲלָה לְתִשְׁעַת הַשְּׁבָטִים וַחֲצִי הַשֵּׁבֶט הַמְנַשֶּׁה: עִמּוֹ
הָרְאוּבֵנִי וְהַגָּדִי לָקְחוּ נַחֲלָתָם אֲשֶׁר נָתַן לָהֶם מֹשֶׁה בְּעֵבֶר הַיַּרְדֵּן מִזְּרָחָה
ט כַּאֲשֶׁר נָתַן לָהֶם מֹשֶׁה עֶבֶד יהוה: מֵעֲרוֹעֵר אֲשֶׁר עַל־שְׂפַת־נַחַל אַרְנוֹן
י וְהָעִיר אֲשֶׁר בְּתוֹךְ־הַנַּחַל וְכָל־הַמִּישֹׁר מֵידְבָא עַד־דִּיבוֹן: וְכֹל עָרֵי
יא סִיחוֹן מֶלֶךְ הָאֱמֹרִי אֲשֶׁר מָלַךְ בְּחֶשְׁבּוֹן עַד־גְּבוּל בְּנֵי עַמּוֹן: וְהַגִּלְעָד
יב וּגְבוּל הַגְּשׁוּרִי וְהַמַּעֲכָתִי וְכֹל הַר חֶרְמוֹן וְכָל־הַבָּשָׁן עַד־סַלְכָה: כָּל־
מַמְלְכוּת עוֹג בַּבָּשָׁן אֲשֶׁר־מָלַךְ בְּעַשְׁתָּרוֹת וּבְאֶדְרֶעִי הוּא נִשְׁאַר מִיֶּתֶר
יג הָרְפָאִים וַיַּכֵּם מֹשֶׁה וַיֹּרִשֵׁם: וְלֹא הוֹרִישׁוּ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת־הַגְּשׁוּרִי וְאֶת־
יד הַמַּעֲכָתִי וַיֵּשֶׁב גְּשׁוּר וּמַעֲכָת בְּקֶרֶב יִשְׂרָאֵל עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה: רַק לְשֵׁבֶט
הַלֵּוִי לֹא נָתַן נַחֲלָה אִשֵּׁי יהוה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הוּא נַחֲלָתוֹ כַּאֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר־
טו־טז לוֹ: וַיִּתֵּן מֹשֶׁה לְמַטֵּה בְּנֵי־רְאוּבֵן לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם: וַיְהִי לָהֶם הַגְּבוּל
מֵעֲרוֹעֵר אֲשֶׁר עַל־שְׂפַת־נַחַל אַרְנוֹן וְהָעִיר אֲשֶׁר בְּתוֹךְ־הַנַּחַל וְכָל־
יז הַמִּישֹׁר עַל־מֵידְבָא: חֶשְׁבּוֹן וְכָל־עָרֶיהָ אֲשֶׁר בַּמִּישֹׁר דִּיבוֹן וּבָמוֹת בַּעַל
יח־יט וּבֵית בַּעַל מְעוֹן: וַיַּהְצָה וּקְדֵמֹת וּמֵפָעַת: וְקִרְיָתַיִם וְשִׁבְמָה וְצֶרֶת הַשַּׁחַר
כ־כא בְּהַר הָעֵמֶק: וּבֵית פְּעוֹר וְאַשְׁדוֹת הַפִּסְגָּה וּבֵית הַיְשִׁמוֹת: וְכֹל עָרֵי
הַמִּישֹׁר וְכָל־מַמְלְכוּת סִיחוֹן מֶלֶךְ הָאֱמֹרִי אֲשֶׁר מָלַךְ בְּחֶשְׁבּוֹן אֲשֶׁר
הִכָּה מֹשֶׁה אֹתוֹ | וְאֶת־נְשִׂיאֵי מִדְיָן אֶת־אֱוִי וְאֶת־רֶקֶם וְאֶת־צוּר וְאֶת־
כב חוּר וְאֶת־רֶבַע נְסִיכֵי סִיחוֹן יֹשְׁבֵי הָאָרֶץ: וְאֶת־בִּלְעָם בֶּן־בְּעוֹר הַקּוֹסֵם
כג הָרְגוּ בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל בַּחֶרֶב אֶל־חַלְלֵיהֶם: וַיְהִי גְּבוּל בְּנֵי רְאוּבֵן הַיַּרְדֵּן וּגְבוּל
כד זֹאת נַחֲלַת בְּנֵי־רְאוּבֵן לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם הֶעָרִים וְחַצְרֵיהֶן: וַיִּתֵּן
כה מֹשֶׁה לְמַטֵּה גָד לִבְנֵי גָד לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם: וַיְהִי לָהֶם הַגְּבוּל יַעְזֵר וְכָל־עָרֵי
כו הַגִּלְעָד וַחֲצִי אֶרֶץ בְּנֵי עַמּוֹן עַד־עֲרוֹעֵר אֲשֶׁר עַל־פְּנֵי רַבָּה: וּמֵחֶשְׁבּוֹן
כז עַד־רָמַת הַמִּצְפֶּה וּבְטֹנִים וּמִמַּחֲנַיִם עַד־גְּבוּל לִדְבִר: וּבָעֵמֶק בֵּית הָרָם
וּבֵית נִמְרָה וְסֻכּוֹת וְצָפוֹן יֶתֶר מַמְלְכוּת סִיחוֹן מֶלֶךְ חֶשְׁבּוֹן הַיַּרְדֵּן וּגְבֻל
כח עַד־קְצֵה יָם־כִּנֶּרֶת עֵבֶר הַיַּרְדֵּן מִזְרָחָה: זֹאת נַחֲלַת בְּנֵי־גָד לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם
כט הֶעָרִים וַחֲצֵרֵיהֶם: וַיִּתֵּן מֹשֶׁה לַחֲצִי שֵׁבֶט מְנַשֶּׁה וַיְהִי לַחֲצִי
ל מַטֵּה בְנֵי־מְנַשֶּׁה לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם: וַיְהִי גְבוּלָם מִמַּחֲנַיִם כָּל־הַבָּשָׁן כָּל־
לא מַמְלְכוּת | עוֹג מֶלֶךְ־הַבָּשָׁן וְכָל־חַוֹּת יָאִיר אֲשֶׁר בַּבָּשָׁן שִׁשִּׁים עִיר: וַחֲצִי
הַגִּלְעָד וַעַשְׁתָּרוֹת וְאֶדְרֶעִי עָרֵי מַמְלְכוּת עוֹג בַּבָּשָׁן לִבְנֵי מָכִיר בֶּן־
לב מְנַשֶּׁה לַחֲצִי בְנֵי־מָכִיר לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם: אֵלֶּה אֲשֶׁר־נָחַל מֹשֶׁה בְּעַרְבוֹת

13:8. I.e., with the other half of Manasseh, which took its allotment east of the Jordan.
13:14. See *Numbers* 18:20.
13:23. That is, the Jordan and the towns along its banks (*Radak*).

of Moab, on the eastern side of the Jordan, across from Jericho.

33 *But to the tribe of Levi, Moses gave no heritage; HASHEM, the God of Israel, is their heritage, as He had spoken to them.*

14

The division of Canaan
(See Appendix D, map 5)

1 *These are [the areas] that the Children of Israel inherited in the land of Canaan, which were distributed to them as heritages — by Elazar the Kohen and Joshua son of Nun and the heads of the ancestral [families] of the tribes of the Children of Israel — 2 by the lottery of their inheritance, as HASHEM had commanded through Moses, for the nine tribes and the half tribe. 3 For Moses had given the heritage of the two tribes and the half tribe across the Jordan, but to the Levites he had given no heritage among them. 4 The children of Joseph, however, were two tribes,* Manasseh and Ephraim. They gave no share to the Levites in the land, only cities for dwelling and their open land around them for their cattle and their flocks. 5 As HASHEM had commanded Moses, so the Children of Israel did, and they divided the land.*

Caleb's request

6 *The Children of Judah approached Joshua in Gilgal, and Caleb son of Jephunneh the Kenizzite said to him, "You are aware of the matter that HASHEM told Moses, the man of God, concerning me and concerning you in Kadesh-barnea.* 7 I was forty years old when Moses, the servant of HASHEM, sent me from Kadesh-barnea to spy out the land, and I brought him back a report as was in my heart. 8 My brethren who went up with me shattered the heart of the people, but I fulfilled [the will of] HASHEM, my God. 9 Moses swore on that day, saying, 'Surely the land on which your foot trod will be to you as a heritage, and to your children forever, because you fulfilled [the will of] HASHEM, my God.' 10 And now, behold — HASHEM has kept me alive as He had spoken, these forty-five years, from the time HASHEM spoke this word to Moses when Israel went in the Wilderness; and now, behold, I am eighty-five years old today. 11 I am still as strong today as I was on the day that Moses sent me. As my strength was then, so my strength is now for war — to go out and to come in.* 12 So now, give me this mountain of which HASHEM spoke on that day, because you heard on that day that the Anakim were there and that the cities were large and fortified. Perhaps HASHEM will be with me, and I will drive them out, as HASHEM had spoken."*

Joshua gives Hebron to Caleb

13 *Joshua blessed him and gave Hebron to Caleb son of Jephunneh as a heritage. 14 Therefore, Hebron became the heritage of Caleb son of Jephunneh the Kenizzite to this day, because he fulfilled the will of HASHEM, God of Israel. 15 The name of Hebron was formerly Kiriath-arba,* who was the biggest man among the Anakim. Then the land had rest from war.*

15

JUDAH'S TERRITORY
15:1-63

Judah's southern border

1 *The lot for the tribe of the children of Judah according to their families was:* up to the border of Edom, the Wilderness of Zin southward, at the southernmost edge. 2 Their southern border was from the edge of the Dead Sea from the tip that faces south. 3 It went out to the south of Maaleh-akrabbim, passed to Zin, ascended to the south of Kadesh-barnea, passed Hezron, ascended toward Addar, and circled Karka.*

15:1. This chapter gives the borders and cities of Judah in minute detail, a thoroughness that characterizes approximately one-third of the *Book of Joshua*. The Talmud states that had the Israelites not sinned, only six books would have been included in Scripture — the *Five Books of Moses* and the *Book of Joshua* (*Nedarim* 22b). Joshua would have been included because it details the inheritance of each tribe (*Rashi*), and thus the exact borders of the Land of Israel, which must be known precisely since certain *mitzvos* can be performed only in the land.

לג מוֹאָב מֵעֵבֶר לְיַרְדֵּן יְרִיחוֹ מִזְרָחָה׃ וּלְשֵׁבֶט הַלֵּוִי לֹא־נָתַן מֹשֶׁה נַחֲלָה

יד א יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הוּא נַחֲלָתָם כַּאֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר לָהֶם׃ וְאֵלֶּה אֲשֶׁר־נָחֲלוּ
בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּאֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן אֲשֶׁר נָחֲלוּ אוֹתָם אֶלְעָזָר הַכֹּהֵן וִיהוֹשֻׁעַ בִּן־נוּן
ב וְרָאשֵׁי אָבוֹת הַמַּטּוֹת לִבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל׃ בְּגוֹרָל נַחֲלָתָם כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּה יהוה
ג בְּיַד־מֹשֶׁה לְתִשְׁעַת הַמַּטּוֹת וַחֲצִי הַמַּטֶּה׃ כִּי־נָתַן מֹשֶׁה נַחֲלַת שְׁנֵי
ד הַמַּטּוֹת וַחֲצִי הַמַּטֶּה מֵעֵבֶר לַיַּרְדֵּן וְלַלְוִיִּם לֹא־נָתַן נַחֲלָה בְּתוֹכָם׃ כִּי־
הָיוּ בְנֵי־יוֹסֵף שְׁנֵי מַטּוֹת מְנַשֶּׁה וְאֶפְרָיִם וְלֹא־נָתְנוּ חֵלֶק לַלְוִיִּם בָּאָרֶץ כִּי
ה אִם־עָרִים לָשֶׁבֶת וּמִגְרְשֵׁיהֶם לְמִקְנֵיהֶם וּלְקִנְיָנָם׃ כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּה יהוה אֶת־
ו מֹשֶׁה כֵּן עָשׂוּ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיַּחְלְקוּ אֶת־הָאָרֶץ׃ וַיִּגְּשׁוּ בְּנֵי־
יְהוּדָה אֶל־יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בַּגִּלְגָּל וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלָיו כָּלֵב בֶּן־יְפֻנֶּה הַקְּנִזִּי אַתָּה יָדַעְתָּ
אֶת־הַדָּבָר אֲשֶׁר־דִּבֶּר יהוה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה אִישׁ־הָאֱלֹהִים עַל אֹדוֹתַי וְעַל
ז אֹדוֹתֶיךָ בְּקָדֵשׁ בַּרְנֵעַ׃ בֶּן־אַרְבָּעִים שָׁנָה אָנֹכִי בְּשִׁלְּחַ מֹשֶׁה עֶבֶד־יהוה
אֹתִי מִקָּדֵשׁ בַּרְנֵעַ לְרַגֵּל אֶת־הָאָרֶץ וָאָשֵׁב אֹתוֹ דָבָר כַּאֲשֶׁר עִם־לְבָבִי׃
ח וְאַחַי אֲשֶׁר עָלוּ עִמִּי הִמְסִיּוּ אֶת־לֵב הָעָם וְאָנֹכִי מִלֵּאתִי אַחֲרֵי יהוה
ט אֱלֹהָי׃ וַיִּשָּׁבַע מֹשֶׁה בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא לֵאמֹר אִם־לֹא הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר דָּרְכָה רַגְלְךָ
בָּהּ לְךָ תִהְיֶה לְנַחֲלָה וּלְבָנֶיךָ עַד־עוֹלָם כִּי מִלֵּאתָ אַחֲרֵי יהוה אֱלֹהָי׃
י וְעַתָּה הִנֵּה הֶחֱיָה יהוה ו אוֹתִי כַּאֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר זֶה אַרְבָּעִים וְחָמֵשׁ שָׁנָה מֵאָז
דִּבֶּר יהוה אֶת־הַדָּבָר הַזֶּה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה אֲשֶׁר־הָלַךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל בַּמִּדְבָּר וְעַתָּה
יא הִנֵּה אָנֹכִי הַיּוֹם בֶּן־חָמֵשׁ וּשְׁמוֹנִים שָׁנָה׃ עוֹדֶנִּי הַיּוֹם חָזָק כַּאֲשֶׁר בְּיוֹם
יב שְׁלֹחַ אוֹתִי מֹשֶׁה כְּכֹחִי אָז וּכְכֹחִי עָתָּה לַמִּלְחָמָה וְלָצֵאת וְלָבוֹא׃ וְעַתָּה
תְּנָה־לִּי אֶת־הָהָר הַזֶּה אֲשֶׁר־דִּבֶּר יהוה בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא כִּי־אַתָּה שָׁמַעְתָּ
בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא כִּי־עֲנָקִים שָׁם וְעָרִים גְּדֹלוֹת בְּצֻרוֹת אוּלַי יהוה אוֹתִי
יג וְהוֹרַשְׁתִּים כַּאֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר יהוה׃ וַיְבָרְכֵהוּ יְהוֹשֻׁעַ וַיִּתֵּן אֶת־חֶבְרוֹן לְכָלֵב
יד בֶּן־יְפֻנֶּה לְנַחֲלָה׃ עַל־כֵּן הָיְתָה־חֶבְרוֹן לְכָלֵב בֶּן־יְפֻנֶּה הַקְּנִזִּי לְנַחֲלָה
טו עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה יַעַן אֲשֶׁר מִלֵּא אַחֲרֵי יהוה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל׃ וְשֵׁם חֶבְרוֹן
לְפָנִים קִרְיַת אַרְבַּע הָאָדָם הַגָּדוֹל בָּעֲנָקִים הוּא וְהָאָרֶץ שָׁקְטָה

טו ■ מִמִּלְחָמָה׃ וַיְהִי הַגּוֹרָל לְמַטֵּה בְּנֵי יְהוּדָה לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם אֶל־
ב גְּבוּל אֱדוֹם מִדְבַּר־צִן נֶגְבָּה מִקְצֵה תֵימָן׃ וַיְהִי לָהֶם גְּבוּל נֶגֶב מִקְצֵה יָם
ג הַמֶּלַח מִן־הַלָּשׁוֹן הַפֹּנָה נֶגְבָּה׃ וְיָצָא אֶל־מִנֶּגֶב לְמַעֲלֵה עַקְרַבִּים וְעָבַר
צִנָּה וְעָלָה מִנֶּגֶב לְקָדֵשׁ בַּרְנֵעַ וְעָבַר חֶצְרוֹן וְעָלָה אַדָּרָה וְנָסַב הַקַּרְקָעָה׃

14:4. Although Levi was excluded from the division of the land, the grand total of tribal territories was twelve, because Joseph's two sons were treated as tribes.

14:6. Before any of the territories in Eretz Yisrael had been allocated to the tribes, Caleb, one of the twelve spies sent by Moses (see *Numbers* Ch. 13), asked Joshua for the city of Hebron, which Moses had promised him. The leaders of Judah accompanied Caleb in ■ show of support for his claim. (See also *Numbers* 14:24, 30.)

14:11. That is, to lead the people out to battle and to lead them back home safely.

14:15. Literally, "City of Arba," i.e., the city was named for Arba, the tallest of the Anakim.

The eastern border (See Appendix D, map 2)

4 It passed to Azmon and went out to the Brook of Egypt; the border's outlets
were to the Sea. This shall be your southern border. 5 The eastern border was
from the Salt Sea to the end of the Jordan. The border on the northern side
stretched from the tip of the Sea at the end of the Jordan River; 6 the border
ascended to Beth-haglah and passed to the north of Beth-haarabah; the border
ascended to the Stone of Bohan son of Reuben. 7 The border ascended toward
Debir from the Valley of Achor and northward facing Gilgal which is opposite
Maaleh-adummim, which is south of the valley. The border passed to the waters
of En-shemesh and its outlets were into En-rogel. ¶ The border ascended by the
Valley of the Son of Hinnom to the southern shoulder of the Jebusite, which is
Jerusalem. The border ascended to the top of the mountain that faces the Valley
of Hinnom on the west, which is at the northern edge of the Valley of Rephaim.
9 The border curved from the top of the mountain to the spring of the Waters of
Nephtoah and went out to the cities of Mount Ephron. The border curved toward

The northern border

Baalah, which is Kiriath-jearim. 10 The border went around from Baalah to the
west to Mount Seir and passed to the flank of Mount Jearim from the north,
which is Chesalon. It descended to Beth-shemesh and passed Timnah. 11 The
border went out to the flank of Ekron to the north; the border curved toward
Shicron, passed Mount Baalah, and went out to Jabneel; the border's outlets

The western border

were to the Sea. 12 The western border was the Great Sea and its border. * This
is the border of the children of Judah all around, according to their families.

Caleb's inheritance

13 To Caleb son of Jephunneh he gave a portion among the Children of Judah
in accordance with HASHEM's word to Joshua — Kiriath-arba, * the father of the
Anakim, which is Hebron. 14 Caleb drove out the three sons of the Anak from
there — Sheshai and Ahiman, and Talmai, the offspring of the Anak. 15 He
ascended from there to the inhabitants of Debir; the former name of Debir was
Kiriath-sefer. 16 Caleb said, "Whoever smites Kiriath-sefer and conquers it, I shall
give him my daughter Achsah as a wife."

17 Othniel son of Kenaz, brother* of Caleb, conquered it; so he gave him his
daughter Achsah as a wife. 18 When she came [to him], she urged him to let her
ask her father for a field. Then she slid off the donkey, * and Caleb said to her,
"What do you wish?" 19 She said, "Give me a [source of] blessing, for you have
given me an arid land; give me springs of water." So he gave her the upper
springs and the lower springs.

Judah's southern cities

20 This is the heritage of the tribe of the children of Judah according to their
families. 21 The cities at the extremity of [the territory of] the tribe of the children
of Judah at the border of Edom in the south were: Kabzeal, Eder, Jagur,
22 Kinah, Dimonah, Ad'adah, 23 Kedesh, Hazor, Ithnan, 24 Ziph, Telem, Bealoth,
25 Hazor, Hadattah, Kerioth, Hezron which is Hazor, 26 Amam, Shema,
Moladah, 27 Hazar-gaddah, Heshmon, Beth-pelet, 28 Hazar-shual, Beer-sheba,
Biziothiah, 29 Baalah, Iim, Ezem, 30 Eltolad, Chesil, Hormah, 31 Ziklag, Madmannah, Sansannah, 32 Lebaoth, Shilhim, Ain, Rimmon — all the cities twenty-
nine, * and their villages.

The lowland

33 In the lowland: Eshtaol, Zorah, Ashnah, 34 Zanoah, En-gannim, Tapuah,
Enam, 35 Jarmuth, Adullam, Socoh, Azekah; 36 Shaaraim, Adithaim, Haged-
erah [which is] Gederothaim — fourteen cities and their villages.

Beer-sheba, Moladah, Hazar-shual, Ezem, Eltolad, Hormah, Ziklag, Ain, Rimmon — were eventually given to Simeon (see 19:2-7). Thus, Judah retained twenty-nine of these cities (*Rashi*).

ד וְעָבַר עַצְמוֹנָה וְיָצָא נַחַל מִצְרַיִם °והיה [°וְהָיוּ ק] תֹּצְאוֹת הַגְּבוּל יָמָּה
ה זֶה־יִהְיֶה לָכֶם גְּבוּל נֶגֶב: וּגְבוּל קֵדְמָה יָם הַמֶּלַח עַד־קְצֵה הַיַּרְדֵּן וּגְבוּל
ו לִפְאַת צָפוֹנָה מִלְּשׁוֹן הַיָּם מִקְצֵה הַיַּרְדֵּן: וְעָלָה הַגְּבוּל בֵּית חָגְלָה וְעָבַר
ז מִצָּפוֹן לְבֵית הָעֲרָבָה וְעָלָה הַגְּבוּל אֶבֶן בֹּהַן בֶּן־רְאוּבֵן: וְעָלָה הַגְּבוּל ו
דְּבִרָה מֵעֵמֶק עָכוֹר וְצָפוֹנָה פֹּנֶה אֶל־הַגִּלְגָּל אֲשֶׁר־נֹכַח לְמַעֲלֵה אֲדֻמִּים
אֲשֶׁר מִנֶּגֶב לַנַּחַל וְעָבַר הַגְּבוּל אֶל־מֵי עֵין־שֶׁמֶשׁ וְהָיוּ תֹצְאֹתָיו אֶל־עֵין
ח רֹגֵל: וְעָלָה הַגְּבוּל גֵּי בֶן־הִנֹּם אֶל־כֶּתֶף הַיְבוּסִי מִנֶּגֶב הִיא יְרוּשָׁלִָם וְעָלָה
הַגְּבוּל אֶל־רֹאשׁ הָהָר אֲשֶׁר עַל־פְּנֵי גֵי־הִנֹּם יָמָּה אֲשֶׁר בִּקְצֵה עֵמֶק־
ט רְפָאִים צָפֹנָה: וְתָאַר הַגְּבוּל מֵרֹאשׁ הָהָר אֶל־מַעְיַן מֵי נֶפְתּוֹחַ וְיָצָא אֶל־
י עָרֵי הַר־עֶפְרוֹן וְתָאַר הַגְּבוּל בַּעֲלָה הִיא קִרְיַת יְעָרִים: וְנָסַב הַגְּבוּל
מִבַּעֲלָה יָמָּה אֶל־הַר שֵׂעִיר וְעָבַר אֶל־כֶּתֶף הַר־יְעָרִים מִצָּפוֹנָה הִיא
יא כְסָלוֹן וְיָרַד בֵּית־שֶׁמֶשׁ וְעָבַר תִּמְנָה: וְיָצָא הַגְּבוּל אֶל־כֶּתֶף עֶקְרוֹן צָפוֹנָה
וְתָאַר הַגְּבוּל שִׁכְּרוֹנָה וְעָבַר הַר־הַבַּעֲלָה וְיָצָא יַבְנְאֵל וְהָיוּ תֹצְאוֹת
יב הַגְּבוּל יָמָּה: וּגְבוּל יָם הַיָּמָּה הַגָּדוֹל וּגְבוּל זֶה גְּבוּל בְּנֵי־יְהוּדָה סָבִיב
יג לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם: וּלְכָלֵב בֶּן־יְפֻנֶּה נָתַן חֵלֶק בְּתוֹךְ בְּנֵי־יְהוּדָה אֶל־פִּי יְהוָה
יד לִיהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶת־קִרְיַת אַרְבַּע אֲבִי הָעֲנָק הִיא חֶבְרוֹן: וַיָּרֶשׁ מִשָּׁם כָּלֵב אֶת־
טו שְׁלוֹשָׁה בְּנֵי הָעֲנָק אֶת־שֵׁשַׁי וְאֶת־אֲחִימָן וְאֶת־תַּלְמַי יְלִידֵי הָעֲנָק: וַיַּעַל
טז מִשָּׁם אֶל־יֹשְׁבֵי דְּבִר וְשֵׁם־דְּבִר לְפָנִים קִרְיַת־סֵפֶר: וַיֹּאמֶר כָּלֵב אֲשֶׁר־
יז יַכֶּה אֶת־קִרְיַת־סֵפֶר וּלְכָדָהּ וְנָתַתִּי לוֹ אֶת־עַכְסָה בִתִּי לְאִשָּׁה: וַיִּלְכְּדָהּ
יח עָתְנִיאֵל בֶּן־קְנַז אֲחִי כָלֵב וַיִּתֶּן־לוֹ אֶת־עַכְסָה בִתּוֹ לְאִשָּׁה: וַיְהִי בְּבוֹאָהּ
וַתְּסִיתֵהוּ לִשְׁאוֹל מֵאֵת־אָבִיהָ שָׂדֶה וַתִּצְנַח מֵעַל הַחֲמוֹר וַיֹּאמֶר־לָהּ
יט כָּלֵב מַה־לָּךְ: וַתֹּאמֶר תְּנָה־לִּי בְרָכָה כִּי אֶרֶץ הַנֶּגֶב נְתַתָּנִי וְנָתַתָּה לִּי גֻּלֹּת
כ מָיִם וַיִּתֶּן־לָהּ אֵת גֻּלֹּת עִלִּיּוֹת וְאֵת גֻּלֹּת תַּחְתִּיּוֹת: זאת
כא נַחֲלַת מַטֵּה בְנֵי־יְהוּדָה לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם: וַיִּהְיוּ הֶעָרִים מִקְצֵה לְמַטֵּה בְנֵי־
כב יְהוּדָה אֶל־גְּבוּל אֱדוֹם בַּנֶּגְבָּה קַבְצְאֵל וְעֵדֶר וְיָגוּר: וְקִינָה וְדִימוֹנָה
כג־כה וְעַדְעָדָה: וְקֶדֶשׁ וְחָצוֹר וְיִתְנָן: זִיף וָטֶלֶם וּבְעָלוֹת: וְחָצוֹר ו חֲדַתָּה וּקְרִיּוֹת
כו־כז חֶצְרוֹן הִיא חָצוֹר: אֲמָם וּשְׁמַע וּמוֹלָדָה: וַחֲצַר גַּדָּה וְחֶשְׁמוֹן וּבֵית פָּלֶט:
כח־ל וַחֲצַר שׁוּעָל וּבְאֵר שֶׁבַע וּבִזְיוֹתְיָה: בַּעֲלָה וְעִיִּים וָעֶצֶם: וְאֶלְתּוֹלַד וּכְסִיל
לא־לב וְחָרְמָה: וְצִקְלַג וּמַדְמַנָּה וְסַנְסַנָּה: וּלְבָאוֹת וְשִׁלְחִים וְעַיִן וְרִמּוֹן כָּל־עָרִים
לג עֶשְׂרִים וָתֵשַׁע וְחַצְרֵיהֶן: בַּשְּׁפֵלָה אֶשְׁתָּאוֹל וְצָרְעָה וְאַשְׁנָה:
לד־לו וְזָנוֹחַ וְעֵין גַּנִּים תַּפּוּחַ וְהָעֵינָם: יַרְמוּת וַעֲדֻלָּם שוֹכֹה וַעֲזֵקָה: וְשַׁעֲרַיִם
לז וַעֲדִיתַיִם וְהַגְּדֵרָה וּגְדֵרֹתָיִם עָרִים אַרְבַּע־עֶשְׂרֵה וְחַצְרֵיהֶן: צְנָן

15:12. According to the Talmud, "and its border" is meant to include the islands off the coast of the land.

15:13. See 14:15.

15:17. Caleb and Othniel were half brothers through their mother. Kenaz was the father of Othniel and the stepfather of Caleb (*Radak*).

15:18. To prostrate herself before Caleb.

15:32. Nine of the thirty-eight cities listed here —

37 Zenan, Hadashah, Migdal-gad, 38 Dilan, Mizpeh, Joktheel, 39 Lachish,
Bozkath, Eglon, 40 Cabbon, Lahmas, Chithlish, 41 Gederoth, Beth-dagon, Naa-
mah, Makkedah — sixteen cities and their villages.

42 Libnah, Ether, Ashan, 43 Iphtah, Ashnah, Nezib, 44 Keilah, Achzib,
Mareshah — nine cities and their villages.

45 Ekron and its towns and villages; 46 from Ekron to the Sea, all that lay near
Ashdod and their villages: 47 Ashdod, its towns and villages; Gaza, its towns
and villages to the Brook of Egypt and the Great [Mediterranean] Sea, and its
border. 48 And in the mountain: Shamir, Jattir, Socoh, 49 Dannah, Kiriath-san-
nah which is Debir, 50 Anab, Eshtemoh, Anim, 51 Goshen, Holon, Giloh —
eleven cities and their villages.

The mountain region

52 Arab, Rumah, Eshan, 53 Janum, Beth-tappuah, Aphekah, 54 Humtah,
Kiriath-arba which is Hebron, and Zior — nine cities and their villages.

55 Maon, Carmel, Ziph, Juttah, 56 Jezreel, Jokdeam, Zanoah, 57 Kain, Gibeah,
and Timnah — ten cities and their villages.

58 Halhul, Beth-zur, Gedor; 59 Maarath, Beth-anoth, Eltekon — six cities and
their villages.

60 Kiriath-baal which is Kiriath-jearim, and Harabbah — two cities and their
villages.

61 In the wilderness: Beth-haarabah, Middin, Secacah, 62 and Nibshan, the
City of Salt and En-gedi — six cities and their villages.

The Wilderness of Judah

63 But the Jebusite, the inhabitants of Jerusalem, the children of Judah were
not able to drive out; and the Jebusite dwelled among the children of Judah, in
Jerusalem, until this day.

16

JOSEPH'S TERRITORIES 16:1-18:1

1 The lot for the children of Joseph went out from the Jordan opposite
Jericho to the Waters of Jericho to the east; the wilderness that ascends
from Jericho to the mountain to Beth-el. 2 It went out from Beth-el to Luz and
passed to the border of the Archite, to Ataroth. 3 It descended westward to the
border of the Japhletite until the border of Lower Beth-horon and until Gezer; its
outlets were to the Sea. 4 The children of Joseph — Manasseh and Ephraim —
received their heritages. 5 The border of the children of Ephraim, according to
their families, was: The border of their inheritance to the east was from Atroth
Addar to Upper Beth-horon. 6 The border went out westward north of Mich-
methath, and the border circled to the east of Taanath-shiloh, passing it on the
east of Janoah. 7 It descended from Janoah to Ataroth and Naarath and reached
Jericho, and went out to the Jordan. 8 From Tappuah the border went westward
to the Brook of Kanah and its outlets were to the Sea. This is the heritage of the
children of Ephraim according to their families. 9 There were isolated cities
belonging to the children of Ephraim that were within the heritage of the children
of Manasseh, all these cities and their villages. 10 They did not drive out the
Canaanite that dwelled in Gezer; rather the Canaanite dwelled in the midst of
Ephraim until this day, and they were indentured laborers.

Ephraim's territory (See Appendix D, map 2)

Ephraim's isolated cities

17

1 Then was the lot for the tribe of Manasseh, though he was Joseph's first-
born. * For Machir the firstborn of Manasseh, the father of Gilead — be-
cause he was a man of war — unto him was Gilead and the Bashan. 2 There was
[also a portion] for the remaining sons of Manasseh according to their families:
for the children of Abiezer, for the children of Helek, for the children of Asriel,

Manasseh's family

לח־מ וַחֲדָשָׁה וּמִגְדַּל־גָּד: וְדִלְעָן וְהַמִּצְפֶּה וְיָקְתְּאֵל: לָכִישׁ וּבָצְקַת וְעֶגְלוֹן: וְכַבּוֹן
מא וְלַחְמָס וְכִתְלִישׁ: וּגְדֵרוֹת בֵּית־דָּגוֹן וְנַעֲמָה וּמַקֵּדָה עָרִים שֵׁשׁ־עֶשְׂרֵה
מב־מד וְחַצְרֵיהֶן: לִבְנָה וָעֶתֶר וְעָשָׁן: וְיִפְתָּח וְאַשְׁנָה וּנְצִיב: וּקְעִילָה
מה וְאַכְזִיב וּמָרֵאשָׁה עָרִים תֵּשַׁע וְחַצְרֵיהֶן: עֶקְרוֹן וּבְנֹתֶיהָ וַחֲצֵרֶיהָ:
מו־מז מֵעֶקְרוֹן וָיָמָּה כֹּל אֲשֶׁר־עַל־יַד אַשְׁדּוֹד וְחַצְרֵיהֶן: אַשְׁדּוֹד
בְּנוֹתֶיהָ וַחֲצֵרֶיהָ עַזָּה בְּנוֹתֶיהָ וַחֲצֵרֶיהָ עַד־נַחַל מִצְרַיִם וְהַיָּם °הַגָּדוֹל [ק] וּגְבוּל:
מח־מט [°הַגָּדוֹל ק] וּגְבוּל: וּבָהָר שָׁמִיר וְיַתִּיר וְשׂוֹכֹה: וְדַנָּה וְקִרְיַת־סַנָּה הִיא
נ־נא דְבִר: וַעֲנָב וְאֶשְׁתְּמֹה וְעָנִים: וְגֹשֶׁן וְחֹלֹן וְגִלֹה עָרִים אַחַת־עֶשְׂרֵה
נב־נג וְחַצְרֵיהֶן: אָרַב °וּרוּמָה [נ־א °וּדוּמָה] וְאֶשְׁעָן: °וּינִים [°וְיָנוּם ק]
נד וּבֵית־תַּפּוּחַ וַאֲפֵקָה: וְחֻמְטָה וְקִרְיַת־אַרְבַּע הִיא חֶבְרוֹן וְצִיעֹר עָרִים
נה־נו תֵּשַׁע וְחַצְרֵיהֶן: מָעוֹן ! כַּרְמֶל וָזִיף וּיוּטָּה: וְיִזְרְעֶאל וְיָקְדְעָם וְזָנוֹחַ:
נז־נח הַקַּיִן גִּבְעָה וְתִמְנָה עָרִים עֶשֶׂר וְחַצְרֵיהֶן: חַלְחוּל בֵּית־צוּר
נט־ס וּגְדוֹר: וּמַעֲרַת וּבֵית־עָנוֹת וְאֶלְתֵּקֹן עָרִים שֵׁשׁ וְחַצְרֵיהֶן: קִרְיַת־
סא בַּעַל הִיא קִרְיַת יְעָרִים וְהָרַבָּה עָרִים שְׁתַּיִם וְחַצְרֵיהֶן: בַּמִּדְבָּר
סב בֵּית הָעֲרָבָה מִדִּין וּסְכָכָה: וְהַנִּבְשָׁן וְעִיר־הַמֶּלַח וְעֵין גֶּדִי עָרִים שֵׁשׁ
סג וְחַצְרֵיהֶן: וְאֶת־הַיְבוּסִי יוֹשְׁבֵי יְרוּשָׁלִַם לֹא °יוכלו [°יָכְלוּ ק]
בְּנֵי־יְהוּדָה לְהוֹרִישָׁם וַיֵּשֶׁב הַיְבוּסִי אֶת־בְּנֵי יְהוּדָה בִּירוּשָׁלִַם עַד הַיּוֹם
טז א הַזֶּה: וַיֵּצֵא הַגּוֹרָל לִבְנֵי יוֹסֵף מִיַּרְדֵּן יְרִיחוֹ לְמֵי יְרִיחוֹ מִזְּרֶחָה
ב הַמִּדְבָּר עֹלֶה מִיְרִיחוֹ בָּהָר בֵּית־אֵל: וְיָצָא מִבֵּית־אֵל לוּזָה וְעָבַר אֶל־
ג גְּבוּל הָאַרְכִּי עֲטָרוֹת: וְיָרַד יָמָּה אֶל־גְּבוּל הַיַּפְלֵטִי עַד־גְּבוּל בֵּית־חוֹרֹן
ד תַּחְתּוֹן וְעַד־גָּזֶר וְהָיוּ °תצאתו [°תֹּצְאֹתָיו ק] יָמָּה: וַיִּנְחֲלוּ בְנֵי־יוֹסֵף
ה מְנַשֶּׁה וְאֶפְרָיִם: וַיְהִי גְּבוּל בְּנֵי־אֶפְרַיִם לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם וַיְהִי גְּבוּל נַחֲלָתָם
ו מִזְרָחָה עַטְרוֹת אַדָּר עַד־בֵּית חוֹרֹן עֶלְיוֹן: וְיָצָא הַגְּבוּל הַיָּמָּה הַמִּכְמְתָת
ז מִצָּפוֹן וְנָסַב הַגְּבוּל מִזְּרָחָה תַּאֲנַת שִׁלֹה וְעָבַר אוֹתוֹ מִמִּזְרַח יָנוֹחָה: וְיָרַד
ח מִיָּנוֹחָה עֲטָרוֹת וְנַעֲרָתָה וּפָגַע בִּיְרִיחוֹ וְיָצָא הַיַּרְדֵּן: מִתַּפּוּחַ יֵלֵךְ הַגְּבוּל
יָמָּה נַחַל קָנָה וְהָיוּ תֹצְאֹתָיו הַיָּמָּה זֹאת נַחֲלַת מַטֵּה בְנֵי־אֶפְרָיִם
ט לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם: וְהֶעָרִים הַמִּבְדָּלוֹת לִבְנֵי אֶפְרַיִם בְּתוֹךְ נַחֲלַת בְּנֵי־מְנַשֶּׁה
י כָּל־הֶעָרִים וְחַצְרֵיהֶן: וְלֹא הוֹרִישׁוּ אֶת־הַכְּנַעֲנִי הַיּוֹשֵׁב בְּגֶזֶר וַיֵּשֶׁב
יז א הַכְּנַעֲנִי בְּקֶרֶב אֶפְרַיִם עַד־הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה וַיְהִי לְמַס־עֹבֵד: וַיְהִי
הַגּוֹרָל לְמַטֵּה מְנַשֶּׁה כִּי־הוּא בְכוֹר יוֹסֵף לְמָכִיר בְּכוֹר מְנַשֶּׁה אֲבִי
ב הַגִּלְעָד כִּי הוּא הָיָה אִישׁ מִלְחָמָה וַיְהִי־לוֹ הַגִּלְעָד וְהַבָּשָׁן: °וַיְהִי לִבְנֵי
מְנַשֶּׁה הַנּוֹתָרִים לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם לִבְנֵי אֲבִיעֶזֶר וְלִבְנֵי־חֵלֶק וְלִבְנֵי אַשְׂרִיאֵל

17:1. Ephraim's lottery (Ch. 16) had preceded Manasseh's, even though Manasseh was Joseph's firstborn. The reason for this was that Jacob had given preference to Ephraim when he blessed the two (see *Genesis* 48:20). Within Manasseh, Machir received his portion first, partly because he was the firstborn and partly because he was an able fighter and thus could readily conquer his territory.

for the children of Shechem, for the children of Hepher, and for the children of Shemida. These were the male children of Manasseh son of Joseph according to their families.

Zelophehad's daughters

3 But Zelophehad, son of Hepher, son of Gilead, son of Machir, son of Manasseh, had no sons, only daughters; and these are the names of his daughters: Mahlah, Noah, Hoglah, Milcah, and Tirzah. * *4 They approached before Elazar the Kohen, before Joshua son of Nun, and before the leaders, saying, "HASHEM commanded Moses to give us a heritage among our brethren"; and he gave them, according to the word of HASHEM, a heritage among their father's brothers. 5 Ten portions fell to Manasseh — besides the land of Gilead and the Bashan which are on the other side of the Jordan — 6 because the women of Manasseh received a heritage among his sons. The land of Gilead went to Manasseh's remaining sons.*

Manasseh's territory

7 The border of Manasseh was from Asher to Michmethath which faces Shechem, and the border went to the south to the inhabitants of En-tappuah. ¶ *The land of Tappuah belonged to Manasseh, but Tappuah on the border of Manasseh belonged to the children of Ephraim.* * *9 The border descended to the Brook of Kanah — south of the brook. These cities were Ephraim's, in the midst of the cities of Manasseh. The border of Manasseh was on the north of the brook, and its outlets were to the Sea. 10 The southern part [of Joseph's portion] was Ephraim's and the northern part was Manasseh's. The Sea was their [western] border; they met with Asher on the north and Issachar on the east. 11 There was unto Manasseh, within [the territory of] Issachar and within [the territory of] Asher: Beth-shean and its towns, Ibleam and its towns, the inhabitants of Dor and its towns, the inhabitants of En-dor and its towns, the inhabitants of Taanach and its towns, and the inhabitants of Megiddo and its towns — three provinces. 12 But the children of Manasseh were not able to drive out [the inhabitants of] these cities, and the Canaanite wished to dwell in this land. 13 It happened when the Children of Israel became strong that they imposed tribute on the Canaanite, but they did not drive them out.*

Ephraim's separated cities

Manasseh's separated cities

Joseph's demand . . .

14 The children of Joseph spoke to Joshua, saying, "Why have you given me an inheritance of [only] a single lot and a single portion, seeing that I am a numerous people, for HASHEM has blessed me to such an extent?"

15 Joshua said to them, "If you are such a numerous people, ascend to the forest and clear an area for yourselves there — in the land of the Perizzite and the Rephaim — since the mountain range of Ephraim is too confined for you."

*16 The children of Joseph said, "The mountain is insufficient for us, and all the Canaanite that dwell in the land of the valley — those in Beth-shean and its villages and those in the Valley of Jezreel — have iron chariots."**

. . . and Joshua's response

*17 Joshua spoke to the House of Joseph, to Ephraim and to Manasseh, saying, "You are a numerous people and you have great strength. You should not have [only] one lot. 18 That mountain shall be yours because it is a forest; you can cut it down and its outskirts will be yours, for you shall drive out the Canaanite even though they have iron chariots and are strong."**

18 THE REMAINING TRIBES' TERRITORIES 18:2-19:51

1 The entire assembly of the Children of Israel gathered at Shiloh and erected the Tent of Meeting there, * *and the land had been conquered before them, 2 but there was left among the Children of Israel seven tribes that had not yet received their heritage. 3 Joshua said to the Children of Israel,*

וְלִבְנֵי־שֶׁכֶם וְלִבְנֵי־חֵפֶר וְלִבְנֵי שְׁמִידָע אֵלֶּה בְּנֵי מְנַשֶּׁה בֶן־יוֹסֵף הַזְּכָרִים
ג לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם: וְלִצְלָפְחָד בֶּן־חֵפֶר בֶּן־גִּלְעָד בֶּן־מָכִיר בֶּן־מְנַשֶּׁה לֹא־הָיוּ
לוֹ בָנִים כִּי אִם־בָּנוֹת וְאֵלֶּה שְׁמוֹת בְּנֹתָיו מַחְלָה וְנֹעָה חָגְלָה מִלְכָּה
ד וְתִרְצָה: וַתִּקְרַבְנָה לִפְנֵי אֶלְעָזָר הַכֹּהֵן וְלִפְנֵי | יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בִּן־נוּן וְלִפְנֵי
הַנְּשִׂיאִים לֵאמֹר יהוה צִוָּה אֶת־מֹשֶׁה לָתֶת־לָנוּ נַחֲלָה בְּתוֹךְ אַחֵינוּ וַיִּתֵּן
ה לָהֶם אֶל־פִּי יהוה נַחֲלָה בְּתוֹךְ אַחֵי אֲבִיהֶן: וַיִּפְּלוּ חַבְלֵי־מְנַשֶּׁה עֲשָׂרָה
ו לְבַד מֵאֶרֶץ הַגִּלְעָד וְהַבָּשָׁן אֲשֶׁר מֵעֵבֶר לַיַּרְדֵּן: כִּי בְּנוֹת מְנַשֶּׁה נָחֲלוּ
ז נַחֲלָה בְּתוֹךְ בָּנָיו וְאֶרֶץ הַגִּלְעָד הָיְתָה לִבְנֵי־מְנַשֶּׁה הַנּוֹתָרִים: וַיְהִי גְבוּל־
מְנַשֶּׁה מֵאָשֵׁר הַמִּכְמְתָת אֲשֶׁר עַל־פְּנֵי שְׁכֶם וְהָלַךְ הַגְּבוּל אֶל־הַיְּמִין אֶל־
ח יֹשְׁבֵי עֵין תַּפּוּחַ: לִמְנַשֶּׁה הָיְתָה אֶרֶץ תַּפּוּחַ וְתַפּוּחַ אֶל־גְּבוּל מְנַשֶּׁה לִבְנֵי
ט אֶפְרָיִם: וְיָרַד הַגְּבוּל נַחַל קָנָה נֶגְבָּה לַנַּחַל עָרִים הָאֵלֶּה לְאֶפְרַיִם בְּתוֹךְ
י עָרֵי מְנַשֶּׁה וּגְבוּל מְנַשֶּׁה מִצָּפוֹן לַנַּחַל וַיְהִי תֹצְאֹתָיו הַיָּמָּה: נֶגְבָּה לְאֶפְרַיִם
וְצָפוֹנָה לִמְנַשֶּׁה וַיְהִי הַיָּם גְּבוּלוֹ וּבְאָשֵׁר יִפְגְּעוּן מִצָּפוֹן וּבְיִשָּׂשכָר מִמִּזְרָח:
יא וַיְהִי לִמְנַשֶּׁה בְּיִשָּׂשכָר וּבְאָשֵׁר בֵּית שְׁאָן וּבְנוֹתֶיהָ וְיִבְלְעָם וּבְנוֹתֶיהָ וְאֶת־
יֹשְׁבֵי דֹאר וּבְנוֹתֶיהָ וְיֹשְׁבֵי עֵין־דֹּר וּבְנוֹתֶיהָ וְיֹשְׁבֵי תַעְנַךְ וּבְנוֹתֶיהָ וְיֹשְׁבֵי
יב מְגִדּוֹ וּבְנוֹתֶיהָ שְׁלֹשֶׁת הַנֵּפֶת: וְלֹא יָכְלוּ בְּנֵי מְנַשֶּׁה לְהוֹרִישׁ אֶת־הֶעָרִים
יג הָאֵלֶּה וַיּוֹאֶל הַכְּנַעֲנִי לָשֶׁבֶת בָּאָרֶץ הַזֹּאת: וַיְהִי כִּי חָזְקוּ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיִּתְּנוּ
יד אֶת־הַכְּנַעֲנִי לָמַס וְהוֹרֵשׁ לֹא הוֹרִישׁוּ: וַיְדַבְּרוּ בְּנֵי יוֹסֵף
אֶת־יְהוֹשֻׁעַ לֵאמֹר מַדּוּעַ נָתַתָּה לִּי נַחֲלָה גּוֹרָל אֶחָד וְחֶבֶל אֶחָד וַאֲנִי
טו עַם־רָב עַד אֲשֶׁר־עַד־כֹּה בֵּרַכַנִי יהוה: וַיֹּאמֶר אֲלֵיהֶם יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אִם־עַם־
רַב אַתָּה עֲלֵה לְךָ הַיַּעְרָה וּבֵרַאתָ לְךָ שָׁם בְּאֶרֶץ הַפְּרִזִּי וְהָרְפָאִים כִּי־אָץ
טז לְךָ הַר־אֶפְרָיִם: וַיֹּאמְרוּ בְּנֵי יוֹסֵף לֹא־יִמָּצֵא לָנוּ הָהָר וְרֶכֶב בַּרְזֶל בְּכָל־
הַכְּנַעֲנִי הַיֹּשֵׁב בְּאֶרֶץ הָעֵמֶק לַאֲשֶׁר בְּבֵית־שְׁאָן וּבְנוֹתֶיהָ וַלַּאֲשֶׁר בְּעֶמֶק
יז יִזְרְעֶאל: וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶל־בֵּית יוֹסֵף לְאֶפְרַיִם וְלִמְנַשֶּׁה לֵאמֹר עַם־רַב
יח אַתָּה וְכֹחַ גָּדוֹל לָךְ לֹא־יִהְיֶה לְךָ גּוֹרָל אֶחָד: כִּי הַר יִהְיֶה־לָּךְ כִּי־יַעַר הוּא
וּבֵרַאתוֹ וְהָיָה לְךָ תֹצְאֹתָיו כִּי־תוֹרִישׁ אֶת־הַכְּנַעֲנִי כִּי רֶכֶב בַּרְזֶל לוֹ כִּי
יח א חָזָק הוּא: וַיִּקָּהֲלוּ כָּל־עֲדַת בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל שִׁלֹה וַיַּשְׁכִּינוּ
ב שָׁם אֶת־אֹהֶל מוֹעֵד וְהָאָרֶץ נִכְבְּשָׁה לִפְנֵיהֶם: וַיִּוָּתְרוּ בִּבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֲשֶׁר
ג לֹא־חָלְקוּ אֶת־נַחֲלָתָם שִׁבְעָה שְׁבָטִים: וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

17:3. See *Numbers* 1:7.

17:8. The city of Tappuah belonged to Ephraim, but the countryside around it belonged to Manasseh.

17:16. They complained that Joshua's solution was untenable because the Canaanites were too well armed to be displaced.

17:18. Joshua countered that the large population of Manasseh would enable them both to clear a large forest and to defeat the Canaanites.

18:1. After seven years of conquest and seven years of allocation, the Tabernacle, which had been located in Gilgal, was moved to the city of Shiloh, in Ephraim's territory, where it would remain for 369 years as the focal point of the national service to God (see *Tosefta, Zevachim* 13:6). Whereas the portable Tabernacle in the Wilderness had been made of collapsible wooden walls and a roof of draperies, the Tabernacle at Shiloh was made of stone walls and a roof of draperies.

"How long will you be lax in coming to possess the Land that HASHEM, the God of your fathers, has given you? 4 Appoint for yourselves three men for each tribe. I will dispatch them, and they will arise and traverse the land and describe it in writing according to their heritage; then they will come back to me. 5 They will divide it into seven portions; Judah will remain at his border to the south and the House of Joseph will remain at their border to the north. * 6 You shall describe in writing seven portions of the land and bring it to me here. I will then draw lots for you here before HASHEM, our God. 7 For there is no share for the Levites in your midst, since the service of HASHEM is their heritage. Gad, Reuben, and half the tribe of Manasseh have taken their heritage across the Jordan to the east, which Moses the servant of HASHEM gave them."*

8 The men arose and went. Joshua commanded those who went to write about the land, saying, "Go walk through the land, describe it in writing, and return to me. I will cast a lottery for you here before HASHEM in Shiloh."

9 The men went and passed through the land; they described it in writing, according to the cities, in seven portions, in a book; then they came to Joshua, to the encampment at Shiloh. 10 Joshua cast a lottery for them in Shiloh before HASHEM; there Joshua apportioned the land for the Children of Israel according to their portions.

Benjamin's territory (See Appendix D, map 2)

11 The lottery for the tribe of the children of Benjamin came up, according to their families; the boundary of their lot went out between the children of Judah and the children of Joseph. 12 Their northern border was from the Jordan, and it ascended to the flank of Jericho on the north and ascended the mountain to the west; its outlets were to the wilderness of Beth-aven. 13 From there the border passed toward Luz, to the southern flank of Luz which is Beth-el; and the border descended to Atroth-addar, to the mountain that is south of Lower Beth-horon. 14 The border curved and circled around the western side, going southward from the mountain that faces Beth-horon on the south. Its outlets were toward Kiriath-baal which is Kiriath-jearim, a city of the children of Judah. This was the western side. 15 The southern side [was] from the edge of Kiriath-jearim; and the border went out from the west and went out to the spring of the Waters of Nephtoah. 16 The border descended to the edge of the mountain that faces the Valley of the Son of Hinnom, which is north of the Valley of Rephaim, and descended to the Valley of Hinnom to the southern flank of the Jebusite, and descended to En-rogel. 17 It curved from the north and went out to En-shemesh; it went out to Geliloth which was across from Maaleh-adummim. It then descended toward the Stone of Bohan son of Reuben. 18 It passed to the northern flank opposite the plain, and it descended to the plain. 19 The border passed the northern flank of Beth-hoglah; the border's outlets were to the northern tip of the Salt Sea, to the southern end of the Jordan. This was the southern border. 20 The Jordan bordered it on the eastern side. This is the heritage of the children of Benjamin according to its borders all around, according to their families.

21 These are the cities of the tribe of the children of Benjamin according to their families: Jericho, Beth-hoglah, and Emek Keziz, 22 Beth-haarabah, Zemaraim,

portions and the Divinely guided lottery would match the portions with the appropriate tribes. Judah's position to the south and Joseph's to the north guaranteed the security of those borders, permitting the seven tribes in the central part of the land to concentrate on the conquest.

עַד־אָנָה אַתֶּם מִתְרַפִּים לָבוֹא לָרֶשֶׁת אֶת־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר נָתַן לָכֶם יהוה
ד אֱלֹהֵי אֲבוֹתֵיכֶם: הָבוּ לָכֶם שְׁלֹשָׁה אֲנָשִׁים לַשֵּׁבֶט וְאֶשְׁלָחֵם וְיָקוּמוּ
ה וְיִתְהַלְּכוּ בָאָרֶץ וְיִכְתְּבוּ אוֹתָהּ לְפִי נַחֲלָתָם וְיָבֹאוּ אֵלָי: וְהִתְחַלְּקוּ אֹתָהּ
לְשִׁבְעָה חֲלָקִים יְהוּדָה יַעֲמֹד עַל־גְּבוּלוֹ מִנֶּגֶב וּבֵית יוֹסֵף יַעַמְדוּ עַל־
ו גְּבוּלָם מִצָּפוֹן: וְאַתֶּם תִּכְתְּבוּ אֶת־הָאָרֶץ שִׁבְעָה חֲלָקִים וַהֲבֵאתֶם אֵלַי
ז הֵנָּה וְיָרִיתִי לָכֶם גּוֹרָל פֹּה לִפְנֵי יהוה אֱלֹהֵינוּ: כִּי אֵין־חֵלֶק לַלְוִיִּם
בְּקִרְבְּכֶם כִּי־כְהֻנַּת יהוה נַחֲלָתוֹ וְגָד וּרְאוּבֵן וַחֲצִי שֵׁבֶט הַמְנַשֶּׁה לָקְחוּ
ח נַחֲלָתָם מֵעֵבֶר לַיַּרְדֵּן מִזְּרָחָה אֲשֶׁר נָתַן לָהֶם מֹשֶׁה עֶבֶד יהוה: וַיָּקוּמוּ
הָאֲנָשִׁים וַיֵּלְכוּ וַיֵּצֵו יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶת־הַהֹלְכִים לִכְתֹּב אֶת־הָאָרֶץ לֵאמֹר לְכוּ
וְהִתְהַלְּכוּ בָאָרֶץ וְכִתְבוּ אוֹתָהּ וְשׁוּבוּ אֵלַי וּפֹה אַשְׁלִיךְ לָכֶם גּוֹרָל לִפְנֵי
ט יהוה בְּשִׁלֹה: וַיֵּלְכוּ הָאֲנָשִׁים וַיַּעַבְרוּ בָאָרֶץ וַיִּכְתְּבוּהָ לֶעָרִים לְשִׁבְעָה
י חֲלָקִים עַל־סֵפֶר וַיָּבֹאוּ אֶל־יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶל־הַמַּחֲנֶה שִׁלֹה: וַיַּשְׁלֵךְ לָהֶם
יְהוֹשֻׁעַ גּוֹרָל בְּשִׁלֹה לִפְנֵי יהוה וַיְחַלֵּק־שָׁם יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶת־הָאָרֶץ לִבְנֵי
יא יִשְׂרָאֵל כְּמַחְלְקֹתָם: וַיַּעַל גּוֹרַל מַטֵּה בְנֵי־בִנְיָמִן לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם
יב וַיֵּצֵא גְּבוּל גּוֹרָלָם בֵּין בְּנֵי יְהוּדָה וּבֵין בְּנֵי יוֹסֵף: וַיְהִי לָהֶם הַגְּבוּל לִפְאַת
צָפוֹנָה מִן־הַיַּרְדֵּן וְעָלָה הַגְּבוּל אֶל־כֶּתֶף יְרִיחוֹ מִצָּפוֹן וְעָלָה בָהָר וָיָמָּה
יג °והיה [°וְהָיוּ ק׳] תֹּצְאֹתָיו מִדְּבָרָה בֵּית אָוֶן: וְעָבַר מִשָּׁם הַגְּבוּל לוּזָה אֶל־
כֶּתֶף לוּזָה נֶגְבָּה הִיא בֵּית־אֵל וְיָרַד הַגְּבוּל עֲטָרוֹת אַדָּר עַל־הָהָר אֲשֶׁר
יד מִנֶּגֶב לְבֵית־חֹרוֹן תַּחְתּוֹן: וְתָאַר הַגְּבוּל וְנָסַב לִפְאַת־יָם נֶגְבָּה מִן־הָהָר
אֲשֶׁר עַל־פְּנֵי בֵית־חֹרוֹן נֶגְבָּה °והיה [°וְהָיוּ ק׳] תֹּצְאֹתָיו אֶל־קִרְיַת־בַּעַל
טו הִיא קִרְיַת יְעָרִים עִיר בְּנֵי יְהוּדָה זֹאת פְּאַת־יָם: וּפְאַת־נֶגְבָּה מִקְצֵה
טז קִרְיַת יְעָרִים וְיָצָא הַגְּבוּל יָמָּה וְיָצָא אֶל־מַעְיַן מֵי נֶפְתּוֹחַ: וְיָרַד הַגְּבוּל
אֶל־קְצֵה הָהָר אֲשֶׁר עַל־פְּנֵי גֵי בֶן־הִנֹּם אֲשֶׁר בְּעֵמֶק רְפָאִים צָפוֹנָה וְיָרַד
יז גֵּי הִנֹּם אֶל־כֶּתֶף הַיְבוּסִי נֶגְבָּה וְיָרַד עֵין רֹגֵל: וְתָאַר מִצָּפוֹן וְיָצָא עֵין
שֶׁמֶשׁ וְיָצָא אֶל־גְּלִילוֹת אֲשֶׁר־נֹכַח מַעֲלֵה אֲדֻמִּים וְיָרַד אֶבֶן בֹּהַן בֶּן־
יח־יט רְאוּבֵן: וְעָבַר אֶל־כֶּתֶף מוּל־הָעֲרָבָה צָפוֹנָה וְיָרַד הָעֲרָבָתָה: וְעָבַר
הַגְּבוּל אֶל־כֶּתֶף בֵּית־חָגְלָה צָפוֹנָה °והיה [°וְהָיוּ ק׳] ו °תצאותיו
[°תְּצֹאוֹת ק׳] הַגְּבוּל אֶל־לְשׁוֹן יָם־הַמֶּלַח צָפוֹנָה אֶל־קְצֵה הַיַּרְדֵּן נֶגְבָּה
כ זֶה גְּבוּל נֶגֶב: וְהַיַּרְדֵּן יִגְבֹּל־אֹתוֹ לִפְאַת־קֶדְמָה זֹאת נַחֲלַת בְּנֵי בִנְיָמִן
כא לִגְבוּלֹתֶיהָ סָבִיב לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם: וְהָיוּ הֶעָרִים לְמַטֵּה בְּנֵי בִנְיָמִן
כב לְמִשְׁפְּחוֹתֵיהֶם יְרִיחוֹ וּבֵית־חָגְלָה וְעֵמֶק קְצִיץ: וּבֵית הָעֲרָבָה וּצְמָרַיִם

18:3. God had said long before this (13:1,7) that lots should be drawn to divide the land, and He would assist in the conquest, but the tribes had been lax in doing so (*Malbim*). They were afraid that if each tribe knew where it was to live, the united army would disperse, and the individual tribes would not be strong enough to conquer their assigned lands. The stronger tribes, such as Judah and Joseph, however, had no such fears and had occupied their portions (*Abarbanel*).

18:5. The emissaries would map the land into seven

Beth-el, 23 Auwim, Parah, Ophrah, 24 Cephar-ammonah, Ophni, Geba — twelve
cities and their villages; 25 Gibeon, Ramah, Beeroth, 26 Mizpeh, Chephirah,
Mozah; 27 Rekem, Irpeel, Taralah, 28 Zela, Eleph, the Jebusite [city] which is
Jerusalem, Gibeath, [and] Kiriath — fourteen cities and their villages. This is the
heritage of the children of Benjamin according to their families.

19

Simeon's territory
(See Appendix D, map 2)

1 The second lottery came out for Simeon, for the tribe of the children of
Simeon according to their families. Their heritage was situated in the midst
of the heritage of the children of Judah. 2 They received for their heritage:
Beer-sheba [which is] Sheba, Moladah, 3 Hazar-shual, Balah, Ezem, 4 Eltolad,
Bethul, Hormah, 5 Ziklag, Beth-marcaboth, Hazar-susah, 6 Beth-lebaoth, and
Sharuhen — thirteen cities and their villages. 7 Ain, Rimmon, Ether, and Ashan
— four cities and their villages — 8 and all the villages that surrounded these
cities until Baalath-beer and Ramah of the south; this is the heritage of the tribe
of the children of Simeon according to their families. * *9 The heritage of the*
children of Simeon was from the portion of the children of Judah, because the
lot of the children of Judah was too large for them. Therefore, the children of
Simeon received their heritage within [Judah's] heritage. *

Zebulun's territory

10 The third lottery came up for the children of Zebulun according to their
families; the border of their heritage extended to Sarid. 11 Their border ascended
to the west and Maralah and reached to Dabbesheth; it reached the river that is
alongside Jokneam. 12 It returned from Sarid eastward, toward the rising sun on
the border of Chisloth-tabor, and it went out to Dobrath and ascended to
Japhia. 13 From there it passed to the east, to Gath-hepher and to Ittah-kazin,
and it went out to Rimmon, curving to Neah. 14 The border circled it, at the north
of Hannathon, and its outlets were the Valley of Iphtah-el, 15 with Kattath,
Nahalal, Shimron, Idalah, and Beth-lehem — twelve cities * *and their villages.*
16 This is the heritage of the children of Zebulun according to their families, these
cities and their villages.

Issachar's territory

17 The fourth lottery came out for Issachar, for the children of Issachar
according to their families. 18 Their border was: Jezreel, Chesuloth, Shunem,
19 Hapharaim, Shion, Anaharath, 20 Rabbith, Kishion, Ebez, 21 Remeth, En-
gannim, En-chaddah, and Beth-pazzez. 22 The border reached Tabor, Sha-
hazim, Beth-shemesh; their border's outlets were to the Jordan — sixteen cities
and their villages. 23 This is the heritage of the tribe of the children of Issachar
according to their families, the cities and their villages.

Asher's territory

24 The fifth lottery came out for the tribe of the children of Asher according to
their families. 25 Their border was: Helkath, Hali, Beten, Achshaph, 26 and
Alammelech, Amad, Mishal; and it reached Carmel at the sea and at Shihor-
libnath. 27 It turned toward the rising sun, to Beth-dagon, and it reached Zebulun
and the north of the Valley of Iphtah-el and Beth-haemek and Neiel. It then went
out to the north of Cabul, 28 and to Ebron, Rehob, Hammon, and Kanah, until
Great Sidon. 29 The border turned to Ramah and to the fortified city of Tyre; * *the*
border turned to Hosah, and its outlets were to the Sea from the portion of

19:9. Judah conquered more than it required. Since Simeon was allied with the army of Judah (see *Judges* 1:3), Judah's excess cities were allocated to Simeon.

19:15. Some of the cities listed along the borders belonged to Zebulun; others were just across the border and belonged to the neighboring tribe.

19:29. Tyre belonged to Naphtali and is listed here only as a border landmark.

כג־כד וּבֵית אֵל: וְהָעַוִּים וְהַפָּרָה וְעָפְרָה: וּכְפַר °העמני [°הָעַמֹּנִי ק] וְהָעָפְנִי
כה־כו וָגֶבַע עָרִים שְׁתֵּים־עֶשְׂרֵה וְחַצְרֵיהֶן: גִּבְעוֹן וְהָרָמָה וּבְאֵרוֹת: וְהַמִּצְפֵּה
כז־כח וְהַכְּפִירָה וְהַמֹּצָה: וְרֶקֶם וְיִרְפְּאֵל וְתַרְאֲלָה: וְצֵלַע הָאֶלֶף וְהַיְבוּסִי הִיא
יְרוּשָׁלִַם גִּבְעַת קִרְיַת עָרִים אַרְבַּע־עֶשְׂרֵה וְחַצְרֵיהֶן זֹאת נַחֲלַת בְּנֵי־
יט ■ בִנְיָמִן לְמִשְׁפְּחוֹתָם: וַיֵּצֵא הַגּוֹרָל הַשֵּׁנִי לְשִׁמְעוֹן לְמַטֵּה בְנֵי־
ב שִׁמְעוֹן לְמִשְׁפְּחוֹתָם וַיְהִי נַחֲלָתָם בְּתוֹךְ נַחֲלַת בְּנֵי־יְהוּדָה: וַיְהִי לָהֶם
ג־ד בְּנַחֲלָתָם בְּאֵר־שֶׁבַע וְשֶׁבַע וּמוֹלָדָה: וַחֲצַר שׁוּעָל וּבָלָה וָעָצֶם: וְאֶלְתּוֹלַד
ה־ו וּבְתוּל וְחָרְמָה: וְצִקְלַג וּבֵית־הַמַּרְכָּבוֹת וַחֲצַר סוּסָה: וּבֵית לְבָאוֹת
ז וְשָׁרוּחֶן עָרִים שְׁלֹשׁ־עֶשְׂרֵה וְחַצְרֵיהֶן: עַיִן רִמּוֹן וָעֶתֶר וָעָשָׁן עָרִים אַרְבַּע
ח וְחַצְרֵיהֶן: וְכָל־הַחֲצֵרִים אֲשֶׁר סְבִיבוֹת הֶעָרִים הָאֵלֶּה עַד־בַּעֲלַת בְּאֵר
ט רָמַת נֶגֶב זֹאת נַחֲלַת מַטֵּה בְנֵי־שִׁמְעוֹן לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם: מֵחֶבֶל בְּנֵי יְהוּדָה
נַחֲלַת בְּנֵי שִׁמְעוֹן כִּי־הָיָה חֵלֶק בְּנֵי־יְהוּדָה רַב מֵהֶם וַיִּנְחֲלוּ בְּנֵי־שִׁמְעוֹן
י בְּתוֹךְ נַחֲלָתָם: וַיַּעַל הַגּוֹרָל הַשְּׁלִישִׁי לִבְנֵי זְבוּלֻן
יא לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם וַיְהִי גְּבוּל נַחֲלָתָם עַד־שָׂרִיד: וְעָלָה גְּבוּלָם | לַיָּמָה וּמַרְעֲלָה
יב וּפָגַע בְּדַבֶּשֶׁת וּפָגַע אֶל־הַנַּחַל אֲשֶׁר עַל־פְּנֵי יָקְנְעָם: וְשָׁב מִשָّרִיד קֵדְמָה
יג מִזְרַח הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ עַל־גְּבוּל כִּסְלֹת תָּבֹר וְיָצָא אֶל־הַדָּבְרַת וְעָלָה יָפִיעַ: וּמִשָּׁם
עָבַר קֵדְמָה מִזְרָחָה גִּתָּה חֵפֶר עִתָּה קָצִין וְיָצָא רִמּוֹן הַמִּתְאָר הַנֵּעָה:
יד־טו וְנָסַב אֹתוֹ הַגְּבוּל מִצָּפוֹן חַנָּתֹן וְהָיוּ תֹצְאֹתָיו גֵּי יִפְתַּח־אֵל: וְקַטָּת וְנַהֲלָל
טז וְשִׁמְרוֹן וְיִדְאֲלָה וּבֵית לֶחֶם עָרִים שְׁתֵּים־עֶשְׂרֵה וְחַצְרֵיהֶן: זֹאת נַחֲלַת
יז בְּנֵי־זְבוּלֻן לְמִשְׁפְּחוֹתָם הֶעָרִים הָאֵלֶּה וַחֲצֵרֵיהֶן:
יח יָצָא הַגּוֹרָל הָרְבִיעִי לִבְנֵי יִשָּׂשכָר לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם: וַיְהִי גְּבוּלָם יִזְרְעֶאלָה
יט־כ וְהַכְּסֻלּוֹת וְשׁוּנֵם: וַחֲפָרַיִם וְשִׁיאֹן וַאֲנָחֲרַת: וְהָרַבִּית וְקִשְׁיוֹן וָאֶבֶץ:
כא־כב וְרֶמֶת וְעֵין־גַּנִּים וְעֵין חַדָּה וּבֵית פַּצֵּץ: וּפָגַע הַגְּבוּל בְּתָבוֹר °ושחצומה
[°וְשַׁחֲצִימָה ק] וּבֵית שֶׁמֶשׁ וְהָיוּ תֹצְאוֹת גְּבוּלָם הַיַּרְדֵּן עָרִים שֵׁשׁ־
כג עֶשְׂרֵה וְחַצְרֵיהֶן: זֹאת נַחֲלַת מַטֵּה בְנֵי־יִשָּׂשכָר לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם הֶעָרִים
כד וְחַצְרֵיהֶן: וַיֵּצֵא הַגּוֹרָל הַחֲמִישִׁי לְמַטֵּה בְנֵי־אָשֵׁר לְמִשְׁפְּחוֹתָם:
כה־כו וַיְהִי גְּבוּלָם חֶלְקַת וַחֲלִי וָבֶטֶן וַאַכְשָׁף: וְאַלַּמֶּלֶךְ וְעַמְעָד וּמִשְׁאָל וּפָגַע
כז בְּכַרְמֶל הַיָּמָה וּבְשִׁיחֹור לִבְנָת: וְשָׁב מִזְּרַח הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ בֵּית דָּגוֹן וּפָגַע בִּזְבֻלוּן
וּבְגֵי יִפְתַּח־אֵל צָפוֹנָה בֵּית הָעֵמֶק וּנְעִיאֵל וְיָצָא אֶל־כָּבוּל מִשְּׂמֹאל:
כח־כט וְעֶבְרֹן וּרְחֹב וְחַמּוֹן וְקָנָה עַד צִידוֹן רַבָּה: וְשָׁב הַגְּבוּל הָרָמָה וְעַד־עִיר
מִבְצַר־צֹר וְשָׁב הַגְּבוּל חֹסָה °ויהיו [°וְהָיוּ ק] תֹצְאֹתָיו הַיָּמָה מֵחֶבֶל

19:8. Whereas all the tribes received separate territories within the land, Simeon was not allocated any territory, but only scattered patches of land within the territory of Judah. *Ramban* explains that this was in fulfillment of Jacob's words, "I will divide them [i.e., Simeon and Levi] in Jacob and scatter them in Israel" (*Genesis* 49:7), implying that the tribes of Simeon and Levi would be given a series of cities, but not complete provinces.

Achzib; 30 with Ummah and Aphek and Rehob — twenty-two cities and their villages. 31 This is the heritage of the tribe of the children of Asher according to their families, these cities and their villages.

Naphtali's territory (See Appendix D, map 2)

32 The sixth lottery came out for the children of Naphtali, for the children of Naphtali according to their families. 33 Their border was: from Heleph, from Elon-bezaanannim, Adami, Nekeb, and Jabneel until Lakkum, and its outlets were the Jordan. 34 The border turned westward to Aznoth-tabor and went out from there to Hukok; it reached Zebulun in the south, and reached Asher in the west, and Judah at the Jordan toward the rising sun. 35 The fortified cities were: Ziddim, Zer, Hammath, Rakkath, Kinnereth, 36 Adamah, Haramath, Hazor, 37 Kedesh, Edrei, En-hazor, 38 Iron, Migdal-el, Horem, Beth-anath, and Beth-shemesh — nineteen cities and their villages. 39 This is the heritage of the tribe of the children of Naphtali according to their families, the cities and their villages.*

Dan's territory

40 For the tribe of the children of Dan according to their families, the seventh lottery went out. 41 The border of their heritage was: Zorah, Eshtaol, Ir-shemesh, 42 Shaalabbin, Aijalon, Ithlah, 43 Elon, Timnah, Ekron, 44 Eltekeh, Gibbethon, Baalath, 45 Jehud, Bene-berak, Gath-rimmon, 46 Mei-jarkon, and Rakkon, with the border opposite Jaffa. 47 The boundary of the children of Dan was not sufficient for them, so the children of Dan ascended and battled with Leshem, and conquered it, smiting it by the edge of the sword. They took possession of it and dwelled there, and changed the name of Leshem to Dan, after the name of Dan their ancestor. 48 This is the heritage of the tribe of the children of Dan according to their families, these cities and their villages.

49 Thus they finished apportioning the land according to its borders. The Children of Israel gave a heritage to Joshua son of Nun within their midst. 50 By the word of HASHEM they gave him the city that he requested, Timnath-serah in Mount Ephraim; and he built the city and dwelled there.

51 These are the heritages that Elazar the Kohen, and Joshua son of Nun, and the heads of the ancestral [families] of the tribes of the Children of Israel apportioned by lottery, in Shiloh, before HASHEM, at the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. Thus they finished dividing the land.

20

THE CITIES OF REFUGE 20:1-9 (See Appendix D, map 5)

1 HASHEM spoke to Joshua, saying, 2 "Speak to the Children of Israel, saying, 'Prepare for yourselves the cities of refuge, about which I spoke to you through Moses, 3 where a killer may flee — one who kills a person through carelessness, unintentionally. They will be a refuge for you from the avenger of the blood. 4 He shall flee to one of these cities, stand at the entrance to the city gate, and speak his words into the ears of the elders of that city; they shall bring him into the city, to them, and provide him a place, and he shall dwell among them. 5 If the avenger of the blood chases after him, they shall not deliver the killer into his hand, for he struck his fellow unintentionally; he did not hate him from yesterday and before yesterday. 6 He shall dwell in that city until he stands before the tribunal for judgment, until the death of the Kohen Gadol who will be in those days. Then the killer may return and go to his city and to his house, to the city from which he fled.' "**

7 They designated Kedesh in the Galilee in the mountains of Naphtali,

ל־לא אַכְזִיבָה: וְעֻמָּה וַאֲפֵק וּרְחֹב עָרִים עֶשְׂרִים וּשְׁתַּיִם וְחַצְרֵיהֶן׃ זֹאת נַחֲלַת
לב מַטֵּה בְנֵי־אָשֵׁר לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם הֶעָרִים הָאֵלֶּה וְחַצְרֵיהֶן׃ לִבְנֵי
לג נַפְתָּלִי יָצָא הַגּוֹרָל הַשִּׁשִּׁי לִבְנֵי נַפְתָּלִי לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם׃ וַיְהִי גְבוּלָם
מֵחֵלֶף מֵאֵלוֹן בְּצַעֲנַנִּים וַאֲדָמִי הַנֶּקֶב וְיַבְנְאֵל עַד־לַקּוּם וַיְהִי תֹצְאֹתָיו
לד הַיַּרְדֵּן׃ וְשָׁב הַגְּבוּל יָמָּה אַזְנוֹת תָּבוֹר וְיָצָא מִשָּׁם חוּקֹקָה וּפָגַע בִּזְבֻלוּן
לה מִנֶּגֶב וּבְאָשֵׁר פָּגַע מִיָּם וּבִיהוּדָה הַיַּרְדֵּן מִזְרַח הַשָּׁמֶשׁ׃ וְעָרֵי מִבְצָר
לו־לז הַצִּדִּים צֵר וְחַמַּת רַקַּת וְכִנֶּרֶת׃ וַאֲדָמָה וְהָרָמָה וְחָצוֹר׃ וְקֶדֶשׁ וְאֶדְרֶעִי
לח וְעֵין חָצוֹר׃ וְיִרְאוֹן וּמִגְדַּל־אֵל חֶרֶם וּבֵית־עֲנָת וּבֵית שֶׁמֶשׁ עָרִים תְּשַׁע־
לט עֶשְׂרֵה וְחַצְרֵיהֶן׃ זֹאת נַחֲלַת מַטֵּה בְנֵי־נַפְתָּלִי לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם הֶעָרִים
מ־מא וְחַצְרֵיהֶן׃ לְמַטֵּה בְנֵי־דָן לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם יָצָא הַגּוֹרָל הַשְּׁבִיעִי׃ וַיְהִי
מב גְּבוּל נַחֲלָתָם צָרְעָה וְאֶשְׁתָּאוֹל וְעִיר שָׁמֶשׁ׃ וְשַׁעַלַבִּין וְאַיָּלוֹן וְיִתְלָה׃
מג־מה וְאֵילוֹן וְתִמְנָתָה וְעֶקְרוֹן׃ וְאֶלְתְּקֵה וְגִבְּתוֹן וּבַעֲלָת׃ וּיְהֻד וּבְנֵי־בְרַק וְגַת־
מו־מז רִמּוֹן׃ וּמֵי הַיַّרְקוֹן וְהָרַקּוֹן עִם־הַגְּבוּל מוּל יָפוֹ׃ וַיֵּצֵא גְבוּל־בְּנֵי־דָן מֵהֶם
וַיַּעֲלוּ בְנֵי־דָן וַיִּלָּחֲמוּ עִם־לֶשֶׁם וַיִּלְכְּדוּ אוֹתָהּ ׀ וַיַּכּוּ אוֹתָהּ לְפִי־חָרֶב
מח וַיִּרְשׁוּ אוֹתָהּ וַיֵּשְׁבוּ בָהּ וַיִּקְרְאוּ לְלֶשֶׁם דָּן כְּשֵׁם דָּן אֲבִיהֶם׃ זֹאת נַחֲלַת
מט מַטֵּה בְנֵי־דָן לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם הֶעָרִים הָאֵלֶּה וְחַצְרֵיהֶן׃ וַיְכַלּוּ לִנְחֹל־
אֶת־הָאָרֶץ לִגְבוּלֹתֶיהָ וַיִּתְּנוּ בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל נַחֲלָה לִיהוֹשֻׁעַ בִּן־נוּן בְּתוֹכָם׃
נ עַל־פִּי יהוה נָתְנוּ לוֹ אֶת־הָעִיר אֲשֶׁר שָׁאָל אֶת־תִּמְנַת־סֶרַח בְּהַר אֶפְרָיִם
נא וַיִּבְנֶה אֶת־הָעִיר וַיֵּשֶׁב בָּהּ׃ אֵלֶּה הַנַּחֲלֹת אֲשֶׁר נָחֲלוּ אֶלְעָזָר
הַכֹּהֵן ׀ וִיהוֹשֻׁעַ בִּן־נוּן וְרָאשֵׁי הָאָבוֹת לְמַטּוֹת בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל ׀ בְּגוֹרָל ׀
בְּשִׁלֹה לִפְנֵי יהוה פֶּתַח אֹהֶל מוֹעֵד וַיְכַלּוּ מֵחַלֵּק אֶת־הָאָרֶץ׃

ב א־ב וַיְדַבֵּר יהוה אֶל־יְהוֹשֻׁעַ לֵאמֹר׃ דַּבֵּר אֶל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לֵאמֹר תְּנוּ
ג לָכֶם אֶת־עָרֵי הַמִּקְלָט אֲשֶׁר־דִּבַּרְתִּי אֲלֵיכֶם בְּיַד־מֹשֶׁה׃ לָנוּס שָׁמָּה
ד רוֹצֵחַ מַכֵּה־נֶפֶשׁ בִּשְׁגָגָה בִּבְלִי־דָעַת וְהָיוּ לָכֶם לְמִקְלָט מִגֹּאֵל הַדָּם׃ וְנָס
אֶל־אַחַת ׀ מֵהֶעָרִים הָאֵלֶּה וְעָמַד פֶּתַח שַׁעַר הָעִיר וְדִבֵּר בְּאָזְנֵי זִקְנֵי
הָעִיר־הַהִיא אֶת־דְּבָרָיו וְאָסְפוּ אוֹתוֹ הָעִירָה אֲלֵיהֶם וְנָתְנוּ־לוֹ מָקוֹם
ה וְיָשַׁב עִמָּם׃ וְכִי יִרְדֹּף גֹּאֵל הַדָּם אַחֲרָיו וְלֹא־יַסְגִּרוּ אֶת־הָרֹצֵחַ בְּיָדוֹ
כִּי בִּבְלִי־דַעַת הִכָּה אֶת־רֵעֵהוּ וְלֹא־שֹׂנֵא הוּא לוֹ מִתְּמוֹל שִׁלְשׁוֹם׃
ו וְיָשַׁב ׀ בָּעִיר הַהִיא עַד־עָמְדוֹ לִפְנֵי הָעֵדָה לַמִּשְׁפָּט עַד־מוֹת הַכֹּהֵן
הַגָּדוֹל אֲשֶׁר יִהְיֶה בַּיָּמִים הָהֵם אָז ׀ יָשׁוּב הָרוֹצֵחַ וּבָא אֶל־עִירוֹ וְאֶל־
ז בֵּיתוֹ אֶל־הָעִיר אֲשֶׁר־נָס מִשָּׁם׃ וַיַּקְדִּישׁוּ אֶת־קֶדֶשׁ בַּגָּלִיל בְּהַר נַפְתָּלִי

19:38. Some of the border cities listed above belonged to neighboring tribes.

20:2. See *Numbers* 35:9-34 for the background of the laws in this chapter.

20:6. If the killer is found to have exercised all reasonable care, he is acquitted and does not go into exile. If he is found guilty of carelessness, he is exiled to a city of refuge where he must remain until the death of the Kohen Gadol.

The six cities

and Shechem in the mountains of Ephraim, and Kiriath-arba which is Hebron in the mountains of Judah. ■ *On the other side of the Jordan, by Jericho, to the east, they designated Bezer in the wilderness in the plain from the tribe of Reuben, and Ramoth in Gilead from the tribe of Gad, and Golan in the Bashan from the tribe of Manasseh.* * 9 *These were the cities appointed for all the Children of Israel and for the resident who dwells among them — to which any person who kills through carelessness may flee, and not die by the hand of the avenger of the blood before he stands before the tribunal.*

21

THE CITIES OF THE LEVITES AND KOHANIM
21:1-40
(See Appendix D, map 5)

1 *The heads of the ancestral [families] of the Levites approached Elazar the Kohen, Joshua son of Nun, and the heads of the fathers' [household] of the tribes of the Children of Israel.* 2 *They spoke to them in Shiloh, in the land of Canaan, saying, "HASHEM commanded through Moses to give us cities in which to dwell and their open [surrounding] spaces for our animals."* * 3 *So the Children of Israel gave to the Levites from their heritages, according to the word of HASHEM, these cities and their open spaces.*

4 *The lottery came out for the families of the Kohathite: for the sons of Aaron the Kohen, [who were] of the Levites, [there were] from the tribe of Judah, from the tribe of the Simeonite, and from the tribe of Benjamin, by lottery, thirteen cities.*

5 *For the remaining sons of Kohath: from the families of the tribe of Ephraim, from the tribe of Dan, and from half the tribe of Manasseh, by lottery, ten cities.*

6 *To the sons of Gershon: from the families of the tribe of Issachar, from the tribe of Asher, from the tribe of Naphtali, and from half the tribe of Manasseh in the Bashan, by lottery, thirteen cities.*

7 *For the sons of Merari according to their families: from the tribe of Reuben, from the tribe of Gad, and from the tribe of Zebulun, twelve cities.*

8 *The Children of Israel gave these cities and their open spaces to the Levites, as HASHEM had commanded through Moses, by lottery.*

The cities of the Kohanim — from Judah, Simeon, and Benjamin

9 *They gave — from the tribe of the children of Judah and from the tribe of the children of Simeon — these cities which will be mentioned by name,* 10 *and they belonged to the sons of Aaron from the Kohathite family of the children of Levi, for theirs was the first lottery.* 11 *They gave them Kiriath-arba,* * *father of the giants, which is Hebron in Mount Judah, and its open spaces around it;* 12 *but the fields of the city and its villages they gave to Caleb son of Jephunneh as his possession.*

13 *To the sons of Aaron the Kohen they gave the city of refuge for killers, Hebron and its open spaces, Libnah and its open spaces,* 14 *Jattir and its open spaces, Eshtemoa and its open spaces,* 15 *Holon and its open spaces, Debir and its open spaces,* 16 *Ain and its open spaces, Juttah and its open spaces, and Beth-shemesh and its open spaces — nine cities from these two tribes.*

17 *From the tribe of Benjamin: Gibeon and its open spaces, Geba and its open spaces,* 18 *Anathoth and its open spaces, and Almon and its open spaces — four cities.* 19 *All the cities of the sons of Aaron, the Kohanim, were thirteen cities and their open spaces.*

20 *As for the families of the sons of Kohath, the Levites — those that were left*

(*Rambam*). They were supported by the tithes given them by their brethren, a process that was facilitated by their dispersion throughout the land. See *Numbers* 35:1-8.

21:11. See 14:15.

ח וְאֶת־שְׁכֶם בְּהַר אֶפְרָיִם וְאֶת־קִרְיַת אַרְבַּע הִיא חֶבְרוֹן בְּהַר יְהוּדָה: וּמֵעֵבֶר
לְיַרְדֵּן יְרִיחוֹ מִזְּרָחָה נָתְנוּ אֶת־בֶּצֶר בַּמִּדְבָּר בַּמִּישֹׁר מִמַּטֵּה רְאוּבֵן וְאֶת־
רָאמֹת בַּגִּלְעָד מִמַּטֵּה גָד וְאֶת־°גלון [°גוֹלָן ק׳] בַּבָּשָׁן מִמַּטֵּה מְנַשֶּׁה: אֵלֶּה
ט הָיוּ עָרֵי הַמּוֹעֲדָה לְכָל ׀ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וְלַגֵּר הַגָּר בְּתוֹכָם לָנוּס
שָׁמָּה כָּל־מַכֵּה־נֶפֶשׁ בִּשְׁגָגָה וְלֹא יָמוּת בְּיַד גֹּאֵל הַדָּם עַד־עָמְדוֹ לִפְנֵי
כא א הָעֵדָה: וַיִּגְּשׁוּ רָאשֵׁי אֲבוֹת הַלְוִיִּם אֶל־אֶלְעָזָר הַכֹּהֵן וְאֶל־
ב יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בִּן־נוּן וְאֶל־רָאשֵׁי אֲבוֹת הַמַּטּוֹת לִבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל: וַיְדַבְּרוּ אֲלֵיהֶם
בְּשִׁלֹה בְּאֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן לֵאמֹר יהוה צִוָּה בְיַד־מֹשֶׁה לָתֶת־לָנוּ עָרִים לָשֶׁבֶת
ג וּמִגְרְשֵׁיהֶן לִבְהֵמְתֵּנוּ: וַיִּתְּנוּ בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל לַלְוִיִּם מִנַּחֲלָתָם אֶל־פִּי יהוה
ד אֶת־הֶעָרִים הָאֵלֶּה וְאֶת־מִגְרְשֵׁיהֶן: וַיֵּצֵא הַגּוֹרָל לְמִשְׁפְּחֹת
הַקְּהָתִי וַיְהִי לִבְנֵי אַהֲרֹן הַכֹּהֵן מִן־הַלְוִיִּם מִמַּטֵּה יְהוּדָה וּמִמַּטֵּה הַשִּׁמְעֹנִי
ה וּמִמַּטֵּה בִנְיָמִן בַּגּוֹרָל עָרִים שְׁלֹשׁ עֶשְׂרֵה: וְלִבְנֵי קְהָת
הַנּוֹתָרִים מִמִּשְׁפְּחֹת מַטֵּה־אֶפְרַיִם וּמִמַּטֵּה־דָן וּמֵחֲצִי מַטֵּה מְנַשֶּׁה
ו בַּגּוֹרָל עָרִים עֶשֶׂר: וְלִבְנֵי גֵרְשׁוֹן מִמִّשְׁפְּחוֹת מַטֵּה־יִשָּׂשכָר
וּמִמַּטֵּה־אָשֵׁר וּמִמַּטֵּה נַפְתָּלִי וּמֵחֲצִי מַטֵּה מְנַשֶּׁה בַבָּשָׁן בַּגּוֹרָל עָרִים
ז שְׁלֹשׁ עֶשְׂרֵה: לִבְנֵי מְרָרִי לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם מִמַּטֵּה רְאוּבֵן וּמִמַּטֵּה־
ח גָד וּמִמַּטֵּה זְבוּלֻן עָרִים שְׁתֵּים עֶשְׂרֵה: וַיִּתְּנוּ בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל
לַלְוִיִּם אֶת־הֶעָרִים הָאֵלֶּה וְאֶת־מִגְרְשֵׁיהֶן כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּה יהוה בְּיַד־מֹשֶׁה
ט בַּגּוֹרָל: וַיִּתְּנוּ מִמַּטֵּה בְּנֵי יְהוּדָה וּמִמַּטֵּה בְּנֵי שִׁמְעוֹן אֵת הֶעָרִים
י הָאֵלֶּה אֲשֶׁר־יִקְרָא אֶתְהֶן בְּשֵׁם: וַיְהִי לִבְנֵי אַהֲרֹן מִמִּשְׁפְּחוֹת הַקְּהָתִי
יא מִבְּנֵי לֵוִי כִּי לָהֶם הָיָה הַגּוֹרָל רִאישֹׁנָה: וַיִּתְּנוּ לָהֶם אֶת־קִרְיַת אַרְבַּע אֲבִי
יב הָעֲנָק הִיא חֶבְרוֹן בְּהַר יְהוּדָה וְאֶת־מִגְרְשָׁהּ סְבִיבֹתֶיהָ: וְאֶת־שְׂדֵה הָעִיר
יג וְאֶת־חֲצֵרֶיהָ נָתְנוּ לְכָלֵב בֶּן־יְפֻנֶּה בַּאֲחֻזָּתוֹ: וְלִבְנֵי ׀ אַהֲרֹן
הַכֹּהֵן נָתְנוּ אֶת־עִיר מִקְלַט הָרֹצֵחַ אֶת־חֶבְרוֹן וְאֶת־מִגְרְשָׁהּ וְאֶת־לִבְנָה
יד־טו וְאֶת־מִגְרְשָׁהּ: וְאֶת־יַתִּיר וְאֶת־מִגְרְשָׁהּ וְאֶת־אֶשְׁתְּמֹעַ וְאֶת־מִגְרְשָׁהּ: וְאֶת־
טז חֹלֹן וְאֶת־מִגְרְשָׁהּ וְאֶת־דְּבִר וְאֶת־מִגְרְשָׁהּ: וְאֶת־עַיִן וְאֶת־מִגְרְשָׁהּ וְאֶת־
יִטָּה וְאֶת־מִגְרְשָׁהּ אֶת־בֵּית־שֶׁמֶשׁ וְאֶת־מִגְרְשָׁהּ עָרִים תֵּשַׁע מֵאֵת שְׁנֵי
יז הַשְּׁבָטִים הָאֵלֶּה: וּמִמַּטֵּה בִנְיָמִן אֶת־גִּבְעוֹן וְאֶת־מִגְרְשָׁהּ
יח אֶת־גֶּבַע וְאֶת־מִגְרְשָׁהּ: אֶת־עֲנָתוֹת וְאֶת־מִגְרְשָׁהּ וְאֶת־עַלְמוֹן וְאֶת־
יט מִגְרְשָׁהּ עָרִים אַרְבַּע: כָּל־עָרֵי בְנֵי־אַהֲרֹן הַכֹּהֲנִים שְׁלֹשׁ־עֶשְׂרֵה
כ עָרִים וּמִגְרְשֵׁיהֶן: וּלְמִשְׁפְּחוֹת בְּנֵי־קְהָת הַלְוִיִּם הַנּוֹתָרִים

20:8. Although Moses designated the three cities to the east of the Jordan before his death (*Deuteronomy* 4:41-43), they did not assume their official status until Joshua designated the remaining three (*Talmud*).

21:2. The Levite cities were spread throughout the land in fulfillment of Jacob's utterance, "I will scatter them in Israel" (*Genesis* 49:7). The Torah granted the Levites cities, but not a tribal province in the land (*Numbers* 18:20), so that they would devote themselves to Divine service in the Holy Temple and teach the Torah to the other tribes

from the sons of Kohath — the cities of their lottery were from the tribe of Ephraim. [21] *They gave them the city of refuge for killers, Shechem and its open spaces in Mount Ephraim, Gezer and its open spaces,* [22] *Kivzaim and its open spaces, and Beth-horon and its open spaces — four cities.*

The cities of Kohath — from Ephraim, Dan, and half of Manasseh

[23] *From the tribe of Dan — Elteke and its open spaces, Gibbethon and its open spaces,* [24] *Aijalon and its open spaces, and Gath-rimmon and its open spaces — four cities.*

[25] *From half the tribe of Manasseh: Taanach and its open spaces and Gath-rimmon and its open spaces — two cities.* [26] *In all there were ten cities and their open spaces for the remaining families of the sons of Kohath.*

[27] *For the sons of Gershon of the families of the Levites: from half the tribe of Manasseh, the city of refuge for the killer, Golan in the Bashan and its open spaces, and Beeshterah and its open spaces — two cities.*

The cities of Gershon — from half of Manasseh, Issachar, Asher, and Naphtali

[28] *From the tribe of Issachar: Kishion and its open spaces, Dobrath and its open spaces,* [29] *Jarmuth and its open spaces, and En-gannim and its open spaces — four cities.*

[30] *From the tribe of Asher: Mishal and its open spaces, Abdon and its open spaces,* [31] *Helkath and its open spaces, and Rehob and its open spaces — four cities.*

[32] *From the tribe of Naphtali: the city of refuge for the killers, Kedesh in the Galilee and its open spaces, Hammoth-dor and its open spaces, and Kartan and its open spaces — three cities.* [33] *All the Gershonite cities according to their families were thirteen cities and their open spaces.*

The cities of Merari — from Zebulun, Reuben, and Gad

[34] *For the families of the sons of Merari, the remaining Levites: from the tribe of Zebulun, Jokneam and its open spaces, Kartah and its open spaces,* [35] *Dimnah and its open spaces, and Nahalal and its open spaces — four cities.* *

[36] *From the tribe of Gad: the city of refuge for the killers, Ramoth, in the Gilead, and its open spaces, Mahanaim and its open spaces,* [37] *Heshbon and its open spaces, and Jazer and its open spaces — all the cities four.*

[38] *All the cities for the sons of Merari according to their families, the remaining families of the Levites — their lot was twelve cities.*

[39] *All the cities of the Levites within the possession of the Children of Israel were forty-eight, and their open spaces.* [40] *Every single city of these cities shall be [given] with its open spaces all around it; so shall it be for all these cities.*

DIVISION OF TERRITORIES CONCLUDED 21:41-22:34

[41] *Thus HASHEM gave to Israel the entire land that He swore to their forefathers to give; they inherited it and dwelled in it.* [42] *HASHEM granted them rest from all around, according to all that He had sworn to their forefathers; no man from among all their enemies stood before them; HASHEM delivered all their enemies into their hands.* [43] *Nothing of all the good things of which HASHEM had spoken to the House of Israel was lacking; everything came to pass.*

God's promises fulfilled

21:35. Some editions contain the following two verses after verse 35: *From the tribe of Reuben: Bezer and its open spaces, Jahaz and its open spaces, Kedemoth and its open spaces, Mephaath and its open spaces — four cities.* However, most Masoretic authorities maintain that although the information contained in these verses is recorded in *I Chronicles* 6:63-64, it is nevertheless not part of the original Masoretic text of Joshua (*Radak*).

כא מִבְּנֵי קְהָת וַיֶּהִי עָרֵי גּוֹרָלָם מִמַּטֵּה אֶפְרָיִם׃ וַיִּתְּנוּ לָהֶם אֶת־עִיר
מִקְלַט הָרֹצֵחַ אֶת־שְׁכֶם וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ בְּהַר אֶפְרָיִם וְאֶת־גֶּזֶר וְאֶת־
כב מִגְרָשָׁהּ׃ וְאֶת־קִבְצַיִם וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ וְאֶת־בֵּית חֹרוֹן וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ עָרִים
כג אַרְבָּע׃ וּמִמַּטֵּה־דָן אֶת־אֶלְתְּקֵא וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ אֶת־גִּבְּתוֹן
כד וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ׃ אֶת־אַיָּלוֹן וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ אֶת־גַּת־רִמּוֹן וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ
כה עָרִים אַרְבָּע׃ וּמֶחָצִית מַטֵּה מְנַשֶּׁה אֶת־תַּעְנָךְ וְאֶת־
כו מִגְרָשָׁהּ וְאֶת־גַּת־רִמּוֹן וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ עָרִים שְׁתָּיִם׃ כָּל־עָרִים אֲשֶׁר
כז וּמִגְרְשֵׁיהֶן לְמִשְׁפְּחוֹת בְּנֵי־קְהָת הַנּוֹתָרִים׃ וְלִבְנֵי גֵרְשׁוֹן
מִמִּשְׁפְּחֹת הַלְוִיִּם מֵחֲצִי מַטֵּה מְנַשֶּׁה אֶת־עִיר מִקְלַט הָרֹצֵחַ אֶת־
°גלון [°גוֹלָן ק׳] בַּבָּשָׁן וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ וְאֶת־בְּעֶשְׁתְּרָה וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ עָרִים
כח שְׁתָּיִם׃ וּמִמַּטֵּה יִשָּׂשכָר אֶת־קִשְׁיוֹן וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ אֶת־
כט דָּבְרַת וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ׃ אֶת־יַרְמוּת וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ אֶת־עֵין גַּנִּים וְאֶת־
ל מִגְרָשָׁהּ עָרִים אַרְבָּע׃ וּמִמַּטֵּה אָשֵׁר אֶת־מִשְׁאָל וְאֶת־
לא מִגְרָשָׁהּ אֶת־עַבְדּוֹן וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ׃ אֶת־חֶלְקָת וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ וְאֶת־רְחֹב
לב וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ עָרִים אַרְבָּע׃ וּמִמַּטֵּה נַפְתָּלִי אֶת־עִיר ו
מִקְלַט הָרֹצֵחַ אֶת־קֶדֶשׁ בַּגָּלִיל וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ וְאֶת־חַמֹּת דֹּאר וְאֶת־
לג מִגְרָשָׁהּ וְאֶת־קַרְתָּן וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ עָרִים שָׁלֹשׁ׃ כָּל־עָרֵי הַגֵּרְשֻׁנִּי
לד לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם שְׁלֹשׁ־עֶשְׂרֵה עִיר וּמִגְרְשֵׁיהֶן׃ וּלְמִשְׁפְּחוֹת
בְּנֵי־מְרָרִי הַלְוִיִּם הַנּוֹתָרִים מֵאַת מַטֵּה זְבוּלֻן אֶת־יָקְנְעָם וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ
לה אֶת־קַרְתָּה וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ׃ אֶת־דִּמְנָה וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ אֶת־נַהֲלָל וְאֶת־
לו מִגְרָשָׁהּ עָרִים אַרְבָּע׃ °° וּמִמַּטֵּה־גָד אֶת־עִיר מִקְלַט הָרֹצֵחַ
לז אֶת־רָמֹת בַּגִּלְעָד וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ וְאֶת־מַחֲנַיִם וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ׃ אֶת־חֶשְׁבּוֹן
לח וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ אֶת־יַעְזֵר וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ כָּל־עָרִים אַרְבָּע׃ כָּל־
הֶעָרִים לִבְנֵי מְרָרִי לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם הַנּוֹתָרִים מִמִּשְׁפְּחוֹת הַלְוִיִּם וַיְהִי
לט גּוֹרָלָם עָרִים שְׁתֵּים עֶשְׂרֵה׃ כֹּל עָרֵי הַלְוִיִּם בְּתוֹךְ אֲחֻזַּת בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל
מ עָרִים אַרְבָּעִים וּשְׁמֹנֶה וּמִגְרְשֵׁיהֶן׃ תְּהִיֶּינָה הֶעָרִים הָאֵלֶּה עִיר עִיר
מא וּמִגְרְשֶׁיהָ סְבִיבֹתֶיהָ כֵּן לְכָל־הֶעָרִים הָאֵלֶּה׃ וַיִּתֵּן יהוה
לְיִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת־כָּל־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר נִשְׁבַּע לָתֵת לַאֲבוֹתָם וַיִּרְשׁוּהָ וַיֵּשְׁבוּ
מב בָהּ׃ וַיָּנַח יהוה לָהֶם מִסָּבִיב כְּכֹל אֲשֶׁר־נִשְׁבַּע לַאֲבוֹתָם וְלֹא־עָמַד
מג אִישׁ בִּפְנֵיהֶם מִכָּל־אֹיְבֵיהֶם אֵת כָּל־אֹיְבֵיהֶם נָתַן יהוה בְּיָדָם׃ לֹא־
נָפַל דָּבָר מִכֹּל הַדָּבָר הַטּוֹב אֲשֶׁר־דִּבֶּר יהוה אֶל־בֵּית יִשְׂרָאֵל הַכֹּל

°° בקצת ספרים אחר פסוק לה׃

וּמִמַּטֵּה רְאוּבֵן אֶת־בֶּצֶר וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ וְאֶת־יַהְצָה וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ׃
אֶת־קֶדֵמוֹת וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ וְאֶת־מֵיפַעַת וְאֶת־מִגְרָשָׁהּ עָרִים אַרְבָּע׃

22

Farewell to Reuben, Gad and Manasseh

*1 Then Joshua summoned the Reubenite, and the Gadite and half of the tribe of Manasseh. * 2 He said to them, "You have observed all that Moses, the servant of HASHEM, has commanded you, and you have obeyed my voice, in all that I have commanded you. 3 You have not forsaken your brethren these many days — until this day; you have kept the charge of the commandment of HASHEM, your God. 4 And now HASHEM, your God, has granted rest to your brethren as He had told them; so now turn and go to your tents, to the land of your possession, which Moses, the servant of HASHEM, gave you across the Jordan. 5 Only be very careful to fulfill the commandment and the Torah that Moses, the servant of HASHEM, commanded you: to love HASHEM, your God, and to walk in all His ways and to observe His commandments and to cling to Him and to serve Him with all your heart and with all your soul." 6 Then Joshua blessed them and sent them forth, and they went to their tents.*

*7 To half the tribe of Manasseh, Moses had given [territory] in the Bashan, and to half of it, Joshua had given [territory] among their brothers on the western side of the Jordan. When Joshua sent them away to their dwellings he blessed them, as well. * 8 And he said to them saying, "With much wealth return to your tents, and with very much cattle, with silver, gold, copper, and iron, and garments, very much. Divide the spoils of your enemies with your brothers."**

9 They returned and went — the children of Reuben, the children of Gad, and half the tribe of Manasseh — from the Children of Israel, from Shiloh that is in the land of Canaan, to go to the land of Gilead, to the land of their possession, of which they took possession in accordance with the word of HASHEM through the hand of Moses. 10 They came to the regions of the Jordan that are in the land of Canaan. The children of Reuben, the children of Gad, and half the tribe of Manasseh built an altar there, near the Jordan — a large altar as a showpiece. 11 The Children of Israel heard, saying, "Behold, the children of Reuben, the children of Gad, and half the tribe of Manasseh have built the altar opposite the land of Canaan in the regions of the Jordan, across from the side of the Children of Israel." 12 When the Children of Israel heard, the entire assembly of the Children of Israel congregated at Shiloh to advance upon them with an army.

The suspected rebellion

13 To the children of Reuben, the children of Gad, and half the tribe of Manasseh, the Children of Israel sent Phineas the son of Elazar the Kohen to the land of Gilead. 14 Ten leaders were with him, one head of an ancestral family for each tribe of Israel; each man was the head of his ancestral family of the thousands of Israel. 15 They came to the children of Reuben, the children of Gad, and half the tribe of Manasseh, to the land of Gilead, and they spoke with them, saying, 16 "Thus said the entire assembly of HASHEM: 'What is this treachery that you have committed against the God of Israel — to turn away from HASHEM this day, by building for yourselves an altar for your rebellion this day against HASHEM? 17 Is the sin of Peor not enough for us — from which we have not become cleansed until this day, and which resulted in the plague in the assembly of HASHEM? 18 Yet today you would turn away from HASHEM? If you rebel against HASHEM today, tomorrow He will be angry with the entire assembly of Israel.*

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blessed half of Manasseh along with Gad and Reuben, the other eastern tribes (*Radak*).

22:8. Joshua applied the principle that the warriors should share the spoils with those who had remained behind to guard the women, children, and property (*Rashi*).

22:17. See *Numbers* 24:1-9.

כב א בָּא: אָז יִקְרָא יְהוֹשֻׁעַ לָרְאוּבֵנִי וְלַגָּדִי וְלַחֲצִי מַטֵּה מְנַשֶּׁה:
ב וַיֹּאמֶר אֲלֵיהֶם אַתֶּם שְׁמַרְתֶּם אֵת כָּל־אֲשֶׁר צִוָּה אֶתְכֶם מֹשֶׁה עֶבֶד יְהוָה
ג וַתִּשְׁמְעוּ בְקוֹלִי לְכֹל אֲשֶׁר־צִוִּיתִי אֶתְכֶם: לֹא־עֲזַבְתֶּם אֶת־אֲחֵיכֶם זֶה
יָמִים רַבִּים עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה וּשְׁמַרְתֶּם אֶת־מִשְׁמֶרֶת מִצְוַת יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם:
ד וְעַתָּה הֵנִיחַ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם לַאֲחֵיכֶם כַּאֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר לָהֶם וְעַתָּה פְּנוּ וּלְכוּ
לָכֶם לְאָהֳלֵיכֶם אֶל־אֶרֶץ אֲחֻזַּתְכֶם אֲשֶׁר ׀ נָתַן לָכֶם מֹשֶׁה עֶבֶד יְהוָה
ה בְּעֵבֶר הַיַּרְדֵּן: רַק ׀ שִׁמְרוּ מְאֹד לַעֲשׂוֹת אֶת־הַמִּצְוָה וְאֶת־הַתּוֹרָה אֲשֶׁר
צִוָּה אֶתְכֶם מֹשֶׁה עֶבֶד־יְהוָה לְאַהֲבָה אֶת־יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם וְלָלֶכֶת בְּכָל־
דְּרָכָיו וְלִשְׁמֹר מִצְוֹתָיו וּלְדָבְקָה־בוֹ וּלְעָבְדוֹ בְּכָל־לְבַבְכֶם וּבְכָל־נַפְשְׁכֶם:
ו־ז וַיְבָרְכֵם יְהוֹשֻׁעַ וַיְשַׁלְּחֵם וַיֵּלְכוּ אֶל־אָהֳלֵיהֶם: וְלַחֲצִי ׀
שֵׁבֶט הַמְנַשֶּׁה נָתַן מֹשֶׁה בַּבָּשָׁן וּלְחֶצְיוֹ נָתַן יְהוֹשֻׁעַ עִם־אֲחֵיהֶם °מעבר
[°בְּעֵבֶר ק׳] הַיַּרְדֵּן יָמָּה וְגַם כִּי שִׁלְּחָם יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶל־אָהֳלֵיהֶם וַיְבָרְכֵם:
ח וַיֹּאמֶר אֲלֵיהֶם לֵאמֹר בִּנְכָסִים רַבִּים שׁוּבוּ אֶל־אָהֳלֵיכֶם וּבְמִקְנֶה רַב־
מְאֹד בְּכֶסֶף וּבְזָהָב וּבְנְחֹשֶׁת וּבְבַרְזֶל וּבְשִׂלְמֹות הַרְבֵּה מְאֹד חִלְקוּ שְׁלַל־
ט אֹיְבֵיכֶם עִם־אֲחֵיכֶם: וַיָּשֻׁבוּ וַיֵּלְכוּ בְּנֵי־רְאוּבֵן וּבְנֵי־גָד
וַחֲצִי ׀ שֵׁבֶט הַמְנַשֶּׁה מֵאֵת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל מִשִּׁלֹה אֲשֶׁר־בְּאֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן לָלֶכֶת
אֶל־אֶרֶץ הַגִּלְעָד אֶל־אֶרֶץ אֲחֻזָּתָם אֲשֶׁר נֶאֱחֻזוּ־בָהּ עַל־פִּי יְהוָה בְּיַד־
י מֹשֶׁה: וַיָּבֹאוּ אֶל־גְּלִילוֹת הַיַּרְדֵּן אֲשֶׁר בְּאֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן וַיִּבְנוּ בְנֵי־רְאוּבֵן וּבְנֵי־
גָד וַחֲצִי שֵׁבֶט הַמְנַשֶּׁה שָׁם מִזְבֵּחַ עַל־הַיַּרְדֵּן מִזְבֵּחַ גָּדוֹל לְמַרְאֶה:
יא וַיִּשְׁמְעוּ בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל לֵאמֹר הִנֵּה־בָנוּ בְנֵי־רְאוּבֵן וּבְנֵי־גָד וַחֲצִי שֵׁבֶט
הַמְנַשֶּׁה אֶת־הַמִּזְבֵּחַ אֶל־מוּל אֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן אֶל־גְּלִילוֹת הַיַּרְדֵּן אֶל־עֵבֶר
יב בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל: וַיִּשְׁמְעוּ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיִּקָּהֲלוּ כָּל־עֲדַת בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל שִׁלֹה
יג לַעֲלוֹת עֲלֵיהֶם לַצָּבָא: וַיִּשְׁלְחוּ בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶל־בְּנֵי־
רְאוּבֵן וְאֶל־בְּנֵי־גָד וְאֶל־חֲצִי שֵׁבֶט־מְנַשֶּׁה אֶל־אֶרֶץ הַגִּלְעָד אֶת־פִּינְחָס
יד בֶּן־אֶלְעָזָר הַכֹּהֵן: וַעֲשָׂרָה נְשִׂאִים עִמּוֹ נָשִׂיא אֶחָד נָשִׂיא אֶחָד לְבֵית אָב
טו לְכֹל מַטּוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל וְאִישׁ רֹאשׁ בֵּית־אֲבוֹתָם הֵמָּה לַאַלְפֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל: וַיָּבֹאוּ
אֶל־בְּנֵי־רְאוּבֵן וְאֶל־בְּנֵי־גָד וְאֶל־חֲצִי שֵׁבֶט־מְנַשֶּׁה אֶל־אֶרֶץ הַגִּלְעָד
טז וַיְדַבְּרוּ אִתָּם לֵאמֹר: כֹּה אָמְרוּ כָּל ׀ עֲדַת יְהוָה מָה־הַמַּעַל הַזֶּה אֲשֶׁר
מְעַלְתֶּם בֵּאלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לָשׁוּב הַיּוֹם מֵאַחֲרֵי יְהוָה בִּבְנוֹתְכֶם לָכֶם מִזְבֵּחַ
יז לִמְרָדְכֶם הַיּוֹם בַּיהוָה: הַמְעַט־לָנוּ אֶת־עֲוֹן פְּעוֹר אֲשֶׁר לֹא־הִטַּהַרְנוּ
יח מִמֶּנּוּ עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה וַיְהִי הַנֶּגֶף בַּעֲדַת יְהוָה: וְאַתֶּם תָּשֻׁבוּ הַיּוֹם מֵאַחֲרֵי
יְהוָה וְהָיָה אַתֶּם תִּמְרְדוּ הַיּוֹם בַּיהוָה וּמָחָר אֶל־כָּל־עֲדַת יִשְׂרָאֵל יִקְצֹף:

22:1. The two-and-a-half tribes east of the Jordan were in a uniquely precarious position. Their separation from the bulk of their brethren created the danger that they would view themselves as a separate nation. This chapter deals with this fear and the entire nation's efforts to prevent it from happening.

22:7. This parenthetical verse explains why Joshua

19 But if the land of your possession is contaminated, cross over to the land of HASHEM's possession where the Sanctuary of HASHEM is, and take your possession among us; but do not rebel against HASHEM and do not rebel against us by building for yourselves an altar other than the Altar of HASHEM, our God. 20 Did not Achan son of Zerah commit treachery* regarding the consecrated property, and wrath fell upon the entire assembly of Israel? That man was not the only one to perish for his sin!' "*

The explanation

21 The children of Reuben, the children of Gad, and half the tribe of Manasseh responded and spoke to the heads of the thousands of Israel, 22 "Almighty, God, HASHEM; Almighty, God, HASHEM: He knows and Israel shall know. If it is in rebellion or in treachery against HASHEM, save us not this day. 23 [If we meant] to build an altar for ourselves to turn away from following HASHEM, or to offer an elevation-offering or meal-offering upon it, or to offer peace-offerings upon it, let HASHEM Himself exact [retribution], 24 if we did not do this out of fear, saying [to ourselves]: In the future your children might say to our children, 'What have you to do with HASHEM the God of Israel? 25 HASHEM has established a border between us and you, O children of Reuben and children of Gad — the Jordan! You have no share in HASHEM!' So your children will cause our children to stop fearing HASHEM. 26 Therefore, we said, 'Let us do this for ourselves — to build the altar, not for elevation-offering and not for sacrifice, 27 but so that it will be a witness between us and you and our generations after us, to perform the service of HASHEM before Him with our elevation-offerings, and with our offerings and with our peace-offerings.' Then your children will not say to our children in the future, 'You have no share in HASHEM.' 28 So we said, 'When they say this to us or to our generations tomorrow, we will say, "See the structure of the altar of HASHEM that our fathers made — not for elevation-offering and not for offering, but as a testimony between us and you." ' 29 It would be sacrilegious for us to rebel against HASHEM and to turn away this day from following HASHEM, to build an altar for burnt-offering, meal-offering, and sacrifice — other than the Altar of HASHEM, our God, which is before His Sanctuary!"*

The rest of the tribes approve

*30 When Phineas the Kohen and the leaders of the assembly and the heads of the thousands of Israel that were with him heard the words that the children of Reuben, the children of Gad and the children of Manasseh spoke, it was good in their eyes. 31 And Phineas son of Elazar the Kohen said to the children of Reuben, the children of Gad, and the children of Manasseh, "Today we know that HASHEM is in our midst, since you did not commit this treachery against HASHEM. Now you have saved the Children of Israel from the hand of HASHEM."**

32 Then Phineas son of Elazar the Kohen and the leaders returned from the children of Reuben and the children of Gad, from the land of Gilead, to the land of Canaan, to the Children of Israel, and they gave them a report. 33 The matter was good in the eyes of the Children of Israel; and the Children of Israel blessed God and no longer spoke of advancing upon them with an army, to destroy the land in which the children of Reuben and the children of Gad dwelled. 34 The children of Reuben and the children of Gad named the altar ["Witness"], for "it is a witness between us that HASHEM is God."

יט וְאַךְ אִם־טְמֵאָה אֶרֶץ אֲחֻזַּתְכֶם עִבְרוּ לָכֶם אֶל־אֶרֶץ אֲחֻזַּת יהוה אֲשֶׁר
שֶׁכַן־שָׁם מִשְׁכַּן יהוה וְהֵאָחֲזוּ בְּתוֹכֵנוּ וּבַיהוָה אַל־תִּמְרֹדוּ וְאֹתָנוּ אַל־
כ תִּמְרֹדוּ בִּבְנֹתְכֶם לָכֶם מִזְבֵּחַ מִבַּלְעֲדֵי מִזְבַּח יהוה אֱלֹהֵינוּ: הֲלוֹא ׀ עָכָן
בֶּן־זֶרַח מָעַל מַעַל בַּחֵרֶם וְעַל־כָּל־עֲדַת יִשְׂרָאֵל הָיָה קֶצֶף וְהוּא אִישׁ
כא אֶחָד לֹא גָוַע בַּעֲוֹנוֹ: וַיַּעֲנוּ בְּנֵי־רְאוּבֵן וּבְנֵי־גָד וַחֲצִי שֵׁבֶט
כב הַמְנַשֶּׁה וַיְדַבְּרוּ אֶת־רָאשֵׁי אַלְפֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל: אֵל ׀ אֱלֹהִים ׀ יהוה אֵל ׀
אֱלֹהִים ׀ יהוה הוּא יֹדֵעַ וְיִשְׂרָאֵל הוּא יֵדָע אִם־בְּמֶרֶד וְאִם־בְּמַעַל
כג בַּיהוָה אַל־תּוֹשִׁיעֵנוּ הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה: לִבְנוֹת לָנוּ מִזְבֵּחַ לָשׁוּב מֵאַחֲרֵי יהוה
וְאִם־לְהַעֲלוֹת עָלָיו עוֹלָה וּמִנְחָה וְאִם־לַעֲשׂוֹת עָלָיו זִבְחֵי שְׁלָמִים יהוה
כד הוּא יְבַקֵּשׁ: וְאִם־לֹא מִדְּאָגָה מִדָּבָר עָשִׂינוּ אֶת־זֹאת לֵאמֹר מָחָר יֹאמְרוּ
כה בְנֵיכֶם לְבָנֵינוּ לֵאמֹר מַה־לָּכֶם וְלַיהוה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל: וּגְבוּל נָתַן־יהוה
בֵּינֵנוּ וּבֵינֵיכֶם בְּנֵי־רְאוּבֵן וּבְנֵי־גָד אֶת־הַיַּרְדֵּן אֵין־לָכֶם חֵלֶק בַּיהוָה
כו וְהִשְׁבִּיתוּ בְנֵיכֶם אֶת־בָּנֵינוּ לְבִלְתִּי יְרֹא אֶת־יהוה: וַנֹּאמֶר נַעֲשֶׂה־נָּא לָנוּ
כז לִבְנוֹת אֶת־הַמִּזְבֵּחַ לֹא לְעוֹלָה וְלֹא לְזֶבַח: כִּי עֵד הוּא בֵּינֵנוּ וּבֵינֵיכֶם
וּבֵין דֹּרוֹתֵינוּ אַחֲרֵינוּ לַעֲבֹד אֶת־עֲבֹדַת יהוה לְפָנָיו בְּעֹלוֹתֵינוּ וּבִזְבָחֵינוּ
וּבִשְׁלָמֵינוּ וְלֹא־יֹאמְרוּ בְנֵיכֶם מָחָר לְבָנֵינוּ אֵין־לָכֶם חֵלֶק בַּיהוָה:
כח וַנֹּאמֶר וְהָיָה כִּי־יֹאמְרוּ אֵלֵינוּ וְאֶל־דֹּרֹתֵינוּ מָחָר וְאָמַרְנוּ רְאוּ אֶת־
תַּבְנִית מִזְבַּח יהוה אֲשֶׁר־עָשׂוּ אֲבוֹתֵינוּ לֹא לְעוֹלָה וְלֹא לְזֶבַח כִּי־עֵד
כט הוּא בֵּינֵנוּ וּבֵינֵיכֶם: חָלִילָה לָּנוּ מִמֶּנּוּ לִמְרֹד בַּיהוה וְלָשׁוּב הַיּוֹם
מֵאַחֲרֵי יהוה לִבְנוֹת מִזְבֵּחַ לְעֹלָה לְמִנְחָה וּלְזֶבַח מִלְּבַד מִזְבַּח יהוה
ל אֱלֹהֵינוּ אֲשֶׁר לִפְנֵי מִשְׁכָּנוֹ: וַיִּשְׁמַע פִּינְחָס הַכֹּהֵן וּנְשִׂיאֵי
הָעֵדָה וְרָאשֵׁי אַלְפֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֲשֶׁר אִתּוֹ אֶת־הַדְּבָרִים אֲשֶׁר דִּבְּרוּ בְּנֵי־
לא רְאוּבֵן וּבְנֵי־גָד וּבְנֵי מְנַשֶּׁה וַיִּיטַב בְּעֵינֵיהֶם: וַיֹּאמֶר פִּינְחָס בֶּן־אֶלְעָזָר
הַכֹּהֵן אֶל־בְּנֵי־רְאוּבֵן וְאֶל־בְּנֵי־גָד וְאֶל־בְּנֵי מְנַשֶּׁה הַיּוֹם יָדַעְנוּ כִּי־
בְתוֹכֵנוּ יהוה אֲשֶׁר לֹא־מְעַלְתֶּם בַּיהוה הַמַּעַל הַזֶּה אָז הִצַּלְתֶּם אֶת־בְּנֵי
לב יִשְׂרָאֵל מִיַּד יהוה: וַיָּשָׁב פִּינְחָס בֶּן־אֶלְעָזָר הַכֹּהֵן ׀ וְהַנְּשִׂיאִים מֵאֵת בְּנֵי־
רְאוּבֵן וּמֵאֵת בְּנֵי־גָד מֵאֶרֶץ הַגִּלְעָד אֶל־אֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן אֶל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל
לג וַיָּשִׁבוּ אוֹתָם דָּבָר: וַיִּיטַב הַדָּבָר בְּעֵינֵי בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיְבָרְכוּ אֱלֹהִים בְּנֵי
יִשְׂרָאֵל וְלֹא אָמְרוּ לַעֲלוֹת עֲלֵיהֶם לַצָּבָא לְשַׁחֵת אֶת־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר בְּנֵי־
לד רְאוּבֵן וּבְנֵי־גָד יֹשְׁבִים בָּהּ: וַיִּקְרְאוּ בְּנֵי־רְאוּבֵן וּבְנֵי־גָד לַמִּזְבֵּחַ כִּי־עֵד
הוּא בֵּינֹתֵינוּ כִּי יהוה הָאֱלֹהִים:

22:19. If you consider the east bank of the Jordan to lack the sanctity of Eretz Yisrael because the Tabernacle is not there (*Radak*), then join your brethren in the west and we will redistribute the land to give you portions among us.

22:20. Achan's sin is recorded in Chapter 7.

22:22. They were addressing God, as it were, saying that if they were not sincere, He should not save them (*Rashi*).

22:31. Your explanation has prevented the calamity of future generations sinning in the manner you described (*Metzudos*), or an attack against innocent people.

23

JOSHUA'S FAREWELL 23:1-24:33

Joshua encourages and admonishes the people

1 It happened many days after HASHEM had given rest to Israel from all their
surrounding enemies, and Joshua was old, well on in years: 2 Joshua
summoned all of Israel* — their elders, their heads, their judges, and their
marshals — and said to them, "I have aged and am well on in years. 3 You have
seen all that HASHEM, your God, has done to all these nations before you; that
HASHEM, your God, has fought for you. 4 See, I have allotted to you [the
territories of] these remaining nations as a heritage for your tribes, from the
Jordan, including all the nations that I have destroyed, up to the Great Sea
toward the setting of the sun. 5 HASHEM, your God, will push them out from your
presence and drive them out from before you, and you will inherit their land, as
HASHEM, your God, has spoken to you. 6 Strengthen yourselves very much to

Do not deviate from the Torah and avoid mingling with the nations . . .

observe and to do all that is written in the book of the Torah of Moses, not to
deviate from it to the right or to the left, 7 not to come into these nations, those
who still remain with you; you shall not mention the name of their gods and you
shall not cause others to swear by them, you shall not serve them and you shall
not bow down to them. 8 Only cling to HASHEM, your God, as you have done up
to this day. 9 HASHEM has driven out great and powerful nations from before
you, and not a man has stood against you, to this day. 10 One of you chased
a thousand, because HASHEM, your God, it is He Who fought for you, as He
spoke to you.

. . . or you will forfeit God's help

11 "You shall beware greatly for your souls, to love HASHEM, your God. 12 For
if you should turn away and cling to the rest of these nations, these which
remain with you, by intermarrying with them and coming into them and they
into you, 13 you should know with certainty that HASHEM, your God, will not
continue to drive these nations out from before you; they will be a snare and an
obstacle to you, a lash in your sides and thorns in your eyes, until you are
banished from this goodly land that HASHEM, your God, has given to you.
14 Behold, this day I am going the way of all the world. You know with all your
heart and with all your soul that not one of all the good things that HASHEM your
God has promised you has fallen short; all have come about for you, not one
word of it has fallen short.

Otherwise you will be banished

15 "But it shall be that just as every good thing that HASHEM, your God, has
told you has come to you, so will HASHEM bring upon you every bad thing until
He will have eliminated you from upon this goodly land that HASHEM, your God,
has given you. 16 If you transgress the covenant of HASHEM, your God, that He
has commanded you, and you go and serve gods of others and bow down to
them, the wrath of HASHEM will burn against you, and you will perish swiftly
from the goodly land that He has given you."

24

A second assembly

1 Joshua assembled all the tribes of Israel at Shechem; he summoned the
elders of Israel, their heads, their judges, and their officers, and they
stood before God.* 2 Joshua said to the entire nation, "Thus said HASHEM,

victories. He summoned the entire nation and explained to them that their success was dependent not on his presence, but rather upon their faithfulness to the Torah. If they would be scrupulous in their observance, then God would continue to make them victorious. If, however, they would fail in their observance, then the Canaanites would remain and be a thorn in their sides (v. 13).

24:1. Joshua convoked a second assembly of the Israelites before his death. He reviewed the panorama of Jewish history and recounted God's manifold kindness to the Jewish people. Then he urged them to remain loyal to God, and to destroy any gold and silver objects used for idol worship that were in their possession. Finally, just as Moses had done before his death, Joshua urged them to reaffirm their adherence to the Torah.

כג

א וַיְהִי מִיָּמִים רַבִּים אַחֲרֵי אֲשֶׁר־הֵנִיחַ יהוה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל מִכָּל־אֹיְבֵיהֶם
ב מִסָּבִיב וִיהוֹשֻׁעַ זָקֵן בָּא בַּיָּמִים: וַיִּקְרָא יְהוֹשֻׁעַ לְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל לִזְקֵנָיו
וּלְרָאשָׁיו וּלְשֹׁפְטָיו וּלְשֹׁטְרָיו וַיֹּאמֶר אֲלֵהֶם אֲנִי זָקַנְתִּי בָּאתִי בַּיָּמִים:
ג וְאַתֶּם רְאִיתֶם אֵת כָּל־אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה יהוה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם לְכָל־הַגּוֹיִם הָאֵלֶּה
ד מִפְּנֵיכֶם כִּי יהוה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם הוּא הַנִּלְחָם לָכֶם: רְאוּ הִפַּלְתִּי לָכֶם אֶת־
הַגּוֹיִם הַנִּשְׁאָרִים הָאֵלֶּה בְּנַחֲלָה לְשִׁבְטֵיכֶם מִן־הַיַּרְדֵּן וְכָל־הַגּוֹיִם
ה אֲשֶׁר הִכְרַתִּי וְהַיָּם הַגָּדוֹל מְבוֹא הַשָּׁמֶשׁ: וַיהוה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם הוּא יֶהְדֳּפֵם
מִפְּנֵיכֶם וְהוֹרִישׁ אֹתָם מִלִּפְנֵיכֶם וִירִשְׁתֶּם אֶת־אַרְצָם כַּאֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר
ו יהוה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם לָכֶם: וַחֲזַקְתֶּם מְאֹד לִשְׁמֹר וְלַעֲשׂוֹת אֵת כָּל־הַכָּתוּב
ז בְּסֵפֶר תּוֹרַת מֹשֶׁה לְבִלְתִּי סוּר־מִמֶּנּוּ יָמִין וּשְׂמֹאול: לְבִלְתִּי־בוֹא בַּגּוֹיִם
הָאֵלֶּה הַנִּשְׁאָרִים הָאֵלֶּה אִתְּכֶם וּבְשֵׁם אֱלֹהֵיהֶם לֹא־תַזְכִּירוּ וְלֹא
ח תַשְׁבִּיעוּ וְלֹא תַעַבְדוּם וְלֹא תִשְׁתַּחֲוּ לָהֶם: כִּי אִם־בַּיהוה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם
ט תִּדְבָּקוּ כַּאֲשֶׁר עֲשִׂיתֶם עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה: וַיּוֹרֶשׁ יהוה מִפְּנֵיכֶם גּוֹיִם גְּדֹלִים
י וַעֲצוּמִים וְאַתֶּם לֹא־עָמַד אִישׁ בִּפְנֵיכֶם עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה: אִישׁ־אֶחָד מִכֶּם
יִרְדֹּף־אֶלֶף כִּי | יהוה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם הוּא הַנִּלְחָם לָכֶם כַּאֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר לָכֶם:
יא־יב וְנִשְׁמַרְתֶּם מְאֹד לְנַפְשֹׁתֵיכֶם לְאַהֲבָה אֶת־יהוה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם: כִּי | אִם־
שׁוֹב תָּשׁוּבוּ וּדְבַקְתֶּם בְּיֶתֶר הַגּוֹיִם הָאֵלֶּה הַנִּשְׁאָרִים הָאֵלֶּה אִתְּכֶם
יג וְהִתְחַתַּנְתֶּם בָּהֶם וּבָאתֶם בָּהֶם וְהֵם בָּכֶם: יָדוֹעַ תֵּדְעוּ כִּי לֹא יוֹסִיף
יהוה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם לְהוֹרִישׁ אֶת־הַגּוֹיִם הָאֵלֶּה מִלִּפְנֵיכֶם וְהָיוּ לָכֶם לְפַח
וּלְמוֹקֵשׁ וּלְשֹׁטֵט בְּצִדֵּיכֶם וְלִצְנִנִים בְּעֵינֵיכֶם עַד־אָבְדְכֶם מֵעַל הָאֲדָמָה
יד הַטּוֹבָה הַזֹּאת אֲשֶׁר נָתַן לָכֶם יהוה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם: וְהִנֵּה אָנֹכִי הוֹלֵךְ הַיּוֹם
בְּדֶרֶךְ כָּל־הָאָרֶץ וִידַעְתֶּם בְּכָל־לְבַבְכֶם וּבְכָל־נַפְשְׁכֶם כִּי לֹא־נָפַל
דָּבָר אֶחָד מִכֹּל | הַדְּבָרִים הַטּוֹבִים אֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר יהוה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם עֲלֵיכֶם
טו הַכֹּל בָּאוּ לָכֶם לֹא־נָפַל מִמֶּנּוּ דָּבָר אֶחָד: וְהָיָה כַּאֲשֶׁר־בָּא עֲלֵיכֶם
כָּל־הַדָּבָר הַטּוֹב אֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר יהוה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם אֲלֵיכֶם כֵּן יָבִיא יהוה עֲלֵיכֶם
אֵת כָּל־הַדָּבָר הָרָע עַד־הַשְׁמִידוֹ אוֹתְכֶם מֵעַל הָאֲדָמָה הַטּוֹבָה
טז הַזֹּאת אֲשֶׁר נָתַן לָכֶם יהוה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם: בְּעָבְרְכֶם אֶת־בְּרִית יהוה
אֱלֹהֵיכֶם אֲשֶׁר צִוָּה אֶתְכֶם וַהֲלַכְתֶּם וַעֲבַדְתֶּם אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים
וְהִשְׁתַּחֲוִיתֶם לָהֶם וְחָרָה אַף־יהוה בָּכֶם וַאֲבַדְתֶּם מְהֵרָה מֵעַל הָאָרֶץ

כד

א הַטּוֹבָה אֲשֶׁר נָתַן לָכֶם: וַיֶּאֱסֹף יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶת־כָּל־שִׁבְטֵי
יִשְׂרָאֵל שְׁכֶמָה וַיִּקְרָא לִזְקֵנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וּלְרָאשָׁיו וּלְשֹׁפְטָיו וּלְשֹׁטְרָיו
ב וַיִּתְיַצְּבוּ לִפְנֵי הָאֱלֹהִים: וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶל־כָּל־הָעָם כֹּה־אָמַר יהוה

23:2. At the end of his life, Joshua was acutely aware that many Canaanites still remained in the land. He knew that these idolaters were a threat to the existence of the Israelites, and that without his leadership, the Israelites might lose confidence in their worthiness of the Divine protection that had assured their previous

the God of Israel: 'Your forefathers — Terah, the father of Abraham and the father of Nahor — always dwelt beyond the [Euphrates] River and they served gods of others. [3] *But I took your forefather Abraham from beyond the River and led him throughout all the land of Canaan; I multiplied his seed and I gave him Isaac.* [4] *To Isaac I gave Jacob and Esau. To Esau I gave Mount Seir to inherit, and Jacob and his sons went down to Egypt.*

[5] *" 'I sent Moses and Aaron, and I plagued Egypt with all that I did in their midst, and afterwards I brought you out.* [6] *I brought your forefathers out of Egypt and you arrived at the sea. The Egyptians pursued your forefathers with chariot and horsemen to the Sea of Reeds.* [7] *They cried out to HASHEM, and He placed darkness between you and the Egyptians and brought the sea upon them and covered them — your own eyes saw what I did with the Egyptians — and then you dwelled in the Wilderness for many years.* ¶ *I brought you to the land of the Amorite, who dwelled across the Jordan, and they battled with you, but I delivered them into your hand and you inherited their land; I destroyed them from before you.* [9] *Then Balak the son of Zippor, king of Moab, arose and battled against Israel. He sent and summoned Balaam son of Beor to curse you,* [10] *but I refused to listen to Balaam, and he pronounced a blessing upon you; thus I rescued you from his power.*

[11] *" 'Then you crossed the Jordan and came to Jericho. The inhabitants of Jericho battled against you — the Amorite and the Perizzite and the Canaanite and the Hittite and the Girgashite, the Hivvite and the Jebusite — and I delivered them into your hand.* [12] *I sent the hornet-swarm ahead of you, and it drove them out before you — the two kings of the Amorite — not by your sword and not by your bow.* [13] *I gave you a land for which you did not labor and cities that you did not build, yet you occupied them; vineyards and olive groves that you did not plant, yet you are eating from them.'*

Joshua's discourse

[14] *"And now, fear HASHEM and serve Him with wholeheartedness and truth; remove the gods that your forefathers served on the other side of the River and in Egypt, and serve HASHEM.* [15] *If it is evil in your eyes to serve HASHEM, choose today whom you will serve: the gods your forefathers served across the River, or the gods of the Amorite in whose land you dwell. But as for me and my house, we will serve HASHEM!"*

[16] *The nation responded and said, "It would be sacrilegious for us to forsake HASHEM, to serve gods of others.* [17] *For it is HASHEM our God Who brought us and our fathers up from the land of Egypt, from the house of bondage, Who performed these great wondrous signs before our eyes; He safeguarded us on all the paths upon which we walked and among all the peoples in whose midst we passed.* [18] *HASHEM drove out all the peoples and the Amorite who inhabited the land from before us. We, too, will serve HASHEM, for He is our God!"*

[19] *But Joshua said to the people, "You will not be able to serve HASHEM, for He is a holy God; He is a jealous God; He will not forgive your rebellious sins or your transgressions.* [20] *If you forsake HASHEM and serve gods of the foreigner, He will turn and act harshly toward you and destroy you after having done good with you."*

[21] *The people said to Joshua, "No, we will serve only HASHEM!"* [22] *Joshua said*

אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּעֵבֶר הַנָּהָר יָשְׁבוּ אֲבוֹתֵיכֶם מֵעוֹלָם תֶּרַח אֲבִי אַבְרָהָם
ג וַאֲבִי נָחוֹר וַיַּעַבְדוּ אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים: °וָאֶקַּח אֶת־אֲבִיכֶם אֶת־אַבְרָהָם
מֵעֵבֶר הַנָּהָר וָאוֹלֵךְ אוֹתוֹ בְּכָל־אֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן °וארב [°וָאַרְבֶּה ק׳] אֶת־זַרְעוֹ
ד וָאֶתֵּן־לוֹ אֶת־יִצְחָק: וָאֶתֵּן לְיִצְחָק אֶת־יַעֲקֹב וְאֶת־עֵשָׂו וָאֶתֵּן לְעֵשָׂו אֶת־
ה הַר שֵׂעִיר לָרֶשֶׁת אוֹתוֹ וְיַעֲקֹב וּבָנָיו יָרְדוּ מִצְרָיִם: וָאֶשְׁלַח אֶת־מֹשֶׁה
וְאֶת־אַהֲרֹן וָאֶגֹּף אֶת־מִצְרַיִם כַּאֲשֶׁר עָשִׂיתִי בְּקִרְבּוֹ וְאַחַר הוֹצֵאתִי
ו אֶתְכֶם: וָאוֹצִיא אֶת־אֲבוֹתֵיכֶם מִמִּצְרַיִם וַתָּבֹאוּ הַיָּמָּה וַיִּרְדְּפוּ מִצְרַיִם
ז אַחֲרֵי אֲבוֹתֵיכֶם בְּרֶכֶב וּבְפָרָשִׁים יַם־סוּף: וַיִּצְעֲקוּ אֶל־יהוה וַיָּשֶׂם מַאֲפֵל
בֵּינֵיכֶם ו וּבֵין הַמִּצְרִים וַיָּבֵא עָלָיו אֶת־הַיָּם וַיְכַסֵּהוּ וַתַּרְאֶינָה עֵינֵיכֶם אֵת
ח אֲשֶׁר־עָשִׂיתִי בְּמִצְרָיִם וַתֵּשְׁבוּ בַמִּדְבָּר יָמִים רַבִּים: °ואבאה [°וָאָבִיא ק׳]
אֶתְכֶם אֶל־אֶרֶץ הָאֱמֹרִי הַיּוֹשֵׁב בְּעֵבֶר הַיַّרְדֵּן וַיִּלָּחֲמוּ אִתְּכֶם וָאֶתֵּן אוֹתָם
ט בְּיֶדְכֶם וַתִּירְשׁוּ אֶת־אַרְצָם וָאַשְׁמִידֵם מִפְּנֵיכֶם: וַיָּקָם בָּלָק בֶּן־צִפּוֹר מֶלֶךְ
מוֹאָב וַיִּלָּחֶם בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל וַיִּשְׁלַח וַיִּקְרָא לְבִלְעָם בֶּן־בְּעוֹר לְקַלֵּל אֶתְכֶם:
י וְלֹא אָבִיתִי לִשְׁמֹעַ לְבִלְעָם וַיְבָרֵךְ בָּרוֹךְ אֶתְכֶם וָאַצֵּל אֶתְכֶם מִיָּדוֹ:
יא וַתַּעַבְרוּ אֶת־הַיַּרְדֵּן וַתָּבֹאוּ אֶל־יְרִיחוֹ וַיִּלָּחֲמוּ בָכֶם בַּעֲלֵי־יְרִיחוֹ הָאֱמֹרִי
וְהַפְּרִזִּי וְהַכְּנַעֲנִי וְהַחִתִּי וְהַגִּרְגָּשִׁי הַחִוִּי וְהַיְבוּסִי וָאֶתֵּן אוֹתָם בְּיֶדְכֶם:
יב וָאֶשְׁלַח לִפְנֵיכֶם אֶת־הַצִּרְעָה וַתְּגָרֶשׁ אוֹתָם מִפְּנֵיכֶם שְׁנֵי מַלְכֵי הָאֱמֹרִי
יג לֹא בְחַרְבְּךָ וְלֹא בְקַשְׁתֶּךָ: וָאֶתֵּן לָכֶם אֶרֶץ ו אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יָגַעְתָּ בָּהּ וְעָרִים
אֲשֶׁר לֹא־בְנִיתֶם וַתֵּשְׁבוּ בָּהֶם כְּרָמִים וְזֵיתִים אֲשֶׁר לֹא־נְטַעְתֶּם אַתֶּם
יד אֹכְלִים: וְעַתָּה יְרָאוּ אֶת־יהוה וְעִבְדוּ אֹתוֹ בְּתָמִים וּבֶאֱמֶת וְהָסִירוּ אֶת־
אֱלֹהִים אֲשֶׁר עָבְדוּ אֲבוֹתֵיכֶם בְּעֵבֶר הַנָּהָר וּבְמִצְרַיִם וְעִבְדוּ אֶת־יהוה:
טו וְאִם רַע בְּעֵינֵיכֶם לַעֲבֹד אֶת־יהוה בַּחֲרוּ לָכֶם הַיּוֹם אֶת־מִי תַעֲבֹדוּן אִם
אֶת־אֱלֹהִים אֲשֶׁר־עָבְדוּ אֲבוֹתֵיכֶם אֲשֶׁר °בעבר [°מֵעֵבֶר ק׳] הַנָּהָר וְאִם
אֶת־אֱלֹהֵי הָאֱמֹרִי אֲשֶׁר אַתֶּם יֹשְׁבִים בְּאַרְצָם וְאָנֹכִי וּבֵיתִי נַעֲבֹד אֶת־
טז יהוה: וַיַּעַן הָעָם וַיֹּאמֶר חָלִילָה לָּנוּ מֵעֲזֹב אֶת־יהוה לַעֲבֹד
יז אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים: כִּי יהוה אֱלֹהֵינוּ הוּא הַמַּעֲלֶה אֹתָנוּ וְאֶת־אֲבוֹתֵינוּ
מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם מִבֵּית עֲבָדִים וַאֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה לְעֵינֵינוּ אֶת־הָאֹתוֹת הַגְּדֹלוֹת
הָאֵלֶּה וַיִּשְׁמְרֵנוּ בְּכָל־הַדֶּרֶךְ אֲשֶׁר־הָלַכְנוּ בָהּ וּבְכֹל הָעַמִּים אֲשֶׁר עָבָרְנוּ
יח בְּקִרְבָּם: וַיְגָרֶשׁ יהוה אֶת־כָּל־הָעַמִּים וְאֶת־הָאֱמֹרִי יֹשֵׁב הָאָרֶץ מִפָּנֵינוּ
יט גַּם־אֲנַחְנוּ נַעֲבֹד אֶת־יהוה כִּי־הוּא אֱלֹהֵינוּ: וַיֹּאמֶר
יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶל־הָעָם לֹא תוּכְלוּ לַעֲבֹד אֶת־יהוה כִּי־אֱלֹהִים קְדֹשִׁים הוּא
כ אֵל־קַנּוֹא הוּא לֹא־יִשָּׂא לְפִשְׁעֲכֶם וּלְחַטֹּאתֵיכֶם: כִּי תַעֲזֹבוּ אֶת־יהוה
וַעֲבַדְתֶּם אֱלֹהֵי נֵכָר וְשָׁב וְהֵרַע לָכֶם וְכִלָּה אֶתְכֶם אַחֲרֵי אֲשֶׁר־הֵיטִיב
כא־כב לָכֶם: וַיֹּאמֶר הָעָם אֶל־יְהוֹשֻׁעַ לֹא כִּי אֶת־יהוה נַעֲבֹד: וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ

to the people, "You bear witness upon yourselves that you have chosen HASHEM, to serve Him";

and they said, "We are witnesses."

The covenant and conclusion

23 "So now, remove the gods of the foreigner that are among you and direct your hearts to HASHEM, the God of Israel." 24 The people replied to Joshua, "We shall serve HASHEM, our God, and we shall heed His voice."

25 Joshua made a covenant with the people that day and he set down decrees and laws for them in Shechem. 26 Joshua wrote these words [and placed them] with the Book of God's Torah.* He took a large stone and stood it there beneath the doorpost that was in the Sanctuary of HASHEM, 27 and Joshua declared to all the people, "Behold, this stone will be ■ witness for us, for it has heard all the words of HASHEM that He has spoken to us; it will be a witness against you if you ever deny your God." 28 Then Joshua sent the people forth, each man to his heritage.*

Joshua's death and burial
(See Appendix A, timeline 3)

29 It was after these events that Joshua son of Nun, the servant of HASHEM, died at the age of one hundred and ten years. 30 They buried him in the border of his heritage in Timnath-serah, which is in Mount Ephraim, north of Mount Gaash.

31 Israel served HASHEM all the days of Joshua and all the days of the Elders whose days were lengthened after Joshua, and who had known all the deeds of HASHEM, which He had done for Israel.

Joseph's burial

32 Joseph's bones, which the Children of Israel had brought up from Egypt, they buried in Shechem, in the portion of the field that Jacob acquired from the children of Hamor, the father of Shechem, for a hundred kesitahs; and it became a heritage for the children of Joseph.*

Elazar's death and burial

33 Elazar son of Aaron died, and they buried him in the Hill of Phinehas his son, which was given to him on Mount Ephraim.

אֶל־הָעָם עֵדִים אַתֶּם בָּכֶם כִּי־אַתֶּם בְּחַרְתֶּם לָכֶם אֶת־יהוה לַעֲבֹד אוֹתוֹ
כג וַיֹּאמְרוּ עֵדִים: וְעַתָּה הָסִירוּ אֶת־אֱלֹהֵי הַנֵּכָר אֲשֶׁר בְּקִרְבְּכֶם וְהַטּוּ אֶת־
כד לְבַבְכֶם אֶל־יהוה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל: וַיֹּאמְרוּ הָעָם אֶל־יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶת־יהוה
כה אֱלֹהֵינוּ נַעֲבֹד וּבְקוֹלוֹ נִשְׁמָע: וַיִּכְרֹת יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בְּרִית לָעָם בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא
כו וַיָּשֶׂם לוֹ חֹק וּמִשְׁפָּט בִּשְׁכֶם: וַיִּכְתֹּב יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶת־הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה בְּסֵפֶר
תּוֹרַת אֱלֹהִים וַיִּקַּח אֶבֶן גְּדוֹלָה וַיְקִימֶהָ שָׁם תַּחַת הָאַלָּה אֲשֶׁר בְּמִקְדַּשׁ
כז יהוה: וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶל־כָּל־הָעָם הִנֵּה הָאֶבֶן הַזֹּאת
תִּהְיֶה־בָּנוּ לְעֵדָה כִּי־הִיא שָׁמְעָה אֵת כָּל־אִמְרֵי יהוה אֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר עִמָּנוּ
כח וְהָיְתָה בָכֶם לְעֵדָה פֶּן־תְּכַחֲשׁוּן בֵּאלֹהֵיכֶם: וַיְשַׁלַּח יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶת־הָעָם
כט אִישׁ לְנַחֲלָתוֹ: וַיְהִי אַחֲרֵי הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה וַיָּמָת יְהוֹשֻׁעַ
ל בִּן־נוּן עֶבֶד יהוה בֶּן־מֵאָה וָעֶשֶׂר שָׁנִים: וַיִּקְבְּרוּ אֹתוֹ בִּגְבוּל נַחֲלָתוֹ
לא בְּתִמְנַת־סֶרַח אֲשֶׁר בְּהַר־אֶפְרָיִם מִצְּפוֹן לְהַר־גָּעַשׁ: וַיַּעֲבֹד יִשְׂרָאֵל
אֶת־יהוה כֹּל יְמֵי יְהוֹשֻׁעַ וְכֹל | יְמֵי הַזְּקֵנִים אֲשֶׁר הֶאֱרִיכוּ יָמִים אַחֲרֵי
לב יְהוֹשֻׁעַ וַאֲשֶׁר יָדְעוּ אֵת כָּל־מַעֲשֵׂה יהוה אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל: וְאֶת־
עַצְמוֹת יוֹסֵף אֲשֶׁר־הֶעֱלוּ בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל | מִמִּצְרַיִם קָבְרוּ בִשְׁכֶם בְּחֶלְקַת
הַשָּׂדֶה אֲשֶׁר קָנָה יַעֲקֹב מֵאֵת בְּנֵי־חֲמוֹר אֲבִי־שְׁכֶם בְּמֵאָה קְשִׂיטָה וַיֶּהְיוּ
לג לִבְנֵי־יוֹסֵף לְנַחֲלָה: וְאֶלְעָזָר בֶּן־אַהֲרֹן מֵת וַיִּקְבְּרוּ אֹתוֹ בְּגִבְעַת פִּינְחָס
בְּנוֹ אֲשֶׁר נִתַּן־לוֹ בְּהַר אֶפְרָיִם:

סכום הפסוקים של ספר יהושע שש מאות וחמשים וששה. **ותרן** לשון אלם סימן.

24:25. He reviewed the laws of the Torah (*Rashi*).

24:26. Joshua wrote the words he had just proclaimed, and placed the parchment together with the Torah scroll (*Targum*). At that time the Holy Ark, which the verse refers to as the Sanctuary, was in Shechem (*Radak*).

24:32. See *Genesis* 33:19.

Judges שופטים

With the death of Joshua, the Jewish nation entered a new era. No longer was there a single national leader, a virtual king of the nation, as Moses and Joshua had been. True, there were courts in every town and city, as commanded by the Torah, so that there would be a system of justice, but there was no formally constituted national leader. There should have been a general acknowledgment that, as Samuel had insisted centuries later, "HASHEM your God is your king," and all questions of law and policy should have been decided by the national or tribal Sanhedrins. Instead, the tribes became involved in settling their respective provinces, setting up homes and farms and — because of their reluctance to eradicate all Canaanite influence from the land — often tended to adopt the corrupt practices of their neighbors.

As the Book of Judges notes all too sadly, "In those days there was no king in Israel; every man did what was proper in his own eyes" (17:6, 21:25). There were episodes of extreme sinfulness that caused God to remove His protective providence from Israel, and foreign oppressors would exercise predatory control over parts of the country. Nevertheless, the masses of the people never lost their faith in God and their basic allegiance to the Torah. God would choose a leader, known as a judge, who would rally the people to repent and thus deserve God's help once again. Then, generally, the judge would conquer and expel the oppressor and the nation would enjoy a long period of tranquility — until it slid downward again.

Sometimes the judge would be someone of great renown, such as Deborah or Othniel, who was one of Joshua's greatest contemporaries. Sometimes he would be a young man of enormous but unknown potential, such as Gideon. There was a time when the nation did not merit a leader as great as these historic figures, so Jephthah became their judge; or a time when they did not deserve to conquer their enemies, so God gave them Samson, whose individual exploits kept the brutal Philistines at bay.

In reading the Book of Judges, it is essential to note that the combined years of peace and righteousness far outnumbered the years of failure and persecution. Always, the judge was chosen by God, and whenever he or she called upon the people to repent, they responded. The nation had shortcomings, but it was essentially righteous and true to the Torah and its Giver.

1

CONQUEST OF CANAAN 1:1-36

1 It happened after the death of Joshua that the Children of Israel inquired of HASHEM, saying, "Who should go up for us first against the Canaanite, to wage war against him?"*
2 HASHEM said, "Judah should go up. Behold, I have delivered the land into his hand."

Simeon assists Judah

3 Judah said to Simeon his brother, "Go up [in battle] with me for my portion* and let us wage war against the Canaanite; then I, too, will go with you for your portion." So Simeon went with him. 4 Judah attacked and HASHEM delivered the Canaanite and the Perizzite into their hand; they struck them down at Bezek — ten thousand men.
5 They found Adoni-bezek in Bezek, and battled against him, and they struck down the Canaanite and the Perizzite. 6 Adoni-bezek fled and they chased after him. They seized him and cut off his thumbs and his big toes.* 7 Adoni-bezek said, "Seventy kings with their thumbs and big toes cut off used to glean under my table; as I did, so God requited me." They brought him to Jerusalem and he died there.

Judah's conquests (See Appendix D, map 3)

8 The children of Judah then waged war against Jerusalem.* They conquered it and struck it down by the edge of the sword, and they set the city on fire. 9 Afterward, the children of Judah descended to wage war against the Canaanite who inhabited the mountain, the South, and the lowland.
10 Judah had gone forth against the Canaanite who dwelled in Hebron — the name of Hebron in early times had been Kiriath-arba — and they struck down Sheshai, Ahiman, and Talmai. 11 From there he went [to fight] against the inhabitants of Debir, and the name of Debir in early times had been Kiriath-sefer.

Othniel marries Caleb's daughter

12 Caleb said, "Whoever smites Kiriath-sefer and conquers it — I shall give him my daughter Achsah as a wife." 13 Othniel son of Kenaz, Caleb's younger brother, conquered it; so he gave him his daughter Achsah as a wife.
14 When she came [to Othniel], she urged him to let her ask her father for a field. Then she slid off the donkey, and Caleb said to her, "What do you wish?"
15 She said to him, "Give me a [source of] blessing — for you have given me an arid land; give me springs of water." So Caleb gave her the upper springs and the lower springs.

The Kenites

16 The children of the Kenite,* Moses' father-in-law, ascended from the City of Date Palms with the children of Judah to the Wilderness of Judah that is south of Arad; they went and settled with the people. 17 Judah went with his brother Simeon and they struck down the Canaanite who dwelled in Zephath and destroyed it. He named the city Hormah [Destruction]. 18 Judah conquered Gaza and its territory, Ashkelon and its territory, and Ekron and its territory.
19 HASHEM was with Judah and he drove out the [inhabitants of the] mountains, but the inhabitants of the valley could not be driven out, because they had iron chariots. 20 They granted Hebron to Caleb, as Moses had spoken, and he drove the three sons of the giant from there.

Jerusalem

21 But the children of Benjamin did not drive out the Jebusite, inhabitant of Jerusalem,* so the Jebusite dwelt with the children of Benjamin, in Jerusalem,

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they might be caught in the crossfire of war. The Kenites had settled in Jericho (the City of Date Palms), and when the battle for the city took place, they left it and settled with the tribe of Judah (*Radak*).

1:21. Although Judah had captured and razed Jerusalem (v. 8), the Jebusite inhabitants took refuge in the city's citadel, from which Judah was unable to dislodge them (*Abarbanel*). Part of Jerusalem was in the province of Benjamin, and that part remained in the possession of the Jebusites.

א וַיְהִי אַחֲרֵי מוֹת יְהוֹשֻׁעַ וַיִּשְׁאֲלוּ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בַּיהוָה לֵאמֹר מִי־יַעֲלֶה־
ב לָנוּ אֶל־הַכְּנַעֲנִי בַּתְּחִלָּה לְהִלָּחֶם בּוֹ: וַיֹּאמֶר יהוה יְהוּדָה יַעֲלֶה הִנֵּה
ג נָתַתִּי אֶת־הָאָרֶץ בְּיָדוֹ: וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוּדָה לְשִׁמְעוֹן אָחִיו עֲלֵה אִתִּי בְגוֹרָלִי
ד וְנִלָּחֲמָה בַּכְּנַעֲנִי וְהָלַכְתִּי גַם־אֲנִי אִתְּךָ בְּגוֹרָלֶךָ וַיֵּלֶךְ אִתּוֹ שִׁמְעוֹן: וַיַּעַל
יְהוּדָה וַיִּתֵּן יהוה אֶת־הַכְּנַעֲנִי וְהַפְּרִזִּי בְּיָדָם וַיַּכּוּם בְּבֶזֶק עֲשֶׂרֶת אֲלָפִים
ה אִישׁ: וַיִּמְצְאוּ אֶת־אֲדֹנִי בֶזֶק בְּבֶזֶק וַיִּלָּחֲמוּ בּוֹ וַיַּכּוּ אֶת־הַכְּנַעֲנִי וְאֶת־
ו הַפְּרִזִּי: וַיָּנָס אֲדֹנִי בֶזֶק וַיִּרְדְּפוּ אַחֲרָיו וַיֹּאחֲזוּ אֹתוֹ וַיְקַצְּצוּ אֶת־בְּהֹנוֹת יָדָיו
ז וְרַגְלָיו: וַיֹּאמֶר אֲדֹנִי־בֶזֶק שִׁבְעִים | מְלָכִים בֶּהֹנוֹת יְדֵיהֶם וְרַגְלֵיהֶם
מְקֻצָּצִים הָיוּ מְלַקְּטִים תַּחַת שֻׁלְחָנִי כַּאֲשֶׁר עָשִׂיתִי כֵּן שִׁלַּם־לִי אֱלֹהִים
וַיְבִיאֻהוּ יְרוּשָׁלִַם וַיָּמָת שָׁם:
ח וַיִּלָּחֲמוּ בְנֵי־יְהוּדָה בִּירוּשָׁלִַם וַיִּלְכְּדוּ אוֹתָהּ וַיַּכּוּהָ לְפִי־חָרֶב וְאֶת־הָעִיר
ט שִׁלְּחוּ בָאֵשׁ: וְאַחַר יָרְדוּ בְּנֵי יְהוּדָה לְהִלָּחֵם בַּכְּנַעֲנִי יוֹשֵׁב הָהָר וְהַנֶּגֶב
י וְהַשְּׁפֵלָה: וַיֵּלֶךְ יְהוּדָה אֶל־הַכְּנַעֲנִי הַיּוֹשֵׁב בְּחֶבְרוֹן וְשֵׁם־חֶבְרוֹן לְפָנִים
יא קִרְיַת אַרְבַּע וַיַּכּוּ אֶת־שֵׁשַׁי וְאֶת־אֲחִימַן וְאֶת־תַּלְמָי: וַיֵּלֶךְ מִשָּׁם אֶל־
יב יוֹשְׁבֵי דְּבִיר וְשֵׁם־דְּבִיר לְפָנִים קִרְיַת־סֵפֶר: וַיֹּאמֶר כָּלֵב אֲשֶׁר־יַכֶּה אֶת־
יג קִרְיַת־סֵפֶר וּלְכָדָהּ וְנָתַתִּי לוֹ אֶת־עַכְסָה בִתִּי לְאִשָּׁה: וַיִּלְכְּדָהּ עָתְנִיאֵל
יד בֶּן־קְנַז אֲחִי כָלֵב הַקָּטֹן מִמֶּנּוּ וַיִּתֶּן־לוֹ אֶת־עַכְסָה בִתּוֹ לְאִשָּׁה: וַיְהִי בְּבוֹאָהּ
וַתְּסִיתֵהוּ לִשְׁאוֹל מֵאֵת־אָבִיהָ הַשָּׂדֶה וַתִּצְנַח מֵעַל הַחֲמוֹר וַיֹּאמֶר־לָהּ
טו כָּלֵב מַה־לָּךְ: וַתֹּאמֶר לוֹ הָבָה־לִּי בְרָכָה כִּי אֶרֶץ הַנֶּגֶב נְתַתָּנִי וְנָתַתָּה לִי
טז גֻּלֹּת מָיִם וַיִּתֶּן־לָהּ כָּלֵב אֵת גֻּלֹּת עִלִּית וְאֵת גֻּלֹּת תַּחְתִּית: וּבְנֵי
קֵינִי חֹתֵן מֹשֶׁה עָלוּ מֵעִיר הַתְּמָרִים אֶת־בְּנֵי יְהוּדָה מִדְבַּר יְהוּדָה אֲשֶׁר
יז בַּנֶּגֶב עֲרָד וַיֵּלֶךְ וַיֵּשֶׁב אֶת־הָעָם: וַיֵּלֶךְ יְהוּדָה אֶת־שִׁמְעוֹן אָחִיו וַיַּכּוּ
אֶת־הַכְּנַעֲנִי יוֹשֵׁב צְפַת וַיַּחֲרִימוּ אוֹתָהּ וַיִּקְרָא אֶת־שֵׁם־הָעִיר חָרְמָה:
יח וַיִּלְכֹּד יְהוּדָה אֶת־עַזָּה וְאֶת־גְּבוּלָהּ וְאֶת־אַשְׁקְלוֹן וְאֶת־גְּבוּלָהּ וְאֶת־
יט עֶקְרוֹן וְאֶת־גְּבוּלָהּ: וַיְהִי יהוה אֶת־יְהוּדָה וַיָּרֶשׁ אֶת־הָהָר כִּי לֹא לְהוֹרִישׁ
כ אֶת־יֹשְׁבֵי הָעֵמֶק כִּי־רֶכֶב בַּרְזֶל לָהֶם: וַיִּתְּנוּ לְכָלֵב אֶת־חֶבְרוֹן כַּאֲשֶׁר
כא דִּבֶּר מֹשֶׁה וַיּוֹרֶשׁ מִשָּׁם אֶת־שְׁלֹשָׁה בְּנֵי הָעֲנָק: וְאֶת־הַיְבוּסִי יֹשֵׁב
יְרוּשָׁלִַם לֹא הוֹרִישׁוּ בְּנֵי בִנְיָמִן וַיֵּשֶׁב הַיְבוּסִי אֶת־בְּנֵי בִנְיָמִן בִּירוּשָׁלִַם

1:1. Seeing that Joshua had died, the Canaanites would be emboldened, convinced that without its leader, Israel would be vulnerable. But if the very first battle were to end in ■ decisive Jewish victory, the Canaanites would become disheartened.Therefore, the nation inquired of the *Urim VeTumim* (see *Exodus* 28:30) which tribe should initiate the crucial first battle (*Ralbag*).

1:3. The tribe of Simeon received scattered cities within the boundaries of Judah, but had no separate, contiguous territory of its own (see *Joshua* 19:1).

1:6. Nowhere else do we find Jews mutilating their opponents, as they did to Adoni-bezek. God prompted them to do this in order to frighten the remaining Canaanite rulers and to punish Adoni-bezek measure for measure for the atrocities he had inflicted on his victims (*Ralbag*).

1:8. Scripture reviews the important areas taken in Judah's earlier wars under the leadership of Joshua, the conquests of Caleb and Othniel, and the request of Caleb's daughter Achsah. See *Joshua* 15:13-20,63.

1:16. Like their ancestor Jethro, the Kenites were loyal friends and allies of Israel, and the Jews reciprocated this friendship by evacuating the Kenite families whenever

until this day.

The tribes of Joseph . . .

22 The House of Joseph went up, as well, to Beth-el, and HASHEM was with them. 23 The House of Joseph spied out Beth-el — the name of the city in early times had been Luz. 24 The lookouts saw a man leaving the city and they said to him, "Show us the approach to the city and we shall deal kindly with you." 25 He showed them the approach to the city and they struck down the city by the edge of the sword, but they released the man and his entire family. 26 The man went to the land of the Hittites. He built a city and called it Luz; that is its name until this day.

. . . Manasseh . . .

27 Manasseh did not drive out [the inhabitants of] Beth-shean and its towns, Taanach and its towns, the inhabitants of Dor and its towns, the inhabitants of Ibleam and its towns, and the inhabitants of Megiddo and its towns. The Canaanite were determined to dwell in this land. * *28 So it was that when Israel was strong, they imposed tribute upon the Canaanite, but did not drive him out.*

. . . and Ephraim

29 Ephraim did not drive out the Canaanite that was dwelling in Gezer, so the Canaanite dwelt in their midst in Gezer.

Zebulun

30 Zebulun did not drive out the inhabitants of Kitron and the inhabitants of Nahalol, so the Canaanite dwelt in their midst, and became tributary.

Asher

31 Asher did not drive out the inhabitants of Acco nor the inhabitants of Sidon, [nor of] Ahlab, Achzib, Helbah, Aphik, and Rehob. 32 So the Asherite dwelt amid the Canaanite, the inhabitants of the land, for they did not drive them out.

Naphtali

33 Naphtali did not drive out the inhabitants of Beth-shemesh and the inhabitants of Beth-anath, so they dwelt among the Canaanite, the inhabitants of the land. The inhabitants of Beth-shemesh and Beth-anath became tributary to them.

Dan

34 The Amorite forced the children of Dan up the mountain, for they did not let them descend to the valley. 35 The Amorite was determined to dwell in Har-heres, Aijalon, and Shaalbim, but the hand of the House of Joseph prevailed, so [the Amorite] became tributary. 36 The border of the Amorite was from Maaleh-akrabbim, from the rock upward.

2

THE PERIOD OF THE JUDGES: CYCLES OF IDOLATRY, CHASTENING AND DELIVERANCE 2:1-3:6

1 An emissary of HASHEM went up from Gilgal to Bochim. He said, "I brought you up from Egypt and I brought you to the land that I swore to your forefathers. And I said, 'I shall never annul My covenant with you, 2 but you shall not seal a covenant with the inhabitants of this land; you shall break apart their altars.' But you did not hearken to My voice! What is this that you have done? 3 So I also said, 'I shall not chase them out before you, and they will be unto you [as thorns in your] sides,* and their gods will be a trap for you.' "*

4 It happened that when the emissary of HASHEM spoke these words to all the Children of Israel, the people raised their voices and wept. 5 They named that place Bochim [Crying], and they brought offerings there to HASHEM.

6 Joshua had sent the people away and the Children of Israel had gone, every man to his heritage, to possess the land. 7 The people served HASHEM all the days of Joshua and all the days of the elders who outlived Joshua, who had seen all the great work of HASHEM, which He had done for Israel.**

would be saddled with them, as permanent challenges.

2:6. The rest of this chapter provides the background for the events of the entire period of the Judges, which began with Joshua's death.

2:7. Although the people erred in not continuing the wars of conquest, they did not turn to sin as long as they remembered the great leaders and the miracles they had witnessed (*Radak*).

כב עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה׃ וַיַּעֲלוּ בֵית־יוֹסֵף גַּם־הֵם בֵּית־אֵל וַיהוָה עִמָּם׃
כג־כד וַיָּתֵרוּ בֵית־יוֹסֵף בְּבֵית־אֵל וְשֵׁם־הָעִיר לְפָנִים לוּז׃ וַיִּרְאוּ הַשֹּׁמְרִים אִישׁ
יוֹצֵא מִן־הָעִיר וַיֹּאמְרוּ לוֹ הַרְאֵנוּ נָא אֶת־מְבוֹא הָעִיר וְעָשִׂינוּ עִמְּךָ
כה חָסֶד׃ וַיַּרְאֵם אֶת־מְבוֹא הָעִיר וַיַּכּוּ אֶת־הָעִיר לְפִי־חָרֶב וְאֶת־הָאִישׁ וְאֶת־
כו כָּל־מִשְׁפַּחְתּוֹ שִׁלֵּחוּ׃ וַיֵּלֶךְ הָאִישׁ אֶרֶץ הַחִתִּים וַיִּבֶן עִיר וַיִּקְרָא שְׁמָהּ לוּז
כז הוּא שְׁמָהּ עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה׃ וְלֹא־הוֹרִישׁ מְנַשֶּׁה אֶת־בֵּית־
שְׁאָן וְאֶת־בְּנוֹתֶיהָ וְאֶת־תַּעְנָךְ וְאֶת־בְּנוֹתֶיהָ וְאֶת־°ישב [°יוֹשְׁבֵי ק׳] דּוֹר
וְאֶת־בְּנוֹתֶיהָ וְאֶת־יוֹשְׁבֵי יִבְלְעָם וְאֶת־בְּנוֹתֶיהָ וְאֶת־יוֹשְׁבֵי מְגִדּוֹ וְאֶת־
כח בְּנוֹתֶיהָ וַיּוֹאֶל הַכְּנַעֲנִי לָשֶׁבֶת בָּאָרֶץ הַזֹּאת׃ וַיְהִי כִּי־חָזַק יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיָּשֶׂם
כט אֶת־הַכְּנַעֲנִי לָמַס וְהוֹרֵישׁ לֹא הוֹרִישׁוֹ׃ וְאֶפְרַיִם לֹא הוֹרִישׁ
ל אֶת־הַכְּנַעֲנִי הַיּוֹשֵׁב בְּגֶזֶר וַיֵּשֶׁב הַכְּנַעֲנִי בְּקִרְבּוֹ בְּגָזֶר׃ זְבוּלֻן
לֹא הוֹרִישׁ אֶת־יוֹשְׁבֵי קִטְרוֹן וְאֶת־יוֹשְׁבֵי נַהֲלֹל וַיֵּשֶׁב הַכְּנַעֲנִי בְּקִרְבּוֹ
לא וַיִּהְיוּ לָמַס׃ אָשֵׁר לֹא הוֹרִישׁ אֶת־יֹשְׁבֵי עַכּוֹ וְאֶת־יוֹשְׁבֵי צִידוֹן
לב וְאֶת־אַחְלָב וְאֶת־אַכְזִיב וְאֶת־חֶלְבָּה וְאֶת־אֲפִיק וְאֶת־רְחֹב׃ וַיֵּשֶׁב
לג הָאָשֵׁרִי בְּקֶרֶב הַכְּנַעֲנִי יֹשְׁבֵי הָאָרֶץ כִּי לֹא הוֹרִישׁוּ׃ נַפְתָּלִי
לֹא הוֹרִישׁ אֶת־יֹשְׁבֵי בֵית־שֶׁמֶשׁ וְאֶת־יֹשְׁבֵי בֵית־עֲנָת וַיֵּשֶׁב בְּקֶרֶב
לד הַכְּנַעֲנִי יֹשְׁבֵי הָאָרֶץ וְיֹשְׁבֵי בֵית־שֶׁמֶשׁ וּבֵית עֲנָת הָיוּ לָהֶם לָמַס׃ וַיִּלְחַצוּ
לה הָאֱמֹרִי אֶת־בְּנֵי־דָן הָהָרָה כִּי־לֹא נְתָנוּ לָרֶדֶת לָעֵמֶק׃ וַיּוֹאֶל הָאֱמֹרִי
לָשֶׁבֶת בְּהַר־חֶרֶס בְּאַיָּלוֹן וּבְשַׁעַלְבִּים וַתִּכְבַּד יַד בֵּית יוֹסֵף וַיִּהְיוּ לָמַס׃
ב לו־א וּגְבוּל הָאֱמֹרִי מִמַּעֲלֵה עַקְרַבִּים מֵהַסֶּלַע וָמָעְלָה׃ וַיַּעַל
מַלְאַךְ־יהוָה מִן־הַגִּלְגָּל אֶל־הַבֹּכִים וַיֹּאמֶר אַעֲלֶה אֶתְכֶם
מִמִּצְרַיִם וָאָבִיא אֶתְכֶם אֶל־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר נִשְׁבַּעְתִּי לַאֲבֹתֵיכֶם וָאֹמַר
ב לֹא־אָפֵר בְּרִיתִי אִתְּכֶם לְעוֹלָם׃ וְאַתֶּם לֹא־תִכְרְתוּ בְרִית לְיֹשְׁבֵי הָאָרֶץ
ג הַזֹּאת מִזְבְּחוֹתֵיהֶם תִּתֹּצוּן וְלֹא־שְׁמַעְתֶּם בְּקוֹלִי מַה־זֹּאת עֲשִׂיתֶם׃ וְגַם
אָמַרְתִּי לֹא־אֲגָרֵשׁ אוֹתָם מִפְּנֵיכֶם וְהָיוּ לָכֶם לְצִדִּים וֵאלֹהֵיהֶם יִהְיוּ לָכֶם
ד לְמוֹקֵשׁ׃ וַיְהִי כְּדַבֵּר מַלְאַךְ יהוה אֶת־הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה אֶל־כָּל־בְּנֵי
ה יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיִּשְׂאוּ הָעָם אֶת־קוֹלָם וַיִּבְכּוּ׃ וַיִּקְרְאוּ שֵׁם־הַמָּקוֹם הַהוּא בֹּכִים
ו וַיִּזְבְּחוּ־שָׁם לַיהוָה׃ וַיְשַׁלַּח יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶת־הָעָם וַיֵּלְכוּ
ז בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל אִישׁ לְנַחֲלָתוֹ לָרֶשֶׁת אֶת־הָאָרֶץ׃ וַיַּעַבְדוּ הָעָם אֶת־
יהוה כֹּל יְמֵי יְהוֹשֻׁעַ וְכֹל ו יְמֵי הַזְּקֵנִים אֲשֶׁר הֶאֱרִיכוּ יָמִים אַחֲרֵי
יְהוֹשׁוּעַ אֲשֶׁר רָאוּ אֵת כָּל־מַעֲשֵׂה יהוה הַגָּדוֹל אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל׃

1:27-36. Nearly all the tribes were derelict in not persevering to rid the land of its inhabitants. Indeed, had this pernicious seed of idol worship not been permitted to take root in the land, the spiritual degeneration that led to the destruction of the Temple more than eight hundred years later would not have occurred.

2:1. The word מַלְאַךְ means "emissary" and is used to describe both an angel and a prophet, as each is an emissary who carries out God's mission. Since the emissary speaks in God's name, he uses the first person.

2:3. See *Numbers* 33:55. Measure for measure, if Israel would choose to establish ties to the Canaanite nations, it

8 Joshua son of Nun, the servant of HASHEM, died at the age of a hundred and
ten years. 9 They buried him within the borders of his heritage, in Timnath-heres
in Mount Ephraim, north of Mount Gaash. 10 That entire generation, as well, was
gathered in to its forefathers. A new generation arose after them that did not
know HASHEM, nor the deeds that He had performed for Israel.

Idolatry

11 The Children of Israel would do what was evil in the eyes of HASHEM, and
would worship the Baalim.* 12 They would forsake HASHEM, the God of their
forefathers, Who took them out of the land of Egypt, and follow the gods of
others, from among the gods of the peoples that were around them; they would
prostrate themselves to them and anger HASHEM. 13 They would forsake HASHEM
and worship the Baal and the Ashtaroth.

Chastening

14 Then the wrath of HASHEM would flare against Israel and He would deliver
them into the hands of plunderers and they would plunder them, and He would
deliver them into the hands of their enemies all around, so that they could no
longer stand before their enemies. 15 Wherever they would go out [in battle], the
hand of HASHEM would be upon them for evil — as HASHEM had spoken and as
HASHEM had sworn to them — and they would be very distressed.

16 Then HASHEM would set up judges who would save them from the hand of
their plunderers. 17 But they would not hearken to their judges either, for they
would stray after the gods of others and prostrate themselves to them. They
would turn away quickly from the path that their forefathers had traveled, to
hearken to the commandments of HASHEM; they did not do so.*

Deliverance

18 When HASHEM would set up judges for them, HASHEM would be with the
judge and he would save them from the hand of their enemies all the days of the
judge, for HASHEM would have relented because of their outcry before those who
oppressed them and who crushed them.

19 But then it would happen that upon the death of the judge they would turn
back and be even more corrupt than their forefathers, to follow the gods of
others, to worship them, and to prostrate themselves before them. They would
not omit any of their misdeeds or their stubborn way. 20 So the wrath of HASHEM
would flare against Israel and He would say, "Because this nation has violated
My covenant that I commanded their forefathers and they did not hearken to My
voice, 21 I, too, shall no longer drive away any man from before them, from
among the nations that Joshua left when he died, 22 in order to test Israel through
them: Are they observing the way of HASHEM, to follow them as their forefathers
observed, or not?"*

23 So HASHEM let those nations remain, without driving them out quickly, and
He did not deliver them into Joshua's hand.

3

The remaining nations
(See Appendix D, map 4)

1 These are the nations that HASHEM let remain, to test Israel through them, all
those who did not know all the Canaanite wars — 2 [they remained] only
so that the generations of the Children of Israel would know, to teach them
warfare; but those who preceded [them] did not [need to] know:* 3 the five
governors of the Philistines, all the Canaanite, the Sidonite, and the Hivvite that
dwell on Mount Lebanon, from the mountain of the plain of Hermon until the
approach to Hamath. 4 They were [for God] to test Israel through them, to know
whether they would hearken to the commandments of HASHEM, which He
commanded their forefathers through the hand of Moses. 5 So the Children of

ח־ט וַיָּמָת יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בִּן־נוּן עֶבֶד יְהוָה בֶּן־מֵאָה וָעֶשֶׂר שָׁנִים: וַיִּקְבְּרוּ אוֹתוֹ
י בִּגְבוּל נַחֲלָתוֹ בְּתִמְנַת־חֶרֶס בְּהַר אֶפְרָיִם מִצְּפוֹן לְהַר־גָּעַשׁ: וְגַם כָּל־
הַדּוֹר הַהוּא נֶאֱסְפוּ אֶל־אֲבוֹתָיו וַיָּקָם דּוֹר אַחֵר אַחֲרֵיהֶם אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יָדְעוּ
יא אֶת־יהוה וְגַם אֶת־הַמַּעֲשֶׂה אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל: וַיַּעֲשׂוּ
יב בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת־הָרַע בְּעֵינֵי יהוה וַיַּעַבְדוּ אֶת־הַבְּעָלִים: וַיַּעַזְבוּ אֶת־
יהוה | אֱלֹהֵי אֲבוֹתָם הַמּוֹצִיא אוֹתָם מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם וַיֵּלְכוּ אַחֲרֵי | אֱלֹהִים
אֲחֵרִים מֵאֱלֹהֵי הָעַמִּים אֲשֶׁר סְבִיבוֹתֵיהֶם וַיִּשְׁתַּחֲווּ לָהֶם וַיַּכְעִסוּ אֶת־
יג־יד יהוה: וַיַּעַזְבוּ אֶת־יהוה וַיַּעַבְדוּ לַבַּעַל וְלָעַשְׁתָּרוֹת: וַיִּחַר־אַף יהוה
בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל וַיִּתְּנֵם בְּיַד שֹׁסִים וַיָּשֹׁסוּ אוֹתָם וַיִּמְכְּרֵם בְּיַד אוֹיְבֵיהֶם מִסָּבִיב
טו וְלֹא־יָכְלוּ עוֹד לַעֲמֹד לִפְנֵי אוֹיְבֵיהֶם: בְּכֹל | אֲשֶׁר יָצְאוּ יַד־יהוה הָיְתָה־
בָּם לְרָעָה כַּאֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר יהוה וְכַאֲשֶׁר נִשְׁבַּע יהוה לָהֶם וַיֵּצַר לָהֶם מְאֹד:
טז־יז וַיָּקֶם יהוה שֹׁפְטִים וַיּוֹשִׁיעُום מִיַּד שֹׁסֵיהֶם: וְגַם אֶל־שְׁפָטֵיהֶם לֹא שָׁמְעוּ
כִּי זָנוּ אַחֲרֵי אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים וַיִּשְׁתַּחֲווּ לָהֶם סָרוּ מַהֵר מִן־הַדֶּרֶךְ אֲשֶׁר
יח הָלְכוּ אֲבוֹתָם לִשְׁמֹעַ מִצְוֹת־יהוה לֹא עָשׂוּ כֵן: וְכִי־הֵקִים יהוה | לָהֶם
שֹׁפְטִים וְהָיָה יהוה עִם־הַשֹּׁפֵט וְהוֹשִׁיעָם מִיַּד אֹיְבֵיהֶם כֹּל יְמֵי הַשּׁוֹפֵט
יט כִּי־יִנָּחֵם יהוה מִנַּאֲקָתָם מִפְּנֵי לֹחֲצֵיהֶם וְדֹחֲקֵיהֶם: וְהָיָה | בְּמוֹת הַשּׁוֹפֵט
יָשֻׁבוּ וְהִשְׁחִיתוּ מֵאֲבוֹתָם לָלֶכֶת אַחֲרֵי אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים לְעָבְדָם
כ וּלְהִשְׁתַּחֲוֹת לָהֶם לֹא הִפִּילוּ מִמַּעַלְלֵיהֶם וּמִדַּרְכָּם הַקָּשָׁה: וַיִּחַר־אַף
יהוה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל וַיֹּאמֶר יַעַן אֲשֶׁר עָבְרוּ הַגּוֹי הַזֶּה אֶת־בְּרִיתִי אֲשֶׁר צִוִּיתִי
כא אֶת־אֲבוֹתָם וְלֹא שָׁמְעוּ לְקוֹלִי: גַּם־אֲנִי לֹא אוֹסִיף לְהוֹרִישׁ אִישׁ
כב מִפְּנֵיהֶם מִן־הַגּוֹיִם אֲשֶׁר־עָזַב יְהוֹשֻׁעַ וַיָּמֹת: לְמַעַן נַסּוֹת בָּם אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל
הֲשֹׁמְרִים הֵם אֶת־דֶּרֶךְ יהוה לָלֶכֶת בָּם כַּאֲשֶׁר שָׁמְרוּ אֲבוֹתָם אִם־לֹא:
כג וַיַּנַּח יהוה אֶת־הַגּוֹיִם הָאֵלֶּה לְבִלְתִּי הוֹרִישָׁם מַהֵר וְלֹא נְתָנָם בְּיַד
ג א יְהוֹשֻׁעַ: וְאֵלֶּה הַגּוֹיִם אֲשֶׁר הִנִּיחַ יהוה לְנַסּוֹת בָּם
ב אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל אֵת כָּל־אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יָדְעוּ אֵת כָּל־מִלְחֲמוֹת כְּנָעַן: רַק לְמַעַן
דַּעַת דֹּרוֹת בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל לְלַמְּדָם מִלְחָמָה רַק אֲשֶׁר־לְפָנִים לֹא יְדָעוּם:
ג חֲמֵשֶׁת | סַרְנֵי פְלִשְׁתִּים וְכָל־הַכְּנַעֲנִי וְהַצִּידֹנִי וְהַחִוִּי יֹשֵׁב הַר הַלְּבָנוֹן
ד מֵהַר בַּעַל חֶרְמוֹן עַד לְבוֹא חֲמָת: וַיְהִיוּ לְנַסּוֹת בָּם אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל
ה לָדַעַת הֲיִשְׁמְעוּ אֶת־מִצְוֹת יהוה אֲשֶׁר־צִוָּה אֶת־אֲבוֹתָם בְּיַד־מֹשֶׁה: וּבְנֵי

2:11. As chronicled in the Book of Judges, Scripture outlines the pattern of events that continued repeatedly throughout the centuries. Thus, the translation *they would do* instead of the simple past "they did."

Baal is a generic term for idols; the word means *master*. *Ashtaroth* (v. 13) was a statue of a female sheep or goat [see *Deuteronomy* 7:13] (*Radak*), worshiped by the Canaanites as the goddess of fertility.

2:17. The root of their continual sinfulness was their failure to heed their leaders; this shortcoming served as an impediment to repentance (*Alshich*).

2:22. It was as if they had willed that their spiritual enemies should live among them, and if so their test was to prove that they would not be influenced by them.

3:2. Because they did not exert themselves to drive out the Canaanites, the next generation would not see the miraculous victories that their fathers saw. Rather, they would have to learn the art of warfare (*Radak*).

Israel dwelt among the Canaanite, the Hittite, the Amorite, the Perizzite, the Hivvite, and the Jebusite. 6 *[The Israelites] took [the nations'] daughters for themselves as wives and gave their daughters to their sons, and they served their gods.*

THE FIRST JUDGE: OTHNIEL SON OF KENAZ 3:7-11

Aramean oppression (See Appendix A, timeline 3)

7 *The Children of Israel did what was evil in the eyes of* HASHEM *and they forgot* HASHEM, *their God, and worshiped the Baalim and the Asherah-trees.* 8 *The wrath of* HASHEM *flared against Israel and He delivered them into the hand of Cushan-rishathaim, king of Aram-naharaim, and the Children of Israel served Cushan-rishathaim for eight years.* 9 *The Children of Israel cried out to* HASHEM, * *and* HASHEM *set up a savior for the Children of Israel and he saved them: Othniel son of Kenaz, Caleb's younger brother.* 10 *The spirit of* HASHEM *was upon him and he judged Israel. He went out to war and* HASHEM *delivered Cushan-rishathaim, king of Aram, into his hand; and his hand dominated Cushan-rishathaim.* 11 *The land was tranquil for forty years;* * *and Othniel son of Kenaz died.*

EHUD SON OF GERA 3:12-30

Moabite oppression

12 *The Children of Israel continued to do that which was evil in the eyes of* HASHEM, *and* HASHEM *strengthened Eglon, king of Moab, over Israel, because they had done that which was evil in the eyes of* HASHEM. 13 *He gathered to himself the Children of Ammon and Amalek, then he went and struck Israel and took possession of the City of Date Palms [Jericho].* 14 *The Children of Israel served Eglon, king of Moab, for eighteen years.*

15 *The Children of Israel cried out to* HASHEM, *and* HASHEM *set up a savior for them: Ehud son of Gera, a Benjaminite, a man with a withered right hand. The Children of Israel sent a tribute with him to Eglon, king of Moab.* 16 *Ehud made himself a sword with two sharp edges, a cubit its length, and he girded it under his garments on his right thigh.*

Ehud confronts Eglon, king of Moab . . .

17 *He brought the tribute to Eglon, king of Moab. (Now Eglon was a very obese man.)* 18 *It happened that when he finished offering the tribute, he led away the people, the bearers of the tribute,* 19 *and then he returned from the quarries near Gilgal and said, "I have a secret matter for you, O king."*

[The King] said, "Silence!" — and all who stood before him went out.

20 *Then Ehud came to him as he was sitting alone in his cool upper chamber. Ehud said, "I have a word of God for you," so he stood up* * *from the chair.*

. . . and dispatches him

21 *Ehud then stretched out his left hand and took the sword from upon his right thigh and thrust it into [Eglon's] belly.* 22 *Even the hilt went in after the blade and the fat closed around the blade, for he did not pull the sword out of his belly; the excrement poured out.*

23 *Ehud went out to the porch, closed the doors of the upper chamber behind him, and locked [them].* 24 *When he had left, [Eglon's] servants came and saw that — behold! the doors of the upper chamber were locked, they said, "He is but relieving himself in the cool chamber."* 25 *They waited for a long time, but behold, he was not opening the doors of the upper chamber. They took the key and opened them and — behold! their master was fallen on the ground, dead!* 26 *Ehud had escaped while they were waiting, and he passed the quarries and escaped to Seirah.*

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of tranquility. In the context of the narrative it is clear that it was a time when the nation maintained the high standard of righteousness that the Torah demands. In fact, of the nearly four hundred years spanned by the period of the Judges, the people were sinful during only one hundred and ten (*Rashi* to *Ezekiel* 4:5).

3:20. Eglon's respect for God was rewarded: Ruth, ancestress of the Davidic dynasty, descended from him (*Rashi*).

ו יִשְׂרָאֵל יָשְׁבוּ בְּקֶרֶב הַכְּנַעֲנִי הַחִתִּי וְהָאֱמֹרִי וְהַפְּרִזִּי וְהַחִוִּי וְהַיְבוּסִי: וַיִּקְחוּ
אֶת־בְּנוֹתֵיהֶם לָהֶם לְנָשִׁים וְאֶת־בְּנוֹתֵיהֶם נָתְנוּ לִבְנֵיהֶם וַיַּעַבְדוּ אֶת־
ז אֱלֹהֵיהֶם: וַיַּעֲשׂוּ בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת־הָרַע בְּעֵינֵי יהוה
ח וַיִּשְׁכְּחוּ אֶת־יהוה אֱלֹהֵיהֶם וַיַּעַבְדוּ אֶת־הַבְּעָלִים וְאֶת־הָאֲשֵׁרוֹת: וַיֵּחַר־
אַף יהוה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל וַיִּמְכְּרֵם בְּיַד כּוּשַׁן רִשְׁעָתַיִם מֶלֶךְ אֲרָם נַהֲרָיִם וַיַּעַבְדוּ
ט בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת־כּוּשַׁן רִשְׁעָתַיִם שְׁמֹנֶה שָׁנִים: וַיִּזְעֲקוּ בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶל־
יהוה וַיָּקֶם יהוה מוֹשִׁיעַ לִבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיּוֹשִׁיעֵם אֶת עָתְנִיאֵל בֶּן־קְנַז אֲחִי
י כָלֵב הַקָּטָן מִמֶּנּוּ: וַתְּהִי עָלָיו רוּחַ־יהוה וַיִּשְׁפֹּט אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיֵּצֵא
לַמִּלְחָמָה וַיִּתֵּן יהוה בְּיָדוֹ אֶת כּוּשַׁן רִשְׁעָתַיִם מֶלֶךְ אֲרָם וַתָּעָז יָדוֹ
יא עַל כּוּשַׁן רִשְׁעָתָיִם: וַתִּשְׁקֹט הָאָרֶץ אַרְבָּעִים שָׁנָה וַיָּמָת עָתְנִיאֵל בֶּן־
יב קְנַז: וַיֹּסִפוּ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לַעֲשׂוֹת הָרַע בְּעֵינֵי יהוה
וַיְחַזֵּק יהוה אֶת־עֶגְלוֹן מֶלֶךְ־מוֹאָב עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל עֵל כִּי־עָשׂוּ אֶת־הָרַע
יג בְּעֵינֵי יהוה: וַיֶּאֱסֹף אֵלָיו אֶת־בְּנֵי עַמּוֹן וַעֲמָלֵק וַיֵּלֶךְ וַיַּךְ אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל
יד וַיִּירְשׁוּ אֶת־עִיר הַתְּמָרִים: וַיַּעַבְדוּ בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת־עֶגְלוֹן מֶלֶךְ־מוֹאָב
טו שְׁמֹנֶה עֶשְׂרֵה שָׁנָה: וַיִּזְעֲקוּ בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶל־יהוה וַיָּקֶם יהוה לָהֶם
מוֹשִׁיעַ אֶת־אֵהוּד בֶּן־גֵּרָא בֶּן־הַיְמִינִי אִישׁ אִטֵּר יַד־יְמִינוֹ וַיִּשְׁלְחוּ בְנֵי־
טז יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּיָדוֹ מִנְחָה לְעֶגְלוֹן מֶלֶךְ מוֹאָב: וַיַּעַשׂ לוֹ אֵהוּד חֶרֶב וְלָהּ שְׁנֵי
יז פִיּוֹת גֹּמֶד אָרְכָּהּ וַיַּחְגֹּר אוֹתָהּ מִתַּחַת לְמַדָּיו עַל יֶרֶךְ יְמִינוֹ: וַיַּקְרֵב אֶת־
יח הַמִּנְחָה לְעֶגְלוֹן מֶלֶךְ מוֹאָב וְעֶגְלוֹן אִישׁ בָּרִיא מְאֹד: וַיְהִי כַּאֲשֶׁר כִּלָּה
יט לְהַקְרִיב אֶת הַמִּנְחָה וַיְשַׁלַּח אֶת הָעָם נֹשְׂאֵי הַמִּנְחָה: וְהוּא שָׁב מִן־
הַפְּסִילִים אֲשֶׁר אֶת הַגִּלְגָּל וַיֹּאמֶר דְּבַר־סֵתֶר לִי אֵלֶיךָ הַמֶּלֶךְ וַיֹּאמֶר
כ הָס וַיֵּצְאוּ מֵעָלָיו כָּל הָעֹמְדִים עָלָיו: וְאֵהוּד | בָּא אֵלָיו וְהוּא־יֹשֵׁב
בַּעֲלִיַּת הַמְּקֵרָה אֲשֶׁר־לוֹ לְבַדּוֹ וַיֹּאמֶר אֵהוּד דְּבַר־אֱלֹהִים לִי אֵלֶיךָ
כא וַיָּקָם מֵעַל הַכִּסֵּא: וַיִּשְׁלַח אֵהוּד אֶת־יַד שְׂמֹאלוֹ וַיִּקַּח אֶת הַחֶרֶב מֵעַל
כב יֶרֶךְ יְמִינוֹ וַיִּתְקָעֶהָ בְּבִטְנוֹ: וַיָּבֹא גַּם־הַנֹּצָב אַחַר הַלַּהַב וַיִּסְגֹּר הַחֵלֶב
כג בְּעַד הַלַּהַב כִּי לֹא שָׁלַף הַחֶרֶב מִבִּטְנוֹ וַיֵּצֵא הַפַּרְשְׁדֹנָה: וַיֵּצֵא אֵהוּד
כד הַמִּסְדְּרוֹנָה וַיִּסְגֹּר דַּלְתוֹת הָעֲלִיָּה בַּעֲדוֹ וְנָעָל: וְהוּא יָצָא וַעֲבָדָיו בָּאוּ
וַיִּרְאוּ וְהִנֵּה דַלְתוֹת הָעֲלִיָּה נְעֻלוֹת וַיֹּאמְרוּ אַךְ מְסִיךְ הוּא אֶת־רַגְלָיו
כה בַּחֲדַר הַמְּקֵרָה: וַיָּחִילוּ עַד־בּוֹשׁ וְהִנֵּה אֵינֶנּוּ פֹתֵחַ דַּלְתוֹת הָעֲלִיָּה
כו וַיִּקְחוּ אֶת־הַמַּפְתֵּחַ וַיִּפְתָּחוּ וְהִנֵּה אֲדֹנֵיהֶם נֹפֵל אַרְצָה מֵת: וְאֵהוּד
נִמְלַט עַד הָתְמַהְמְהָם וְהוּא עָבַר אֶת־הַפְּסִילִים וַיִּמָּלֵט הַשְּׂעִירָתָה:

3:9. The generation that had never seen God's miracles may not have realized that their fate was inextricably tied to their degree of virtue and sin. Only when the persecution became unbearable did they pray for help.

3:11. This pattern would be repeated many times in the Book: National sinfulness would bring about foreign domination, until Israel would cry out to God and He would designate a judge to save them.

Though the Book's accounts of sin and war are lengthy, it records not a single event during the forty-year period

27 It happened when he arrived that he sounded the shofar at Mount Ephraim. The Children of Israel descended with him from the mountain, and he was before them. 28 He said to them, "Give chase behind me, for HASHEM has delivered your enemies, Moab, into your hand!" They descended after him. They conquered the Jordan's crossings into Moab and did not let anyone cross. 29 They struck Moab at that time, about ten thousand men, every fearsome man and every mighty hero, not a man escaped.

SHAMGAR SON OF ANATH 3:31 (See Appendix A, timeline 3)

30 On that day Moab was subjugated under the hand of Israel, and the land was tranquil for eighty years.

31 After him was Shamgar son of Anath.* He struck the Philistines, six hundred men, with a cattle goad; and he, too, saved Israel.

4

DEBORAH THE PROPHETESS AND BARAK 4:1-5:31

1 The Children of Israel continued to do what was evil in the eyes of HASHEM, once Ehud died. 2 HASHEM delivered them into the hand of Jabin, king of Canaan,* who reigned in Hazor. The general of his army was Sisera, who dwelt in Harosheth-goiim. 3 The Children of Israel cried out to HASHEM, for [Sisera] had nine hundred iron chariots, and he oppressed the Children of Israel forcefully for twenty years.

Canannite oppression: Jabin and Sisera

4 Deborah was a prophetess,* the wife of Lappidoth;* she judged Israel at that time. 5 She would sit under the date palm of Deborah,* between Ramah and Beth-el on Mount Ephraim, and the Children of Israel would go up to her for judgment. 6 She sent and summoned Barak son of Abinoam of Kedesh-naphtali and said to him, "Behold, HASHEM, the God of Israel, has commanded, 'Go and convince [the people to go] toward Mount Tabor, and take with you ten thousand men from the children of Naphtali and from the children of Zebulun! 7 I will draw toward you — to Kishon Brook — Sisera, the general of Jabin's army, with his chariot and his multitude; and I shall deliver him into your hand.' "

8 Barak said to her, "If you go with me, I will go; but if you do not go with me, I will not go."*

9 She said, "Indeed, I will go with you — but the path on which you have chosen to go will not be for your glory, for HASHEM will have delivered Sisera into the hand of a woman." Then Deborah got up and went with Barak to Kedesh.

Zebulun and Naphtali mustered

10 Barak mustered Zebulun and Naphtali to Kedesh, and ten thousand men ascended in his footsteps; and Deborah went up with him.

11 (Heber the Kenite had become separated from the Kenites, from the children of Hobab, father-in-law of Moses, and pitched his tents as far as the Plain of Zaanannim, which is near Kedesh.)*

12 They told Sisera that Barak son of Abinoam had gone up to Mount Tabor. 13 Sisera mustered all his chariots — nine hundred iron chariots — and all the people who were with him, from Harosheth-goiim to Kishon Brook.

14 Deborah said to Barak, "Arise! For this is the day when HASHEM has delivered Sisera into your hand — behold, HASHEM has gone forth before you!" So Barak descended from Mount Tabor with the ten thousand men behind him.

Sisera's flight

15 HASHEM panicked Sisera and all the chariots and the entire camp by the edge

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that means *flash* (*Radak*).

4:5. Named for an earlier Deborah who was buried in that area (see *Genesis* 35:8; *Abarbanel*).

4:8. Considering himself unworthy of such a momentous miracle, Barak felt that he needed the merit of the judge and prophetess to insure the success of his mission.

4:11. This sets the stage for the later heroics of Heber's wife (v. 17ff).

כז וַיְהִי בְּבוֹאוֹ וַיִּתְקַע בַּשּׁוֹפָר בְּהַר אֶפְרָיִם וַיֵּרְדוּ עִמּוֹ בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל מִן־הָהָר
כח וְהוּא לִפְנֵיהֶם: וַיֹּאמֶר אֲלֵהֶם רִדְפוּ אַחֲרַי כִּי־נָתַן יְהוָה אֶת־אֹיְבֵיכֶם אֶת־
מוֹאָב בְּיֶדְכֶם וַיֵּרְדוּ אַחֲרָיו וַיִּלְכְּדוּ אֶת־מַעְבְּרוֹת הַיַּרְדֵּן לְמוֹאָב וְלֹא־
כט נָתְנוּ אִישׁ לַעֲבֹר: וַיַּכּוּ אֶת־מוֹאָב בָּעֵת הַהִיא כַּעֲשֶׂרֶת אֲלָפִים אִישׁ כָּל־
ל שָׁמֶן וְכָל־אִישׁ חָיִל וְלֹא נִמְלַט אִישׁ: וַתִּכָּנַע מוֹאָב בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא תַּחַת יַד
לא יִשְׂרָאֵל וַתִּשְׁקֹט הָאָרֶץ שְׁמוֹנִים שָׁנָה: וְאַחֲרָיו הָיָה
שַׁמְגַּר בֶּן־עֲנָת וַיַּךְ אֶת־פְּלִשְׁתִּים שֵׁשׁ־מֵאוֹת אִישׁ בְּמַלְמַד הַבָּקָר וַיֹּשַׁע
ד א גַּם־הוּא אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל: וַיֹּסִפוּ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לַעֲשׂוֹת הָרַע
ב בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה וְאֵהוּד מֵת: וַיִּמְכְּרֵם יהוה בְּיַד יָבִין מֶלֶךְ־כְּנַעַן אֲשֶׁר מָלַךְ
ג בְּחָצוֹר וְשַׂר־צְבָאוֹ סִיסְרָא וְהוּא יוֹשֵׁב בַּחֲרֹשֶׁת הַגּוֹיִם: וַיִּצְעֲקוּ בְנֵי־
יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶל־יהוה כִּי תְשַׁע מֵאוֹת רֶכֶב־בַּרְזֶל לוֹ וְהוּא לָחַץ אֶת־בְּנֵי
יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּחָזְקָה עֶשְׂרִים שָׁנָה:

HAFTARAS BESHALACH *Ashkenazim:* 4:4-5:31

ד וּדְבוֹרָה אִשָּׁה נְבִיאָה אֵשֶׁת לַפִּידוֹת הִיא שֹׁפְטָה אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל בָּעֵת
ה הַהִיא: וְהִיא יוֹשֶׁבֶת תַּחַת־תֹּמֶר דְּבוֹרָה בֵּין הָרָמָה וּבֵין בֵּית־אֵל בְּהַר
ו אֶפְרָיִם וַיַּעֲלוּ אֵלֶיהָ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לַמִּשְׁפָּט: וַתִּשְׁלַח וַתִּקְרָא לְבָרָק בֶּן־
אֲבִינֹעַם מִקֶּדֶשׁ נַפְתָּלִי וַתֹּאמֶר אֵלָיו הֲלֹא־צִוָּה | יהוה אֱלֹהֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל לֵךְ
וּמָשַׁכְתָּ בְּהַר תָּבוֹר וְלָקַחְתָּ עִמְּךָ עֲשֶׂרֶת אֲלָפִים אִישׁ מִבְּנֵי נַפְתָּלִי וּמִבְּנֵי
ז זְבֻלוּן: וּמָשַׁכְתִּי אֵלֶיךָ אֶל־נַחַל קִישׁוֹן אֶת־סִיסְרָא שַׂר־צְבָא יָבִין וְאֶת־
ח רִכְבּוֹ וְאֶת־הֲמוֹנוֹ וּנְתַתִּיהוּ בְיָדֶךָ: וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלֶיהָ בָּרָק אִם־תֵּלְכִי עִמִּי
ט וְהָלַכְתִּי וְאִם־לֹא תֵּלְכִי עִמִּי לֹא אֵלֵךְ: וַתֹּאמֶר הָלֹךְ אֵלֵךְ עִמָּךְ אֶפֶס כִּי
לֹא תִהְיֶה תִּפְאַרְתְּךָ עַל־הַדֶּרֶךְ אֲשֶׁר־אַתָּה הוֹלֵךְ כִּי בְּיַד־אִשָּׁה יִמְכֹּר
י יהוה אֶת־סִיסְרָא וַתָּקָם דְּבוֹרָה וַתֵּלֶךְ עִם־בָּרָק קֶדְשָׁה: וַיַּזְעֵק בָּרָק אֶת־
זְבוּלֻן וְאֶת־נַפְתָּלִי קֶדְשָׁה וַיַּעַל בְּרַגְלָיו עֲשֶׂרֶת אַלְפֵי אִישׁ וַתַּעַל עִמּוֹ
יא דְּבוֹרָה: וְחֶבֶר הַקֵּינִי נִפְרָד מִקַּיִן מִבְּנֵי חֹבָב חֹתֵן מֹשֶׁה וַיֵּט אָהֳלוֹ עַד־
יב אֵלוֹן °בְּצַעֲנַנִּים [°בְּצַעֲנַנִּים ק׳] אֲשֶׁר אֶת־קֶדֶשׁ: וַיַּגִּדוּ לְסִיסְרָא כִּי עָלָה
יג בָּרָק בֶּן־אֲבִינֹעַם הַר־תָּבוֹר: וַיַּזְעֵק סִיסְרָא אֶת־כָּל־רִכְבּוֹ תְּשַׁע מֵאוֹת
רֶכֶב בַּרְזֶל וְאֶת־כָּל־הָעָם אֲשֶׁר אִתּוֹ מֵחֲרֹשֶׁת הַגּוֹיִם אֶל־נַחַל קִישׁוֹן:
יד וַתֹּאמֶר דְּבוֹרָה אֶל־בָּרָק קוּם כִּי זֶה הַיּוֹם אֲשֶׁר נָתַן יהוה אֶת־סִיסְרָא
בְּיָדֶךָ הֲלֹא יהוה יָצָא לְפָנֶיךָ וַיֵּרֶד בָּרָק מֵהַר תָּבוֹר וַעֲשֶׂרֶת אֲלָפִים אִישׁ
טו אַחֲרָיו: וַיְהָם יהוה אֶת־סִיסְרָא וְאֶת־כָּל־הָרֶכֶב וְאֶת־כָּל־הַמַּחֲנֶה לְפִי־

3:31. Shamgar, ■ Levite, was a judge for a period of only several months. His brief reign is included in the eighty years of tranquility mentioned in verse 30 (*Seder Olam*).

4:2. The people again lapsed into sinful conduct and were punished by the ascendancy of Canaan, in fulfillment of the prophecy (2:3) that God would cause the Canaanites to be a source of pain and irritation (*Malbim*).

4:4. Deborah was the first judge to be described as a prophet and as a decider of questions of law for the nation.

Literally, לַפִּידוֹת means *torches*. The phrase אִשָּׁת לַפִּידוֹת then indicates that Deborah was either "a woman who made wicks" for the Tabernacle Menorah (*Rashi*), or "a fiery, energetic woman" (*Ralbag*). Alternatively, *Lappidoth* (Torches) was another name for *Barak* (v. 6), a name

of the sword before Barak; Sisera dismounted from his chariot and fled on his feet. [16] *Barak chased after the chariots and after the camp until Harosheth-goiim; and the entire camp of Sisera fell by the edge of the sword; not even one was left.*

Jael lures Sisera . . .

[17] *Sisera fled on his feet to the tent of Jael, the wife of Heber the Kenite, for there was peace between Jabin, king of Hazor, and the House of Heber the Kenite.* [18] *Jael went out toward Sisera and said to him, "Turn aside, my lord, turn aside to me, do not fear." So he turned aside to her to the tent, and she covered him with a blanket.*

[19] *He said to her, "Give me now a bit of water to drink, because I am thirsty." She opened a skin of milk, gave him to drink, and covered him.* [20] *He said to her, "Stand at the entrance of the tent, and it shall be that if any man will come and ask you and say, 'Is anyone here?' you shall say, 'No!' "*

. . . and dispatches him

[21] *Jael, wife of Heber, took a tent peg, placed a hammer in her hand, came to him stealthily, and drove the peg into his temple and it went through into the ground — [while] he was sleeping deeply and exhausted — and he died.* [22] *Behold — Barak was pursuing Sisera, and Jael went out toward him and told him, "Come and I will show you the man whom you seek!" He came to her and behold — Sisera was fallen, dead, with the peg in his temple.*

[23] *On that day God subjugated Jabin, king of Canaan, before the Children of Israel.* [24] *The hand of the Children of Israel became progressively harsh over Jabin, king of Canaan, until they destroyed Jabin, king of Canaan.*

5

The Song of Deborah

[1] *Deborah sang — as well as Barak son of Abinoam — on that day, saying:*

[2] *When vengeances are inflicted upon Israel and the people dedicates itself [to God] — bless HASHEM.*

[3] *Hear, O kings; give ear, O princes! I, to HASHEM shall I sing; I shall sing praise to HASHEM, God of Israel!*

[4] *HASHEM, as You left Seir,* as You strode from the fields of Edom, the earth quaked and even the heavens trickled; even the clouds dripped water.*

[5] *Mountains melted before HASHEM — as did Sinai — before HASHEM, the God of Israel.*

[6] *In the days of Shamgar son of Anath, in the days of Jael, highway travel ceased, and those who traveled on paths went by circuitous roads.*

[7] *They stopped living in unwalled towns in Israel, they stopped; until I, Deborah, arose; I arose as a mother in Israel.*

[8] *When it chose new gods, war came to its gates; was even a shield or a spear seen among forty thousand in Israel?*

The new situation after the war

[9] *My heart is with the lawgivers of Israel who are devoted to the people, [saying,] "Bless HASHEM."**

[10] *O riders of white donkeys, [you] who sit in judgment, and you who walk*

5:1. A Scriptural "song" is an unusual spiritual phenomenon. Just as music consists of a combination of notes and instruments so harmonious that every part is indispensable, similarly the spiritual experience that erupts into Scriptural song consists of a perception that all events — even those previously incomprehensible — are part of God's plan and were for the benefit of its players. As Deborah sets forth rapturously, even the forces of nature joined Israel in battle.

5:4. Poetically, Deborah depicts the Giving of the Torah at Mount Sinai (see *Deuteronomy* 33:2).

5:9. Deborah expresses her heartfelt gratitude to the devoted *lawgivers*, who circulated among the people tirelessly in their time of degradation, teaching them to *bless HASHEM (Rashi)*.

טז חֶרֶב לִפְנֵי בָרָק וַיֵּרֶד סִיסְרָא מֵעַל הַמֶּרְכָּבָה וַיָּנָס בְּרַגְלָיו: וּבָרָק רָדַף
אַחֲרֵי הָרֶכֶב וְאַחֲרֵי הַמַּחֲנֶה עַד חֲרֹשֶׁת הַגּוֹיִם וַיִּפֹּל כָּל־מַחֲנֵה סִיסְרָא
יז לְפִי־חָרֶב לֹא נִשְׁאַר עַד־אֶחָד: וְסִיסְרָא נָס בְּרַגְלָיו אֶל־אֹהֶל יָעֵל אֵשֶׁת
יח חֶבֶר הַקֵּינִי כִּי שָׁלוֹם בֵּין יָבִין מֶלֶךְ־חָצוֹר וּבֵין בֵּית חֶבֶר הַקֵּינִי: וַתֵּצֵא
יָעֵל לִקְרַאת סִיסְרָא וַתֹּאמֶר אֵלָיו סוּרָה אֲדֹנִי סוּרָה אֵלַי אַל־תִּירָא
יט וַיָּסַר אֵלֶיהָ הָאֹהֳלָה וַתְּכַסֵּהוּ בַּשְּׂמִיכָה: וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלֶיהָ הַשְׁקִינִי־נָא מְעַט־
כ מַיִם כִּי צָמֵאתִי וַתִּפְתַּח אֶת־נֹאוד הֶחָלָב וַתַּשְׁקֵהוּ וַתְּכַסֵּהוּ: וַיֹּאמֶר
אֵלֶיהָ עֲמֹד פֶּתַח הָאֹהֶל וְהָיָה אִם־אִישׁ יָבֹא וּשְׁאֵלֵךְ וְאָמַר הֲיֵשׁ־פֹּה
כא אִישׁ וְאָמַרְתְּ אָיִן: וַתִּקַּח יָעֵל אֵשֶׁת־חֶבֶר אֶת־יְתַד הָאֹהֶל וַתָּשֶׂם אֶת־
הַמַּקֶּבֶת בְּיָדָהּ וַתָּבוֹא אֵלָיו בַּלָּאט וַתִּתְקַע אֶת־הַיָּתֵד בְּרַקָּתוֹ וַתִּצְנַח
כב בָּאָרֶץ וְהוּא־נִרְדָּם וַיָּעֵף וַיָּמֹת: וְהִנֵּה בָרָק רֹדֵף אֶת־סִיסְרָא וַתֵּצֵא יָעֵל
לִקְרָאתוֹ וַתֹּאמֶר לוֹ לֵךְ וְאַרְאֶךָּ אֶת־הָאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר־אַתָּה מְבַקֵּשׁ וַיָּבֹא
כג אֵלֶיהָ וְהִנֵּה סִיסְרָא נֹפֵל מֵת וְהַיָּתֵד בְּרַקָּתוֹ: וַיַּכְנַע אֱלֹהִים בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא
כד אֶת יָבִין מֶלֶךְ־כְּנָעַן לִפְנֵי בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל: וַתֵּלֶךְ יַד בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל הָלוֹךְ וְקָשָׁה
עַל יָבִין מֶלֶךְ־כְּנָעַן עַד אֲשֶׁר הִכְרִיתוּ אֵת יָבִין מֶלֶךְ־כְּנָעַן:

ה

HAFTARAS BESHALACH
Sephardim: 5:1-31

א וַתָּשַׁר דְּבוֹרָה וּבָרָק בֶּן־אֲבִינֹעַם בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא
ב לֵאמֹר: בִּפְרֹעַ פְּרָעוֹת בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל בְּהִתְנַדֵּב
ג עָם בָּרְכוּ יהוה: שִׁמְעוּ מְלָכִים הַאֲזִינוּ אֲזָנִּים
אָנֹכִי לַיהוה אָנֹכִי אָשִׁירָה אֲזַמֵּר
ד לַיהוה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל: יהוה בְּצֵאתְךָ
מִשֵּׂעִיר בְּצַעְדְּךָ מִשְּׂדֵה אֱדוֹם אֶרֶץ
רָעָשָׁה גַּם־שָׁמַיִם נָטָפוּ גַּם־עָבִים נָטְפוּ
ה מָיִם: הָרִים נָזְלוּ מִפְּנֵי יהוה זֶה
ו סִינַי מִפְּנֵי יהוה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל: בִּימֵי שַׁמְגַּר בֶּן־
עֲנָת בִּימֵי יָעֵל חָדְלוּ אֳרָחוֹת וְהֹלְכֵי
ז נְתִיבוֹת יֵלְכוּ אֳרָחוֹת עֲקַלְקַלּוֹת: חָדְלוּ פְרָזוֹן בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל
חָדֵלוּ עַד שֶׁקַּמְתִּי דְּבוֹרָה שֶׁקַּמְתִּי
ח אֵם בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל: יִבְחַר אֱלֹהִים
חֲדָשִׁים אָז לָחֶם שְׁעָרִים מָגֵן
אִם־יֵרָאֶה וָרֹמַח בְּאַרְבָּעִים אֶלֶף
ט בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל: לִבִּי לְחוֹקְקֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הַמִּתְנַדְּבִים
י בָּעָם בָּרְכוּ יהוה: רֹכְבֵי אֲתֹנוֹת
צְחֹרוֹת יֹשְׁבֵי עַל־מִדְיָן וְהֹלְכֵי